

Principles of Marketing

Exam-Ready Revision Notes

Approximately 100 pages of explanations, formulas, comparisons, traps, and answer frames

Every syllabus topic retained

97 exact topic IDs across 13 teaching weeks

Tier A = high-yield core concept; Tier B = supporting/application concept; Tier C = introduction, setup, or recap.

Build date: 8 August 2026

How to Use This Exam Edition

Read the definition first, then reproduce the core explanation without looking. For calculation or architecture questions, write the formula or flow before the prose. Use the red exam-trap line to protect marks, and finish each week with its answer frame. The exact topic badge is also the coverage key used by the audit report.

Coverage and priority. All 97 source lessons are present: Tier A 65, Tier B 21, Tier C 11. Condensation changes depth, not syllabus coverage. Definitions, mechanisms, applicable formulas, examples or contrasts, quick-revision facts, and pitfalls are selected from the edited course notes.

Mark-wise method. For 2 marks: definition + one distinction. For 5 marks: definition + mechanism + example + limitation. For 10 marks: add a diagram or formula, compare alternatives, state metrics, and justify the final decision.

Week Roadmap

Week	Focus	Coverage
Week 1	Marketing Foundations and Consumer Value	10 topics
Week 2	Marketing Frameworks, Positioning, and Portfolios	7 topics
Week 3	Marketing Research, Analytics, and Forecasting	5 topics
Week 4	Marketing Mix, Creativity, and Consumer Action	7 topics
Week 5	Consumer Behaviour and Branding	8 topics
Week 6	Pricing Strategy, Sales, and Channel Decisions	10 topics
Week 7	Product, Market, and Growth Strategy	8 topics
Week 8	Meta Advertising and Campaign Design	5 topics
Week 9	Google Ads, Auctions, and Campaign Types	6 topics
Week 10	Targeting and Performance Marketing	7 topics
Week 11	Google Analytics and Attribution	7 topics
Week 12	Storytelling and Thinking Models	6 topics
Week 13	Budgets, Unit Economics, Ethics, and Career Skills	11 topics

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Week 1: Marketing Foundations and Consumer Value

Week roadmap: Marketing Foundations: Module Overview → What Is Marketing? → Consumer Value: Benefits, Costs, and the Value Equation → Tangible and Intangible Value → Demand Fundamentals → Need, Want, and Demand → 4 more topics.

Coverage: 10 exact source topics; definitions and mechanisms come first, followed by formulas, examples, and traps where applicable.

MKT-W01-T01 Marketing Foundations: Module Overview

Tier C

Definition and why it matters: Marketing sits at the intersection of economics, psychology, and business strategy. Before advanced frameworks like STP, BCG, or digital analytics can be applied, a marketer must understand what marketing actually does, how consumers perceive value, and how demand is formed in real markets. This module builds that foundation

Core explanation: Concept flow: What is Marketing - Value Creation - Demand and Economics - Digital Marketing Mix - Consumer Relationships - foundations - ecosystem

Must remember:

- Marketing = creating and managing perceived value for consumers
- Value = benefits divided by costs; aim for ratio 1
- Demand requires need/want + ability + willingness to pay
- Needs are universal; wants are shaped by marketing; demand is purchase-ready intent
- Elastic demand = price-sensitive; inelastic = price-insensitive
- Digital mix = earned + owned + paid media working together
- Customer groups: strangers, butterflies, true friends, barnacles - each needs different investment

Formula / decision rule: $\text{Value} = (\text{Benefits})/(\text{Costs})$; $\text{Benefits} = \text{Costs}$

Exam trap: Trap: Treating marketing as only advertising. Marketing spans acquisition, engagement, retention, and value creation across the full customer lifecycle Trap: Confusing want with demand. A strong want without purchasing power does not create demand

MKT-W01-T02 What Is Marketing?

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Marketing answers a deceptively simple question: How does a company convince people that its offering solves a real problem worth paying for? It is not a one-time campaign or a billboard - it is an ongoing process of understanding human challenges and delivering solutions that resonate Level: Formal; Definition: Strategies to acquire, engage, and retain customers while creating consumer value

Core explanation: Concept flow: Company Offering - Marketing Bridge - Consumer Need - Trust and Loyalty - Continuous Relationship Loop Marketing bridges the gap between what companies offer and what consumers need. This includes: Activity: Understanding challenges; Purpose: Identify unmet needs and desires; Example: User research before product launch Activity: Crafting messages; Purpose: Communicate value clearly; Example: "Zero sugar, same great taste" (Coke Zero) Activity: Delivering solutions; Purpose: Match offering to need; Example: Home delivery for food (fulfilling the need for food with convenience) Activity: Building trust; Purpose: Enable repeat purchase; Example: Consistent quality, transparent pricing Activity: Driving loyalty; Purpose: Long-term revenue; Example: Rewards programs, personalised experiences Solving individual or societal problems Saving time or simplifying decisions Fostering emotional connection with a brand Influencing purchase decisions through credible messaging Successful marketing is not a one-time event. Companies that excel create a continuous loop: Attract the right customers Deliver promised value Generate loyalty and advocacy Reinvest insights into the next cycle One-off campaigns may spike awareness, but sustainable growth comes from repeated value delivery and relationship building

Must remember:

- Marketing = acquire + engage + build relationships + create consumer value
- Simplest definition: providing value to final consumers

- Bridges company offerings and consumer needs
- Trust and loyalty are outcomes of consistent value delivery
- Marketing is continuous, not a one-time campaign
- Successful companies run a loyalty loop, not isolated promotions

Example or contrast: Consider how a small team decides what the world should hear about a product. The decision is not random - it is based on: Who the audience is What problem they face

Exam trap: Trap: Defining marketing as "selling products." Selling is one activity; marketing encompasses research, positioning, communication, distribution, and relationship management Trap: Saying marketing "creates needs." Marketers cater to needs and shape wants - they do not create biological necessities like food or shelter

MKT-W01-T03

Consumer Value: Benefits, Costs, and the Value Equation

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Consumers do not buy products - they buy perceived worth. Every purchase is a mental calculation: "Do the benefits I get justify what I give up?" Marketing succeeds when it shifts that calculation in the brand's favour

Core explanation: Perceived Value = (Benefits)/(Costs) Component: Benefits; What It Includes: Features, quality, experience, status, convenience, emotional satisfaction Component: Costs; What It Includes: Price, time, effort, mental energy, risk, opportunity cost Ratio: 1; Consumer Feeling: High value - "great deal"; Business Implication: Satisfaction, loyalty, positive word-of-mouth Ratio: = 1; Consumer Feeling: Fair value - "got what I paid for"; Business Implication: Neutral; no strong loyalty Ratio: < 1; Consumer Feeling: Low value - "overpaid"; Business Implication: Dissatisfaction, churn, negative reviews Concept flow: Value = Benefits / Costs - Increase Benefits - Decrease Costs - Add features - Improve quality - Better service - Lower price / discounts - Reduce friction in buying - Save time and effort Strategy: Increase benefits; Example: Add warranty, premium packaging, faster delivery Strategy: Improve quality; Example: Better materials, more reliable performance Strategy: Reduce monetary cost; Example: Discounts, bundling, financing Strategy: Reduce non-monetary cost; Example: One-click checkout (Amazon), simplified onboarding Two levers on the equation: Perceived value is subjective. Two consumers can pay the same price for the same product and feel entirely different about the deal because their benefit assessment differs Marketers influence perception through: Social proof (reviews, endorsements) Experience design (store ambience, packaging) Comparison framing ("save 20% vs competitors")

Must remember:

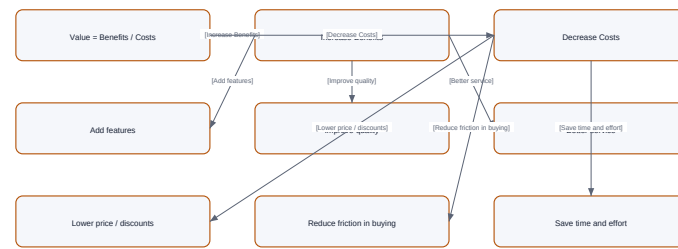
- Value = Benefits / Costs (perceived, not just monetary)
- Ratio 1 = high value; = 1 = fair; < 1 = dissatisfaction
- Increase value by raising benefits OR lowering costs (including friction)
- Fair value satisfies but does not create loyalty
- Perception matters as much as product specs
- Long-term success requires consistently high perceived value

Formula / decision rule: Perceived Value = (Benefits)/(Costs); > 1

Example or contrast: Benefits: fitness tracking, long battery life, sleek design, health insights Costs: purchase price, learning curve, charging time If benefits clearly outweigh price → high perceived value → purchase and brand affinity

Exam trap: Trap: Equating value only with low price. Value is a ratio - a premium product can deliver high value if benefits are exceptional Trap: Ignoring non-monetary costs. Time, effort, and cognitive load are real costs (e.g., a 10-field checkout form increases perceived cost)

Consumer Value: Benefits, Costs, and the Value Equation



Vector reconstruction of the source Memeaid visual

Concept map: Consumer Value: Benefits, Costs, and the Value Equation

MKT-W01-T04

Tangible and Intangible Value

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Consumers evaluate products on two parallel tracks: what they can measure (price, performance) and what they feel (status, experience). Strong brands engineer both - a fuel-efficient car (tangible) and the pride of owning a luxury badge (intangible)

Core explanation: Concept flow: Consumer Value - Tangible Value - Intangible Value - Economic Value - Functional Value - Social Value - Experiential Value Objective, measurable, logical benefits that are easy to quantify Example: Bulk coffee packs (20% savings); Economic Benefit: Lower unit cost Example: Car with 25 km/l fuel efficiency; Economic Benefit: Lower running cost Example: Annual subscription vs monthly; Economic Benefit: Price arbitrage Example: Smartphone with 48-hour battery; Functional Benefit: Reliability without frequent charging Example: 10-minute grocery delivery app; Functional Benefit: Speed and convenience Example: Cloud storage with 99.99% uptime; Functional Benefit: Dependability for business data Focus on price and efficiency - getting the best deal for money Driver: Status signalling; Example: Rolex watch as success symbol Consumer question: Is this a good investment? Driver: Belonging; Example: Buying brand sneakers because the peer group wears them Focus on utility and performance - how well the product does its job Driver: Identity expression; Example: Eco-friendly products signalling environmental responsibility Element: Aesthetics; Example: Apple Store design, luxury car dashboard Consumer question: Does this do what I need it to do? Element: Service warmth; Example: High-end hotel reception greeting Subjective, emotional, psychological benefits - harder to quantify but often decisive Element: Psychological ease; Example: No-questions-asked return policy How a product affects status, identity, and belonging Element: Ambience; Example: Starbucks - aroma, music, cup branding, barista interaction Consumer question: What will people think of me if I use this? Sensory and emotional satisfaction from using the product or service Consumer question: How do I feel while using this? Recall: $\text{Value} = (\text{Benefits})/(\text{Costs})$ Pay INR 300 for coffee worth ~INR 50 in beans Benefits include: comfortable seating, Wi-Fi, status cup with logo, ambience, social signalling Combined tangible + intangible benefits outweigh monetary cost → high value ratio "Buy Now" one-click removes form-filling, decision fatigue, and time Lower perceived non-monetary cost instantly improves value ratio Same price, better perceived deal Products heavy on intangible/experiential value tend toward inelastic demand - consumers stay loyal despite price increases (Starbucks coffee vs generic coffee). This is a core reason brands invest in experience and identity beyond functional specs

Must remember:

- Tangible value = economic (price/efficiency) + functional (utility/performance)
- Intangible value = social (status/belonging) + experiential (emotion/ambience)
- Each sub-type maps to a consumer mental question (investment, utility, perception, feeling)
- Starbucks increases benefits; Amazon decreases costs - both raise value ratio
- Strong brands combine tangible proof with intangible differentiation
- Intangible value drives loyalty and pricing power

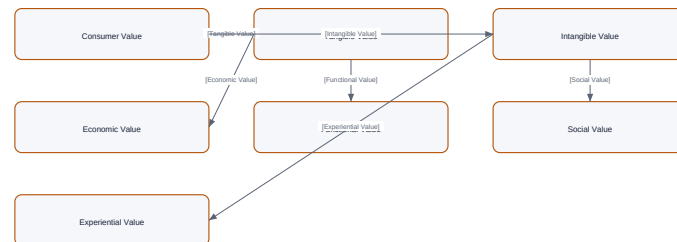
Formula / decision rule: $\text{Value} = (\text{Benefits})/(\text{Costs})$

Example or contrast: Dimension: Measurability; Tangible: High; Intangible: Low Dimension: Decision driver; Tangible: Logic, specs, price; Intangible: Emotion, identity, experience Dimension: Examples; Tangi-

ble: Fuel efficiency, bulk discount; Intangible: Brand prestige, store ambience

Exam trap: Trap: Treating intangible value as "soft" and unimportant. Premium pricing often depends entirely on intangible value Trap: Assuming tangible value alone wins markets. Commodities compete on price; differentiated brands compete on experience and identity

Tangible and Intangible Value



Vector reconstruction of the source Memmald visual

Concept map: Tangible and Intangible Value

MKT-W01-T05 Demand Fundamentals

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Demand is where marketing meets economics. A product can be desirable, beautifully branded, and widely advertised - but if consumers lack the ability or willingness to pay, no sale occurs. Demand is the purchase-ready expression of consumer desire Demand is the relationship between:

Core explanation: Concept flow: Need / Want - Ability to Pay - Willingness to Pay - Demand Created Factor: Need; Meaning: Basic requirement driving purchase; Example: Food, clothing, shelter Factor: Ability; Meaning: Financial capacity to buy; Example: Income, savings, credit access Factor: Willingness; Meaning: Readiness to pay a specific price at perceived fair value; Example: Choosing iPhone at INR 80,000 because value feels right Factor: Income level; Effect: Higher income expands ability; recession shrinks it Factor: Price; Effect: Higher price reduces quantity demanded (law of demand) Factor: Perceived value; Effect: Higher value increases willingness even at premium prices Understanding demand helps answer: Factor: Substitutes; Effect: Availability of alternatives affects demand elasticity What do consumers want? Factor: Macro conditions; Effect: Inflation, interest rates, consumer confidence shift purchasing power How much are they willing to pay? At what price point does desire convert to purchase? Which segments have real purchasing power? Demand analysis informs pricing, targeting, product design, and channel strategy

Must remember:

- Demand = desire + ability + willingness to pay
- All three factors must be present for a purchase to occur
- Needs are universal; wants are shaped; demand is purchase-ready
- Income, price, and perceived value are key demand drivers
- Marketers study demand to set price, target segments, and forecast sales
- High want without ability = no demand

Example or contrast: Need/want: Person wants a smartphone for communication and apps Concept: Need; Nature: Essential, universal, stable; Marketer's Role: Cater to it (cannot create it) Concept: Want; Nature: Specific, trend-driven, flexible; Marketer's Role: Shape and influence it

Exam trap: Trap: Equating desire with demand. Wanting a luxury car without funds is want, not demand Trap: Ignoring willingness. Ability to pay does not guarantee purchase if perceived value is too low

MKT-W01-T06 Need, Want, and Demand

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: These three terms sound interchangeable but drive different marketing strategies. Needs are survival basics. Wants are shaped desires. Demand is what actually shows up in sales data when money changes hands Dimension: Nature; Need: Essential for survival/function; Want: Desire for specific products; Demand: Purchase-ready intent

Core explanation: Definition: Fundamental requirements for survival and functioning Universal and unchanging (air, water, food, shelter, sleep) Need: Food; Want: Sushi at a high-end restaurant Need: Bread; Want: Multi-grain artisan loaf Marketers do not create needs - they provide options to fulfil them Need: Clothing; Want: Latest Nike sneakers Competition is about how the need is met, not whether it exists Need: Transportation; Want: Specific car brand/model Example: Everyone needs food. Marketers offer fast food, home delivery, organic meals, meal kits - different solutions to the same need Definition: Desires for specific products or services that enhance quality of life but are not essential for survival Shaped by advertising, peer pressure, culture, personal taste Changes over time (fashion trends, technology fads) Marketers actively create and influence wants through branding, positioning, and messaging Factor: Income level; Impact: Determines ability Strategic advertising and promotions Factor: Pricing; Impact: Affects willingness at margin Lifestyle association (brand = identity) Factor: Perceived value; Impact: Shifts willingness threshold Social proof and influencer marketing Factor: Market affordability; Impact: iPhone demand limited in low-income segments despite high want Definition: The combination of need or want with ability and willingness to pay Segment: Need fulfilment; Strategy: Compete on reliability, access, price efficiency Reflects real purchasing power, not just desire Segment: Want creation; Strategy: Invest in brand, emotion, differentiation Directly impacts sales and revenue Segment: Demand generation; Strategy: Align price, financing, and value to purchasing power Sensitive to price, income, and perceived value Example: Many people want the latest iPhone. Demand exists only among those who can afford it and believe the price is justified A campaign that generates buzz (want) but ignores affordability (ability) will not produce demand

Must remember:

- Need = essential, universal, stable; marketers cater, not create
- Want = specific desire, trend-driven; marketers shape through branding
- Demand = need/want + ability + willingness to pay
- Want without money is not demand
- Pricing and perceived value convert want into demand
- Food (need) → sushi (want) → paid order (demand)

Exam trap: Trap: Saying marketers create needs. They create wants, not biological necessities Trap: Assuming high want = high sales. Demand requires purchasing power

MKT-W01-T07

Economics Foundations for Marketers

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Economics explains why consumers choose one product over another when resources are limited. Every marketing decision - pricing, bundling, positioning - sits on economic trade-offs. Understanding scarcity, demand curves, and elasticity turns gut-feel pricing into strategy

Core explanation: Consumer decisions are influenced by: Factor: Price of product; Symbol: P_x ; Effect: Higher price - lower quantity demanded Factor: Consumer income; Symbol: i ; Effect: Higher income - more purchasing power Factor: Price of related products; Symbol: P_y ; Effect: Substitutes/complements shift demand Factor: Tastes and preferences; Symbol: T ; Effect: Brand loyalty, trends Factor: Expectations; Symbol: E ; Effect: Anticipated future prices or availability Concept flow: Downward sloping - Higher price = lower quantity demanded Type: Elastic; Definition: Small price change - large quantity change; Typical Products: Wants, luxuries, substitutable goods (grapes, fashion); Price Change Effect: Consumers switch easily Law of demand: As price increases, quantity demanded generally decreases; as price decreases, quantity demanded generally increases Type: Inelastic; Definition: Price change - little quantity change; Typical Products: Needs, essentials (insulin, basic utilities); Price Change Effect: Consumers buy regardless The demand curve is a graphical representation of the price-quantity relationship. Demand reflects both desire and affordability Latin for "all other things being equal." Elasticity: Elastic; Pricing Strategy: Careful price management; promotions drive volume Allows economists to isolate one variable's effect (e.g., price on demand) Elasticity: Inelastic; Pricing Strategy: More pricing power; can raise prices with less volume loss Holds income, preferences, and related prices constant Essential for clean causal analysis in exams and strategy Relationship: Substitutes; Definition: Products used in place of each other; Price Effect: Pepsi price up - Coke demand may rise Example: If Pepsi price drops (ceteris paribus), demand for Pepsi rises Relationship: Complements; Definition:

Products used together; Price Effect: Printer price up - ink cartridge demand may fall Strategic goal: Shift demand from elastic toward inelastic by adding intangible/experiential value (generic coffee → Starbucks experience) Bundle complements (printer + ink subscription) Differentiate against substitutes (unique features, brand loyalty) Monitor competitor pricing of substitutes

Must remember:

- Economics = choices under scarcity and trade-offs
- Demand function: $D_x = f(P_x, i, P_y, T, E)$
- Law of demand: price up → quantity demanded down
- Ceteris paribus = isolate one variable's effect
- Elastic = price-sensitive (wants); inelastic = price-insensitive (needs)
- Substitutes replace each other; complements are bought together
- Brands shift elastic demand toward inelastic via experience and identity

Formula / decision rule: P_x ; P_y

Example or contrast: Elastic: Green grape price doubles → consumers switch to red grapes or strawberries
Inelastic: Insulin price doubles → diabetic patients still need the same quantity Product: Generic coffee (INR 100); Elasticity: Elastic; Why: Commodity; easy to switch cafes

Exam trap: Economics studies how choices are made when resources are limited Humans have unlimited wants but limited resources

MKT-W01-T08

Macro and Microeconomics in Marketing Strategy

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Marketing does not happen in a vacuum. Macroeconomics sets the spending climate (inflation, confidence, interest rates). Microeconomics shapes individual purchase decisions (utility, competitor pricing, differentiation). Effective campaigns read both layers

Core explanation: Definition: Study of the economy as a whole Indicator: Inflation; What It Measures: Rising cost of goods; Marketing Response: Shift to value messaging; offer financing; bulk/home alternatives Indicator: Interest rates; What It Measures: Cost of borrowing; Marketing Response: EMI campaigns when rates low; caution when rates high Indicator: Consumer confidence; What It Measures: Willingness to spend; Marketing Response: Aspirational campaigns when high; savings-focused when low Concept flow: Macro Conditions - High Inflation - High Confidence - Value and savings messaging - 0% financing offers - Aspiration and status campaigns Concept: Consumer utility; Application: Perceived value from product features - highlight what solves the target's problem Concept: Competitor pricing; Application: Monitor and respond to rival price moves Concept: Differentiation; Application: Emphasise unique features when competitors undercut on price Definition: Study of individual consumer behaviour and firm-level market dynamics Concept flow: Macro indicators - Spending climate - Micro market data - Positioning and pricing - Campaign design Question: Can consumers afford to spend?; Lens: Macro Utility emphasis: Smartphone brand leads with camera quality for photo enthusiasts, battery life for travellers Question: What do they value most in this category?; Lens: Micro Comparison ads: "Switch and save" campaigns targeting competitor customers Question: How are competitors priced?; Lens: Micro Value framing: Show unique benefits that justify premium over cheaper alternatives Question: Should we message luxury or savings?; Lens: Macro

Must remember:

- Macroeconomics = economy-wide factors (inflation, rates, confidence)
- Microeconomics = individual utility, competitor pricing, differentiation
- High inflation → value messaging, financing, affordable alternatives
- High confidence → aspirational, luxury, lifestyle campaigns
- Micro: emphasise utility, monitor rivals, differentiate uniquely
- Best strategies combine macro spending climate with micro competitive positioning
- Coffee shop example: bulk beans (macro) + Wi-Fi + local events (micro)

Example or contrast: Condition: High inflation; Campaign Shift: Car dealership offers 0% financing; grocery brands emphasise value packs Condition: Low confidence; Campaign Shift: Discounts, essentials

focus, trust-building Condition: High confidence; Campaign Shift: Luxury, lifestyle enhancement, premium upsell

Exam trap: Trap: Using only micro tactics during a recession. Premium positioning fails when macro purchasing power collapses Trap: Ignoring competitor pricing in utility messaging. Features matter only if price-value balance is competitive

MKT-W01-T09

Digital Marketing Mix: Earned, Owned, and Paid Media

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Modern marketing does not rely on a single channel. Sustainable growth comes from balancing three media types: what you earn through reputation, what you own through your platforms, and what you pay for to accelerate reach. Each plays a distinct role; together they compound

Core explanation: Concept flow: Earned Media - Owned Media - Paid Media - Brand foundation - Reach accelerator - Trust and word-of-mouth Definition: Publicity gained organically through reputation, word-of-mouth, and third-party mentions - not purchased Source: Customer reviews; Example: Glowing product review on Amazon Source: Social shares; Example: User posts about brand experience Source: Media coverage; Example: Press article featuring company story Source: Influencer mentions; Example: Unpaid organic endorsement Source: Guest posts; Example: Third-party blog featuring brand Asset: Website; Purpose: Brand story, product showcase, conversion hub Asset: Blog; Purpose: Thought leadership, SEO, traffic generation Asset: Social profiles; Purpose: Direct audience communication Asset: Email lists; Purpose: Nurture relationships, retention, promotions Highest credibility - people trust peer recommendations over ads Asset: App; Purpose: Engagement, loyalty, data collection Zero direct media cost (though product quality investment is required) Drives awareness and influences purchase decisions authentically Marketer's goal: Earn media through exceptional product, service, and shareable experiences Definition: Digital assets the brand fully controls Format: PPC (Pay-Per-Click); Example: Google Search ads - pay per click Format: Display ads; Example: Banner ads on websites Format: Social media ads; Example: Facebook/Instagram targeted campaigns Format: Native ads; Example: Sponsored content matching platform style Format: Remarketing; Example: Re-engage users who visited site but did not convert Complete control over messaging and user experience Foundation for long-term audience relationships Hub that paid and earned strategies point toward Definition: Marketing efforts requiring payment to promote content or products

Must remember:

- Digital mix = Earned + Owned + Paid
- Earned = organic publicity (reviews, shares, press) - highest trust
- Owned = brand-controlled assets (website, blog, email, social)
- Paid = purchased reach (PPC, display, social ads, remarketing)
- Owned is the foundation; paid is the accelerator; earned is the credibility layer
- Balance all three for sustainable long-term marketing

Example or contrast: Dimension: Cost; Earned: Free (organic); Owned: Platform maintenance; Paid: Per impression/click

Exam trap: Trap: Treating paid media as sufficient alone. Without owned assets, paid traffic has nowhere credible to land Trap: Confusing earned with owned. A brand's Instagram post is owned; a customer's share of that post is earned

MKT-W01-T10

Building Consumer Relationships: The Four Relationship Groups

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Not every customer deserves the same investment. A profitable loyal advocate and a one-time bargain hunter require opposite strategies. The four-group framework (strangers, butterflies, true friends, barnacles) helps allocate marketing resources by projected loyalty and projected profitability

Core explanation: Concept flow: Profitability - High - Loyalty Group: Strangers; Profitability: Low; Loyalty: Low; Strategy: Minimal investment; maximise per-transaction revenue Group: Butterflies; Profitability: High; Loyalty: Low; Strategy: Capture short-term value; promotions while they last Group: True Friends; Profitability: High; Loyalty: High; Strategy: Long-term investment; personalisation and loyalty rewards

Group: Barnacles; Profitability: Low; Loyalty: High; Strategy: Increase profitability or upsell; avoid over-serving Profile: Low profitability, low loyalty - unlikely to return or contribute significantly Do not over-invest in relationship building Focus on maximising revenue per transaction Treat as one-time customers; welcome repeat visits but do not chase conversion Example: Tourist buying once at a convenience store with no local loyalty Profile: High profitability, low loyalty - attracted briefly but shop around Enjoy them while they last Short-term promotions and special deals to maximise spend during the window Do not expect long-term commitment - conversion efforts usually fail Example: Stock trader switching between brokerage apps for best short-term deals and features Profile: High profitability, high loyalty - the ideal customer segment Invest heavily: personalised experiences, loyalty programs, exclusive access Maintain strong relationships and reward advocacy Concept flow: True Friends - Heavy long-term investment - Butterflies - Short-term value capture - Strangers - Per-transaction focus - Barnacles - Profitability improvement Treat as brand ambassadors who drive word-of-mouth growth Group: True friends; Resource Priority: Highest - retention, CRM, loyalty programs Active brand advocacy Group: Butterflies; Resource Priority: Medium-short - timed promotions Resilient to competitor offers Group: Barnacles; Resource Priority: Medium - upsell and margin improvement Profile: High loyalty, low profitability - return regularly but contribute little margin Group: Strangers; Resource Priority: Lowest - efficient transaction processing Increase profitability through upselling, cross-selling, or premium tiers Convert toward "true friend" status by raising average transaction value Avoid excessive free services that drain resources Example: Bank customer making frequent small transactions without maintaining a profitable balance

Must remember:

- Four groups: strangers, butterflies, true friends, barnacles
- Axes: projected profitability vs projected loyalty
- Strangers: low/low - minimal investment, maximise per sale
- Butterflies: high/low - short-term promotions, no loyalty expectation
- True friends: high/high - invest for retention and advocacy
- Barnacles: low/high - upsell to improve profitability
- Resource allocation should match group profile, not treat all customers equally

Exam trap: Trap: Treating all customers equally. Uniform CRM spend wastes budget on strangers and under-invests in true friends Trap: Expecting butterflies to become loyal. They are profitable but transient by nature

Week 1 Exam Lens

Likely questions

- Define and explain Consumer Value: Benefits, Costs, and the Value Equation; include the mechanism and one limitation.
- Compare Consumer Value: Benefits, Costs, and the Value Equation with Tangible and Intangible Value and state when each is preferred.
- Apply Demand Fundamentals to a realistic system or business scenario and justify the decision.

10-mark answer frame: Start with a precise definition; draw or state the causal flow; explain each stage and metric; add a comparison or worked example; close with trade-offs, failure modes, and the decision rule.

Formula and decision sheet: $\text{Value} = (\text{Benefits})/(\text{Costs})$; $\text{Benefits} = \text{Costs}$; $\text{Perceived Value} = (\text{Benefits})/(\text{Costs})$; > 1 ; P_x ; P_y

Mistakes to avoid: Trap: Treating marketing as only advertising. Marketing spans acquisition, engagement, retention, and value creation across the full customer lifecycle Trap: Defining marketing as "selling products." Selling is one activity; marketing encompasses research, positioning, communication, distribution, and relationship management Trap: Equating value only with low price. Value is a ratio - a premium product can deliver high value if benefits are exceptional

Week 2: Marketing Frameworks, Positioning, and Portfolios

Week roadmap: Marketing Foundations and Strategic Evolution: Module Overview → From Marketing Funnel to Flywheel: AIDA in Practice → Strategic Analysis Frameworks: PESTEL, Porter's Five Forces, and SWOT → Points of Parity and Points of Difference → The STP Model: Segmentation, Targeting, and Positioning → Product-Oriented vs Market-Oriented Positioning → 1 more topics.

Coverage: 7 exact source topics; definitions and mechanisms come first, followed by formulas, examples, and traps where applicable.

MKT-W02-T01 Marketing Foundations and Strategic Evolution: Module Overview Tier C

Definition and why it matters: Week 1 established what marketing is, how value works, and how demand forms. This module moves from foundations to strategic frameworks - the tools marketers use to analyse markets, position products, and manage portfolios. Frameworks here are not checklists; they build reasoning for real decisions

Core explanation: Concept flow: Strategic Frameworks - Positioning Concepts - STP Model - BCG Portfolio Management Topic: Funnel vs flywheel; Purpose: Evolution of customer journey thinking Topic: AIDA (+ confidence, satisfaction); Purpose: Psychological stages of purchase decisions

Must remember:

- Module focus: strategic frameworks for marketing decisions
- Key frameworks: AIDA, PESTEL, Porter's Five Forces, SWOT, STP, BCG
- POP = parity with competitors; POD = differentiation
- STP: segment market → select targets → position offering
- BCG: manage product portfolio by growth and market share
- Shift from funnel (linear) to flywheel (continuous momentum)

Exam trap: Trap: Memorising frameworks without applying them. Exams test interpretation (e.g., which BCG quadrant, which PESTEL factor) Trap: Confusing SWOT (firm-level) with Porter's Five Forces (industry-level)

MKT-W02-T02 From Marketing Funnel to Flywheel: AIDA in Practice Tier A

Definition and why it matters: For decades, marketers pictured customers moving linearly: awareness → interest → desire → action. Globalisation and digital complexity broke that model. Today's journey is co-shaped by trust signals, cultural relevance, and emotional priming - not a single straight path

Core explanation: Stage: Attention; Goal: Get noticed; create first recognition; Tactics: Bold visuals, striking headlines, contrast Stage: Interest; Goal: Keep audience curious; Tactics: Provocative questions, surprising answers Stage: Desire; Goal: Turn curiosity into emotional need; Tactics: Storytelling, value promises, sensory experience Stage: Action; Goal: Drive next step; Tactics: CTA, contact info, purchase, visit Concept flow: Attention - Interest - Desire - Action Concept: Proving; Purpose: Build credibility; Examples: Reviews, portfolios, Instagram proof, case studies Concept: Priming; Purpose: Build cultural relevance and emotional connection; Examples: Brand distinctiveness, cultural alignment, repeated exposure Modern purchase decisions involve pre-stages: Together, proving and priming shape decisions before AIDA stages even begin Black background, glowing Coke Zero bottle Command: "Just Add Zero" Stood out vs unbranded posters; captured eyeballs instantly Question: "What does Coke Zero sugar taste like?" Surprising answer: "It's still a Coke" Challenged consumer assumptions about zero-sugar taste Promise: zero sugar, same great Coke taste Billboards poured real ice-cold Coke Zero at sampling stations Multi-sensory: see, hear, taste on the spot 23,000-pound drinkable billboard at Final Four 4,000 feet of tubing spelling "Taste It" Literal action: drink the advertisement Lesson: AIDA works best when each stage is experiential, not just informational Beyond action, add: Confidence: Trust that the purchase was right Satisfaction: Post-purchase delight that fuels retention and referrals Satisfaction feeds back into the system - strengthening retention, advocacy, and long-term growth

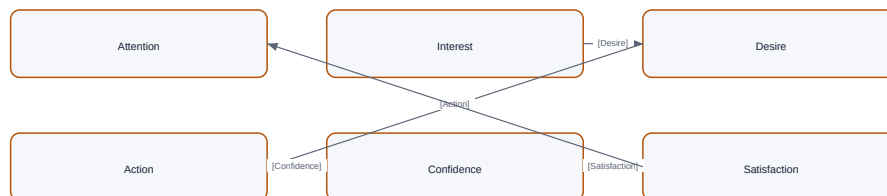
Must remember:

- AIDA: Attention → Interest → Desire → Action
- Proving (credibility) and priming (relevance) precede modern purchase paths
- Coke Zero: multi-sensory AIDA culminating in drinkable billboard
- Funnel ends at purchase; flywheel continues with confidence and satisfaction
- Extended AIDA feeds retention and advocacy back into the system
- Single ads can execute full AIDA in one visual (Beetle example)

Example or contrast: Model: Funnel; Journey End: Action (purchase); Focus: Linear conversion Model: Flywheel; Journey End: Continuous momentum; Focus: Retention, advocacy, compounding value Stage: Attention; Element: Yellow Beetle against red wedding-themed background; headline "Marriage does come with rewards"

Exam trap: Trap: Treating AIDA as strictly sequential in all media. Digital touchpoints can hit multiple stages simultaneously Trap: Ending the journey at Action. Flywheel thinking requires post-purchase confidence and satisfaction

From Marketing Funnel to Flywheel: AIDA in Practice



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: From Marketing Funnel to Flywheel: AIDA in Practice

MKT-W02-T03

Strategic Analysis Frameworks: PESTEL, Porter's Five Forces, and SWOT

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Before positioning a product, a marketer must read the environment. PESTEL scans macro forces. Porter's Five Forces assesses industry competitiveness. SWOT maps internal capabilities against external realities. Together they answer: Where are we, and what can we do about it?

Core explanation: Purpose: Examine the external macro environment affecting a business Factor: Political; What to Analyse: Government policies, trade agreements, political stability; Marketing Implication: Regulatory compliance, market entry timing Factor: Economic; What to Analyse: Inflation, currency, raw material costs, consumer spending; Marketing Implication: Pricing, financing offers, value messaging Factor: Social; What to Analyse: Demographics, culture, lifestyle trends; Marketing Implication: Positioning, product design, ethical branding Factor: Technological; What to Analyse: Innovation, digital trends, R&D; Marketing Implication: Channel strategy, product features Factor: Legal; What to Analyse: Laws, patents, data privacy rules; Marketing Implication: Compliance, risk management Factor: Environmental; What to Analyse: Sustainability, ecological regulations; Marketing Implication: Green marketing, ESG positioning Concept flow: PESTEL Analysis - Forecast trends - Identify risks - Shape competitive positioning Concept flow: Industry Rivalry - Competitive Rivalry - Supplier Power - Buyer Power - Threat of Substitutes - Threat of New Entry Force: Competitive rivalry; Question: How intensely do firms compete? Force: Supplier power; Question: Can suppliers dictate prices/terms? Force: Buyer power; Question: Can customers drive prices down? Force: Threat of substitutes; Question: Can alternatives replace the product? Force: Threat of new entry; Question: How easy is it for new competitors to enter? Purpose: Evaluate industry competitiveness and profit potential : Internal; Helpful: Strengths; Harmful: Weaknesses : External; Helpful: Opportunities; Harmful: Threats Question: What macro forces affect us?; Use: PESTEL Purpose: Evaluate internal strengths/weaknesses against external opportunities/threats Question: How competitive is our industry?; Use: Porter's Five Forces Question: What should our firm do next?; Use: SWOT Question: How does a customer decide to buy?; Use: AIDA / Flywheel

Must remember:

- PESTEL: Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Legal, Environmental
- Porter's Five Forces: rivalry, suppliers, buyers, substitutes, new entry
- SWOT: Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats (2x2 matrix)
- PESTEL = macro scan; Porter = industry competitiveness; SWOT = firm strategy
- Starbucks/Samsung illustrate PESTEL; Walmart illustrates Porter; Zomato illustrates SWOT
- Use frameworks together: environment → industry → firm action

Example or contrast: Factor: Political; Impact: Tax regulations, trade agreements across operating regions
 Factor: Economic; Impact: Currency fluctuations, coffee bean costs, macro trends
 Factor: Social; Impact: Premium coffee culture, ethical consumerism, lifestyle shifts

Exam trap: Trap: Using PESTEL for internal analysis. It is strictly external/macro
 Trap: Confusing Porter's forces with SWOT. Porter = industry structure; SWOT = firm-specific

MKT-W02-T04

Points of Parity and Points of Difference

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: To win a purchase decision, a brand must pass two tests: be good enough to be considered (parity) and different enough to be chosen (difference). Fail parity and you are invisible. Fail difference and you are interchangeable
 Concept: Point of Parity; Abbreviation: POP; Definition: Areas where your offering matches competitors - minimum requirements to be considered

Core explanation: Purpose: Ensure the brand is not eliminated from the consideration set
 Features or attributes consumers expect from any credible player
 Category: Airline; POP Examples: Safety record, on-time performance, baggage handling
 Category: Smartphone; POP Examples: Calling, messaging, app store access, camera
 Category: Bank; POP Examples: Secure transactions, regulatory compliance, ATM access
 Category: E-commerce; POP Examples: Payment options, return policy, delivery tracking
 "Hygiene factors" - absence causes rejection; presence does not win alone
 Must match or exceed category norms
 Brand: Tesla; POD: Software-driven vehicles, Supercharger network, brand innovation identity
 Brand: Dyson; POD: Engineering-led suction performance, design differentiation
 Brand: Patagonia; POD: Environmental activism as brand identity
 Brand: Zomato; POD: Hyperlocal delivery speed + restaurant discovery in India
 Strategy: Lead with POD; When to Use: Mature market with established POP baselines
 Purpose: Give consumers a compelling reason to choose your brand over alternatives
 Strategy: Fix POP gaps first; When to Use: New entrant failing basic category expectations
 Unique value that competitors cannot easily replicate
 Strategy: POD on one dimension, POP on others; When to Use: Most common - differentiate on one axis, match on rest
 Basis for premium pricing, loyalty, and advocacy
 Rooted in functional, emotional, or experiential advantages
 Concept flow: Competitive Market - Match competitor baselines - Highlight unique advantages - Clear market position
 Step: 1; Action: Identify category POPs (what every player must offer)

Must remember:

- POP = parity with competitors; minimum to be considered
- POD = differentiated value; reason to choose
- Balance both: match baselines, highlight uniqueness
- Missing POP = eliminated; missing POD = commoditised
- Audit category norms first, then build defensible differentiation
- POP and POD shift over time as categories mature

Example or contrast: Dimension: Role; POP: Entry ticket to consideration; POD: Reason to choose
 Dimension: Competitive effect; POP: Neutralises disadvantage; POD: Creates advantage
 Dimension: Risk if missing; POP: Elimination from consideration; POD: Commoditisation, price wars

Exam trap: Trap: Pursuing POD while ignoring POP gaps. A unique feature on an unreliable base product fails
 Trap: Treating every feature as POD. Most features are POP in mature categories

MKT-W02-T05

The STP Model: Segmentation, Targeting, and Positioning

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: A product cannot serve everyone equally well. STP is the disciplined process of dividing the market (Segmentation), choosing where to compete (Targeting), and defining how to win in consumers' minds (Positioning) Core formula: Segmentation + Targeting = Positioning

Core explanation: Concept flow: Segmentation: divide market - Targeting: select segments - Positioning: define image Step: S - Segmentation; Definition: Divide broad market into distinct subgroups with shared characteristics; Key Question: Who are the meaningful groups? Step: T - Targeting; Definition: Evaluate and select segment(s) to focus on; Key Question: Which groups are worth pursuing? Step: P - Positioning; Definition: Create unique, desirable image in target consumers' minds; Key Question: How do we want to be perceived? Basis: Geographic; Variables: Country, region, city, climate; Use Case: Localised products, regional campaigns Basis: Demographic; Variables: Age, gender, income, profession; Use Case: Mass-market products with clear buyer profiles Basis: Behavioural; Variables: Purchase patterns, channel preference, loyalty level; Use Case: Retention programs, channel strategy Basis: Psychographic; Variables: Lifestyle, values, hobbies, personality; Use Case: Premium brands, identity-driven products Strategy: Undifferentiated; Definition: One product/message for entire market; Example: Colgate toothpaste - staple for broad audience Strategy: Differentiated; Definition: Separate offerings/messages per segment; Example: Nike - different lines for runners, basketball, casual wear Strategy: Concentrated; Definition: Focus on one niche; Example: Lululemon - yoga and fitness-conscious athletic wear Concept flow: Undifferentiated: mass market - Differentiated: multiple segments - Concentrated: single niche Criterion: Size; Question: Is the segment large enough? Criterion: Profitability; Question: Will it generate acceptable margins? Criterion: Reachability; Question: Can we access them via channels we control? Criterion: Fit; Question: Does our offering match their needs? Phase: Segment; Output: List of distinct customer groups with profiles Phase: Target; Output: Prioritised segment(s) with rationale Phase: Position; Output: Value proposition and messaging for chosen segment(s)

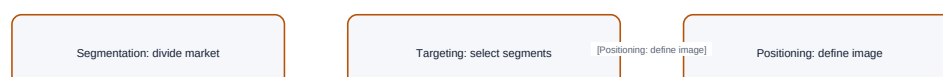
Must remember:

- STP = Segmentation + Targeting = Positioning
- Segment by geography, demographics, behaviour, or psychographics
- Target via undifferentiated, differentiated, or concentrated strategies
- Evaluate segments on size, profitability, reachability
- Plant-based milk: lifestyle vs lactose-intolerant = same product, different messages
- Positioning is the mental image created for chosen target segments

Example or contrast: Broad audience: People moving away from dairy Segment: Lifestyle-driven; Profile: High-income, wellness/sustainability motivated; Messaging Angle: Ethics, sustainability, premium lifestyle Segment: Lactose-intolerant; Profile: Health necessity, daily consumption need; Messaging Angle: Health, digestibility, functional benefit

Exam trap: Trap: Skipping segmentation and targeting to jump to positioning. Position without target = vague brand Trap: Confusing differentiated targeting with multiple brands. One brand can use differentiated messaging across segments

The STP Model: Segmentation, Targeting, and Positioning



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: The STP Model: Segmentation, Targeting, and Positioning

MKT-W02-T06

Product-Oriented vs Market-Oriented Positioning

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Positioning is how a business defines itself in consumers' minds. The critical choice: define around what you make (product-oriented) or what value you deliver (market-oriented). Market-oriented positioning typically builds stronger emotional connection and competitive moats

Core explanation: Orientation: Product-oriented; Focus: What the company makes or sells; Definition Style: "We sell coffee and snacks" Orientation: Market-oriented; Focus: Value, experience, benefit to consumer; Definition Style: "We deliver the third-place experience between home and work" Concept flow: Product-Oriented: what we make - Market-Oriented: value we deliver - Commodity risk - Emotional differentiation Advantage: Emotional connection; Explanation: Consumers buy outcomes, not specifications Advantage: Competitive resilience; Explanation: Harder to undercut on features alone Advantage: Premium pricing; Explanation: Value framing justifies higher prices Advantage: Category leadership; Explanation: Defines the market rather than fitting into it Dimension: Attribute; Example: "Longest battery life" Dimension: Benefit; Example: "Peace of mind" Dimension: User; Example: "For serious runners" Dimension: Competitor; Example: "Unlike traditional banks..." Dimension: Category; Example: "The original energy drink" Dimension: Quality/price; Example: "Affordable luxury" Product-oriented definitions invite comparison on specs and price. Market-oriented definitions compete on meaning and experience Beyond product vs market orientation, positioning can be built on: A strong positioning statement typically answers: Target segment: Who is this for? Frame of reference: What category do we compete in? Point of difference: Why choose us? Reason to believe: What proof supports the claim?

Must remember:

- Positioning = how brand is defined in consumers' minds
- Product-oriented = what we make; market-oriented = value we deliver
- Market-oriented builds emotional connection and pricing power
- Starbucks: coffee → experience; Airbnb: rentals → belonging
- Strong positioning needs target, category, POD, and proof
- Outcome-focused positioning resists commoditisation

Example or contrast: Brand: Starbucks; Product-Oriented: Selling coffee and snacks; Market-Oriented: Delivering the Starbucks experience Brand: Walmart; Product-Oriented: Running discount stores; Market-Oriented: Low prices for better living Brand: Zoom; Product-Oriented: Hosting online meetings; Market-Oriented: Frictionless, secure video communication

Exam trap: Trap: Product-oriented positioning in mature markets. Commodities compete on price; experiences compete on value Trap: Market-oriented claims without delivery. "Belong anywhere" fails if the product experience is poor

MKT-W02-T07

BCG Growth-Share Matrix

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Companies with multiple products cannot invest equally everywhere. The BCG matrix classifies products by relative market share and market growth rate to guide investment, harvesting, or divestment decisions

Core explanation: Concept flow: Share - High - Growth Quadrant: Stars; Market Share: High; Market Growth: High; Strategy: Invest heavily - future returns potential Quadrant: Cash Cows; Market Share: High; Market Growth: Low; Strategy: Milk for cash - reinvest elsewhere Quadrant: Question Marks; Market Share: Low; Market Growth: High; Strategy: Invest or divest - decide if they can become stars Quadrant: Dogs; Market Share: Low; Market Growth: Low; Strategy: Liquidate, divest, or reposition Leaders in fast-growing markets Require significant investment to maintain position Future cash generators if market share is defended Action: Invest aggressively Mature market leaders with stable demand Generate more cash than they consume Fund investment in stars and question marks Concept flow: Cash Cows - Stars - Question Marks - Dogs Action: Harvest profits; minimise new investment Principle: Balance portfolio; Application: Mix of cash generators and growth bets Operate in attractive growing markets but lack leadership Principle: Cash flow discipline; Application: Cows fund stars; don't over-invest in dogs Consume cash with uncertain returns Principle: Dynamic movement; Application: Products shift quadrants as markets evolve May become

stars with investment or dogs without it Principle: Strategic choice; Application: Not every question mark deserves investment Action: Selective investment or exit Weak position in slow markets Often cash traps with limited upside Action: Divest, reposition, or phase out

Must remember:

- BCG matrix: relative market share vs market growth rate
- Stars: high/high - invest; Cash cows: high share/low growth - milk
- Question marks: low share/high growth - invest or exit
- Dogs: low/low - divest or reposition
- Cash cows fund stars and selected question marks
- Portfolio must balance growth bets with cash generation
- Reassess periodically - products move between quadrants

Example or contrast: A diversified FMCG company might classify: Product: Leading detergent in mature market; Likely Quadrant: Cash Cow; Action: Maximise margin, defend share Product: New plant-based snack in growing category; Likely Quadrant: Question Mark; Action: Test investment, monitor share gain

Exam trap: Limitation: Oversimplification; Implication: Two dimensions miss profitability, synergies, strategic fit Limitation: Market definition; Implication: Share and growth depend on how market boundaries are drawn

Week 2 Exam Lens

Likely questions

- Define and explain From Marketing Funnel to Flywheel: AIDA in Practice; include the mechanism and one limitation.
- Compare From Marketing Funnel to Flywheel: AIDA in Practice with Strategic Analysis Frameworks: PESTEL, Porter's Five Forces, and SWOT and state when each is preferred.
- Apply The STP Model: Segmentation, Targeting, and Positioning to a realistic system or business scenario and justify the decision.

10-mark answer frame: Start with a precise definition; draw or state the causal flow; explain each stage and metric; add a comparison or worked example; close with trade-offs, failure modes, and the decision rule.

Mistakes to avoid: Trap: Memorising frameworks without applying them. Exams test interpretation (e.g., which BCG quadrant, which PESTEL factor) Trap: Treating AIDA as strictly sequential in all media. Digital touchpoints can hit multiple stages simultaneously Trap: Using PESTEL for internal analysis. It is strictly external/macro

Week 3: Marketing Research, Analytics, and Forecasting

Week roadmap: Marketing Information and Research: Module Overview → Marketing Information Ecosystem and Market Research → Analytics Maturity, Statistics, and Sampling → Demand Research Tools: Google Trends, Search Intent, and Keyword Analysis → Market Demand Forecasting with Simple ML for Sheets.

Coverage: 5 exact source topics; definitions and mechanisms come first, followed by formulas, examples, and traps where applicable.

MKT-W03-T01 Marketing Information and Research: Module Overview

Tier C

Definition and why it matters: Strategic frameworks (STP, BCG, PESTEL) tell you how to think. Market research and analytics tell you what is true about consumers and markets. This module bridges data collection, statistical reasoning, and practical tools for demand estimation

Core explanation: Concept flow: Define market research types - Compare statistical approaches - Implement demand estimation tools - Smarter marketing decisions Define market research in a business context Area: Marketing Information Ecosystem (MIE); Content: People, process, assets for data-driven decisions

Must remember:

- Module focus: information-driven marketing decisions
- Primary = original data; secondary = existing external data
- Statistics help summarise, compare, and evaluate uncertainty
- Digital tools enable fast demand estimation and trend tracking
- Combine internal + external + primary + secondary sources
- Goal: actionable insights that shape real business decisions

Exam trap: Trap: Treating secondary research as a complete substitute for primary. Secondary gives breadth; primary gives depth and specificity Trap: Accepting statistics without understanding sampling method. Bad samples produce confident but wrong conclusions

MKT-W03-T02 Marketing Information Ecosystem and Market Research

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Marketing decisions fail when they run on assumptions. The Marketing Information Ecosystem (MIE) is the organisational system - people, processes, and assets - that gathers, analyses, and applies data to replace guesswork with evidence

Core explanation: Definition: A framework of people, processes, and assets used to gather, analyse, and apply data for strategic decision-making Generate consumer insights Concept flow: Marketer Managers / Decision Makers - Marketing Information Hub - Internal Databases - Market Scanning - Primary Research - Actionable Insights - External Forces - Competitors - Macro factors Layer: Top; Elements: Marketer managers and information users (decision makers) Layer: Centre; Elements: MIE hub - integrates all data streams Layer: Left; Elements: Internal assessment: sales data, CRM, operational metrics Layer: Right; Elements: Primary research: surveys, focus groups, interviews, experiments Layer: Bottom; Elements: External forces: competitors, channels, target markets, macro trends, regulations Monitor external environment Evaluate marketing strategy effectiveness Definition: Process of evaluating viability of a new product or service by studying potential consumers Purpose: Move from assumptions to informed decisions before market launch Influences: Product features, pricing, positioning, final design Benefit: Control; Explanation: Design questions, methods, and analysis Benefit: Relevance; Explanation: Aligned to specific business problem Benefit: Ownership; Explanation: Competitors cannot access insights Benefit: Deep insights; Explanation: Direct consumer voice via surveys/interviews Benefit: Timeliness; Explanation: Reflects current market conditions Method: Interviews; Use Case: Deep qualitative understanding Method: Ethnographic research; Use Case: Observe behaviour in natural context Method: Observational research; Use Case: Track actions without direct questioning Method: MVP testing; Use Case: Validate product concept early Method: Product/field trials; Use Case: Test in real market conditions Method: Hypothesis testing; Use Case: Statistical validation of assumptions Method: Online surveys / intercept surveys; Use Case: Scale quantitative data collection Method: Focus groups (online/in-person); Use Case: Group dynamics and idea generation Source: Internet / digital

platforms; Examples: Google Trends, industry databases Source: Government agencies; Examples: Census, economic reports Source: Trade associations; Examples: Industry benchmarks Source: Competitor websites; Examples: Pricing, positioning, product range Source: NGOs and educational institutions; Examples: Sector studies Source: Company reports and media; Examples: Annual reports, news analysis Efficiency: Build on existing studies instead of starting from scratch Source: Public libraries; Examples: Historical records Speed: Quick market size, trend, and competition overview Early-stage decisions: Validate direction before expensive primary research

Must remember:

- MIE = people + process + assets for data-driven marketing decisions
- Hub integrates internal data, market scanning, and primary research
- Primary = firsthand, costly, specific, owned; secondary = existing, fast, broad
- Combine primary (depth) and secondary (breadth)
- Primary methods: surveys, interviews, focus groups, MVP tests
- Secondary sources: government, industry reports, digital platforms, competitors
- Quality decisions require continuous information flow, not one-off studies

Example or contrast: Dimension: Data source; Primary Research: Collected firsthand for specific question; Secondary Research: Existing external studies and databases Dimension: Methods; Primary Research: Surveys, interviews, focus groups, experiments, MVP tests; Secondary Research: Industry reports, government data, digital trend platforms Dimension: Cost; Primary Research: Higher; Secondary Research: Lower or free

Exam trap: Limitation: Cost; Risk: Significant budget for design, collection, analysis Limitation: Time; Risk: Planning and execution delays decisions

MKT-W03-T03

Analytics Maturity, Statistics, and Sampling

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Data without interpretation is noise. Marketers need a ladder of analytical sophistication - from describing what happened to prescribing what to do - plus statistical foundations to know whether findings are meaningful or random

Core explanation: Stage: Descriptive; Question: What happened?; Methods: Dashboards, reports, alerts, summaries; Marketing Example: Campaign click-through rates, monthly sales Stage: Diagnostic; Question: Why did it happen?; Methods: Queries, data mining, correlation analysis; Marketing Example: Why did churn spike in Region X? Stage: Predictive; Question: What will happen?; Methods: ML models, statistical forecasting, simulation; Marketing Example: Forecast Q4 demand for product line Stage: Prescriptive; Question: How do we make it happen?; Methods: Optimisation, planning, recommendation engines; Marketing Example: Optimal ad budget allocation by channel Concept flow: Descriptive: what happened - Diagnostic: why - Predictive: what will happen - Prescriptive: how to act Measure: Mean; Definition: Arithmetic average; Strength: Simple, widely used; Weakness: Skewed by outliers Measure: Median; Definition: Middle value when sorted; Strength: Resistant to outliers; Weakness: Ignores extreme values entirely Measure: Mode; Definition: Most frequent value; Strength: Best for categorical data; Weakness: May not exist or be unique Measure: Range; Definition: Max - Min; Marketing Use: Quick spread check; sensitive to outliers Trend: Value and complexity increase up the ladder. Organisations become more strategic as they mature Measure: Variance; Definition: Average squared distance from mean; Marketing Use: Compare spread across datasets Measure: Standard deviation; Definition: $\sqrt{\text{variance}}$; Marketing Use: Most interpretable spread measure (same units as data) Measure: Percentiles; Definition: Value below which X% of data falls; Marketing Use: Benchmarking (80th percentile performer) Measure: IQR; Definition: Middle 50% range (Q3 - Q1); Marketing Use: Outlier detection; robust to skew Marketer's question: What is typical behaviour? Parameter: Accuracy; Rating: High Parameter: Reliability; Rating: High (stable across repeated samples) Parameter: Efficiency; Rating: Low (requires full sampling frame, more effort) High SD = unpredictable behaviour. Low SD = consistency Divide population into meaningful subgroups (strata): demographics, regions, behaviour Parameter: Accuracy; Rating: Low (depends on cluster representativeness) Random sample from each stratum Parameter: Reliability; Rating: Moderate (varies by which clusters selected) Ensures proportional representation Parameter: Efficiency; Rating: High (practical for large, spread-out populations) Divide population into clus-

ters (geographic groups) Randomly select entire clusters Include all individuals within chosen clusters A/B testing is inferential statistics in marketing: Split audience into control (A) and variant (B) Measure outcome (clicks, conversions, revenue) Test whether difference is statistically significant or random noise Use p-values and confidence intervals to decide

Must remember:

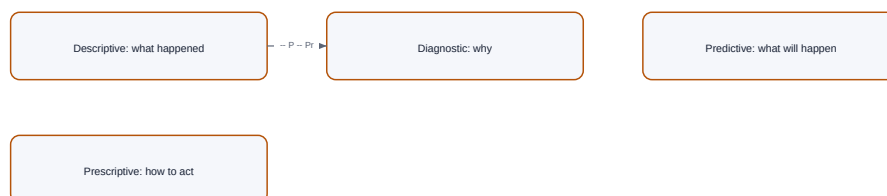
- Analytics maturity: descriptive → diagnostic → predictive → prescriptive
- Descriptive stats summarise; inferential stats generalise from samples
- Mean, median, mode = centre; range, variance, SD, IQR = spread
- Stratified = accurate, reliable, inefficient; cluster = efficient, less accurate
- A/B testing uses inferential statistics for campaign decisions
- Insight quality depends on statistical foundations and sampling design

Formula / decision rule: $\sqrt{\text{variance}}$

Example or contrast: Type: Descriptive; Purpose: Summarise existing data; Marketing Examples: Average purchase per customer, median response time, open rates; Tools: Mean, median, mode, variance, SD, percentiles Type: Inferential; Purpose: Generalise from sample to population; Marketing Examples: A/B test significance, regional churn comparison; Tools: Confidence intervals, hypothesis testing, p-values, z-scores Key distinction: Descriptive = understand what you have. Inferential = predict beyond your sample

Exam trap: Trap: Using mean when data is heavily skewed. Median is more representative Trap: Confusing descriptive dashboards with predictive capability

Analytics Maturity, Statistics, and Sampling



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: Analytics Maturity, Statistics, and Sampling

MKT-W03-T04 Demand Research Tools: Google Trends, Search Intent, and Keyword Analysis Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Before launching a campaign or writing content, marketers need to know what people are searching for, why, and how competitive those queries are. Free and paid tools turn search behaviour into demand signals - without running a single survey

Core explanation: Purpose: Understand what people search across regions, categories, and time periods Feature: Term exploration; Use: Track interest for a keyword (e.g., "iPhone 17") Feature: Comparison; Use: Compare two terms (e.g., iPhone 17 vs MacBook) Feature: Timeline adjustment; Use: 24 hours to multi-year trend views Feature: Channel filter; Use: Web Search, Image, Shopping, News, YouTube Feature: Related queries; Use: Top and rising associated searches Feature: Regional view; Use: Interest by country or region Concept flow: Enter search term - View interest over time - Compare terms - Analyse related queries - Content and campaign strategy Intent Type: Informational; User Goal: Learn about a topic; Example Query: "What is the capital of India?" Intent Type: Navigational; User Goal: Reach a specific site; Example Query: "Facebook", "Amazon" Intent Type: Transactional; User Goal: Buy something; Example Query: "Buy iPhone 17" Intent Type: Commercial investigation; User Goal: Research before purchase; Example Query: "LG washing machine 3321 vs Samsung 591" Top queries: Most common associated searches (e.g., "iPhone 17 Pro" up 4%) Rising queries: Fastest-growing searches (e.g., festival sale terms) Marketing use: Identify demand spikes, seasonal patterns, and product variant interest Metric: Monthly Search Volume (MSV); Definition: Average monthly

searches for a keyword Shows top searches in a selected country in real time Metric: SEO Difficulty (SD); Definition: How competitive the keyword is in organic search (lower = easier to rank) Useful for cultural moment marketing and news-jacking Metric: Intent label; Definition: C (commercial), N (navigational), T (transactional), I (informational) Why it matters: Content and ad strategy differ by intent. Informational queries need educational content; transactional queries need product pages and checkout paths Concept flow: Keyword candidate - MSV moderate? - SD low-moderate? - Select keyword - Reject or deprioritise Purpose: Keyword ideas with volume, intent, and SEO difficulty Choose keywords where: MSV is moderate - not too high (likely very competitive), not too low (not worth effort) SEO difficulty is low to moderate - achievable ranking in reasonable time Example: "BITS Pilani in Goa" (MSV ~33,000, SD ~18) preferred over "BITS Pilani Goa" (MSV ~14,800, SD ~15) - higher volume with manageable competition Deeper keyword analysis with: Keyword volume and keyword difficulty (KD) on scales of 50 or 100 Competitive landscape by region and category Related keyword clusters Option: Discover new keywords; Use: Enter website; get thematic keyword suggestions Option: Get search volume and forecast; Use: Enter known keywords; see volume by region Access: ads.google.com → Tools → Planning → Keyword Planner Need: Trend over time; Tool: Google Trends Need: Real-time country trends; Tool: Google Trends TV Example: "BITS Pilani" targeted to Delhi - average monthly searches between 10,000-100,000 Need: Free keyword research; Tool: Ubersuggest Note: Provides ad metrics beyond organic SEO difficulty - useful for paid campaign planning Need: Deep competitive SEO; Tool: SEMrush, Ahrefs Purpose: Quick visual map of questions and searches across engines, social media, and AI tools Need: Paid campaign volume; Tool: Google Ads Keyword Planner

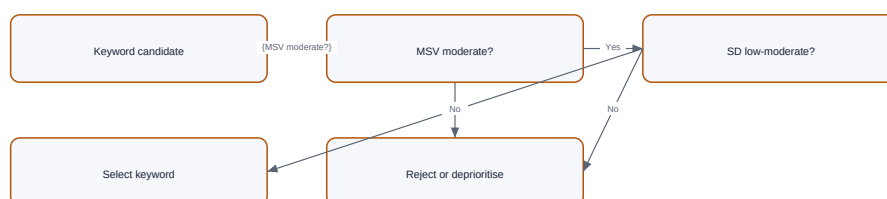
Must remember:

- Google Trends: interest over time, comparisons, related/rising queries
- Four search intents: informational, navigational, transactional, commercial investigation
- Keyword framework: moderate MSV + low-moderate SEO difficulty
- Ubersuggest (free), SEMrush/Ahrefs (paid), Keyword Planner (ads), AnswerThePublic (quick ideas)
- Start with low-KD niches, expand to higher-volume terms
- MSV and KD are not always correlated - evaluate both together

Example or contrast: Keyword: interior design software; Volume: 4,400; KD: 72.5 Keyword: best interior design software; Volume: 880; KD: Higher Keyword: how to lose weight; Volume: 90,000; KD: 49

Exam trap: Trap: Choosing highest-volume keywords blindly. High MSV often means high competition
Trap: Ignoring search intent. Ranking for informational queries does not drive sales directly

Demand Research Tools: Google Trends, Search Intent, and Keyword Analysis



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: Demand Research Tools: Google Trends, Search Intent, and Keyword Analysis

MKT-W03-T05

Market Demand Forecasting with Simple ML for Sheets

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Forecasting does not always require a data science team. When historical data includes timestamps, marketers can predict future demand using automated ML inside Google Sheets - no code, no third-party data sharing Domain: Retail; Forecasting Application: Product sales prediction

Core explanation: Tool: Google Sheets add-on by TensorFlow Decision Forests Website: simplemlfor-sheets.com Feature: Predict missing values; Purpose: Fill gaps in datasets Feature: Spot abnormal values; Purpose: Anomaly detection Feature: Forecast future values; Purpose: Time-series prediction Concept flow:

Make a copy of practice spreadsheet - Install Simple ML for Sheets add-on - Grant permissions - Select date + value columns - Choose Forecast future values - View predictions and chart Given: Monthly passenger data Jan 1949 - Dec 1960; Required: Predict Jan 1961 - May 1963 traffic Column: Date/Time; Content: Month-year timestamp Column: Value; Content: Number of passengers Key advantage: No ML coding knowledge required; data stays in your Google Sheet Open practice Google Sheet → Make a copy Extensions → Add-ons → Get add-ons Search "Simple ML for Sheets" → Install → Grant permissions Navigate to forecast tab (e.g., Case 4: Forecast Future Values) Concept: Historical patterns; Explanation: Model learns trend and seasonality from past data Concept: Time column; Explanation: Required anchor for temporal pattern detection Select date and passenger columns Concept: Automated ML; Explanation: Algorithm selects appropriate model without user configuration Extensions → Simple ML for Sheets → Start Concept: Extrapolation; Explanation: Extends learned patterns into future periods Choose Forecast future values Select Value column (passengers) as forecast target Predicted passenger counts for 1961-1963 Chart with blue line = historical data, red line = predicted values Timeline adjustable for visual analysis Not magic: Forecast quality depends on data quality, pattern stability, and forecast horizon length. Sudden market shocks (pandemics, regulation changes) degrade accuracy

Must remember:

- Forecasting = predicting future values from historical time-series data
- Simple ML for Sheets: no-code ML add-on in Google Sheets
- Requires date column + value column
- Airline case: predict 1961-1963 passengers from 1949-1960 data
- Output: predicted values + chart (blue = past, red = forecast)
- Best for quick operational forecasts; not a substitute for strategic market research
- Quality depends on data history, pattern stability, and forecast horizon

Example or contrast: Scenario: Quick forecast from historical sales data; Tool: Simple ML for Sheets Scenario: Search demand trends; Tool: Google Trends Scenario: Keyword-level demand; Tool: Ubersuggest / SEMrush

Exam trap: Trap: Forecasting without a time/date column. Model cannot detect temporal patterns Trap: Extrapolating too far into the future. Error compounds beyond the data's predictable range

Week 3 Exam Lens

Likely questions

- Define and explain Marketing Information Ecosystem and Market Research; include the mechanism and one limitation.
- Compare Marketing Information Ecosystem and Market Research with Analytics Maturity, Statistics, and Sampling and state when each is preferred.
- Apply Demand Research Tools: Google Trends, Search Intent, and Keyword Analysis to a realistic system or business scenario and justify the decision.

10-mark answer frame: Start with a precise definition; draw or state the causal flow; explain each stage and metric; add a comparison or worked example; close with trade-offs, failure modes, and the decision rule.

Formula and decision sheet: $\sqrt{\text{variance}}$

Mistakes to avoid: Trap: Treating secondary research as a complete substitute for primary. Secondary gives breadth; primary gives depth and specificity Limitation: Cost; Risk: Significant budget for design, collection, analysis Trap: Using mean when data is heavily skewed. Median is more representative

Week 4: Marketing Mix, Creativity, and Consumer Action

Week roadmap: Module Map: Marketing Mix and Creative Execution → Marketing Mix Foundation → The Four Ps and Seven Ps in Detail → Copywriting for Marketing → Visuals, Design Principles, and Visual Cues → Creative Execution and the ABC Behaviour Model → 1 more topics.

Coverage: 7 exact source topics; definitions and mechanisms come first, followed by formulas, examples, and traps where applicable.

MKT-W04-T01 Module Map: Marketing Mix and Creative Execution

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Marketing strategy only becomes real when consumers experience a product, a price, a place to buy, a message, and a creative surface. This module connects the controllable levers of the marketing mix to the craft of words, visuals, and behaviour design that turn those levers into action

Core explanation: By the end of this module, you should be able to: Objective: 4Ps and 7Ps; What mastery looks like: Explain each P and when the extended three (people, process, physical evidence) matter Objective: Copywriting; What mastery looks like: Distinguish copy from content; apply tone, structure, and persuasion tactics Objective: Design and visual cues; What mastery looks like: Use composition and visual guidance to direct attention Objective: User behaviour; What mastery looks like: Apply the ABC model (antecedents-behaviour-consequences) to marketing interventions Concept flow: Marketing mix 4Ps/7Ps - Copywriting - Visuals and design - ABC behaviour model - Campaign decisions Foundation: Put the right product in the right place at the right price at the right time - via the marketing mix Words: Persuasive copy that drives immediate action Visuals: Design rules and cues that guide the eye Behaviour: Why people act, and how marketers design triggers and rewards

Must remember:

- Module theme: marketing mix + copy + design + behaviour
- Goal: understand 4Ps/7Ps, copy/design cues, and behaviour over time
- Mix = controllable variables that meet target needs
- Creative execution turns mix decisions into consumer experience
- ABC model links triggers, actions, and consequences for intervention design

Exam trap: Trap: Treating creative craft as separate from strategy. Mix decisions and creative execution must align Trap: Memorising the 4Ps without the service extension (7Ps). Many exam cases are service-heavy

MKT-W04-T02 Marketing Mix Foundation

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Marketing succeeds when the firm repeatedly delivers the right product, in the right place, at the right price, at the right time - at scale, and in a way that matches real consumer needs. The marketing mix is the set of levers managers control to make that balance happen Marketing mix: Controllable elements (variables) that an organisation uses to influence and meet the needs of target consumers efficiently and effectively

Core explanation: P: Product; Meaning: What is offered; What it includes in practice: Features, packaging, associated services P: Price; Meaning: Cost to the buyer / value signal; What it includes in practice: Amount charged; reflects delivered value P: Place; Meaning: Where and how it can be bought; What it includes in practice: Channels that make the offer available at the right location and time P: Promotion; Meaning: How awareness and desire are created; What it includes in practice: Media and communication channels used to promote the product Concept flow: Target consumers - Marketing mix - Product - Price - Place - Promotion - Need satisfaction + value Extended P: People; Role: Who delivers the experience Extended P: Process; Role: How delivery is standardised and managed Extended P: Physical evidence; Role: Tangible cues that make the service real As markets became more service-oriented and consumer-experience focused, product-price-place-promotion alone were incomplete. Three more controllable elements were added: Together these form the seven Ps of marketing. The original four still apply; the extra three become critical when the "product" is intangible or heavily experience-based (retail, hospitality, SaaS onboarding, consulting)

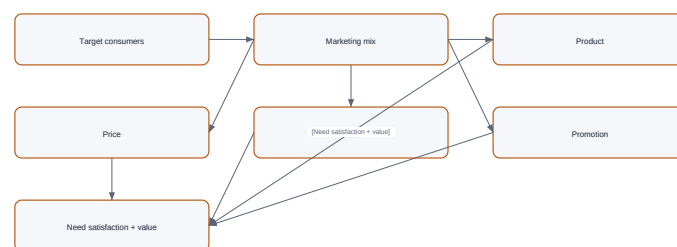
Must remember:

- Foundation idea: right product, place, price, time - consistently at scale
- Marketing mix = controllable variables to meet target needs
- Classic 4Ps: Product, Price, Place, Promotion
- Evolved 7Ps add People, Process, Physical evidence for service/experience markets
- Challenge is coordination and consumer-fit, not memorisation of labels

Example or contrast: Controllable (mix): What the firm sets - offer, price bands, channel design, messaging, staff, processes, store/app environment Not the mix: Macro forces (regulation, recession), competitor moves, and pure demand shocks - the mix responds to these; it does not invent them

Exam trap: Trap: Calling the mix a "slogan of four words." It is an operational framework for decisions that interact (e.g. premium price needs aligned product and place) Trap: Treating Place as only "physical store." Digital marketplaces, wholesale, resellers, and export are all place

Marketing Mix Foundation



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: Marketing Mix Foundation

MKT-W04-T03

The Four Ps and Seven Ps in Detail

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Each P is a decision cluster. Product answers "what do we sell?"; Price "what is the exchange?"; Place "how do they get it?"; Promotion "how do they find out and want it?" The extended Ps answer who delivers, how delivery stays consistent, and what tangible cues prove the offer is real

Core explanation: What the firm offers consumers - not only the physical good, but the full value package
 Dimension: Quality and value; Examples: Specs, durability, performance vs expectation
 Dimension: Branding and imagery; Examples: Name, logo, associations
 Dimension: User experience; Examples: Ease of use, delight in interacting with the offer
 Dimension: Key features; Examples: Differentiating capabilities
 Dimension: Warranties / trust signals; Examples: Guarantees, support promises
 Element: Pricing strategy; Role: Premium, penetration, value-based, etc
 Element: List price; Role: Stated sticker price
 Element: Discounts; Role: Temporary or segment-specific reductions
 Element: Payment methods; Role: Card, EMI, UPI, wallet - friction and access
 Element: Free elements; Role: Freemium, trials, gifts with purchase
 Element: Credit terms; Role: Pay-later, net-30
 B2B - cash-flow and risk
 Channel type: Owned digital; Examples: Company website, app
 Value exchange and cost of purchase - including all terms that change willingness to pay
 Channel type: Marketplaces; Examples: Amazon, eBay, Flipkart
 Channel type: Retail; Examples: Stores, pop-ups
 Channel type: International; Examples: Export, local partners
 Channel type: Wholesale / resellers; Examples: Indirect distribution
 Lever: Messaging; Examples: Core story and claims
 Lever: Search marketing; Examples: SEO/SEM
 How and where customers can purchase - availability at the right location and time
 Lever: Social ads; Examples: Paid social
 Lever: Direct marketing; Examples: Email, SMS, CRM
 Lever: Partnerships; Examples: Co-marketing, affiliates
 Lever: Offline; Examples: Events, OOH, PR
 Lever: Word of mouth; Examples: Organic advocacy
 Lever: Campaigns; Examples: Time-bound promotions
 How consumers discover the product and why they should care
 Concept flow: Physical evidence - Consistent consumer experience - classic - extended
 Who is hired and how they act

Must remember:

- Product = offer package (quality, brand, UX, features, trust)

- Price = value/cost including strategy, discounts, payment, credit
- Place = purchase channels (web, marketplace, retail, wholesale, export)
- Promotion = discovery and persuasion channels
- People = who delivers; Process = how delivery stays consistent
- Physical evidence = tangible cues of the experience
- 7Ps together design consistent, consumer-focused experiences

Exam trap: Trap: Reducing Product to "features only" - brand, UX, and warranties are product decisions
 Trap: Treating Price as only the number on the tag - payment methods and credit terms belong to Price

MKT-W04-T04 Copywriting for Marketing

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: The marketing mix decides what you sell and where. Copywriting decides whether strangers pause, believe, and act - buy, click, subscribe - in the moment. Words still shape how people think, feel, and behave, even when AI drafts first pass text

Core explanation: Copywriting: The art and science of writing persuasive words (copy) that prompt the reader to take an immediate action (purchase, click, subscribe, book a demo) Primary role in marketing/ads: Drive conversions via ads, landing pages, email campaigns, and web UI text Tactic: One idea per paragraph; Why it works: Easier flow; no cognitive overload Tactic: Shorter sentences; Why it works: Clarity; protects short attention spans Technology amplifies distribution; language still changes minds. Narratives colour attention and memory. Tools can draft, but marketers still need judgement on: Tactic: Simple words; Why it works: Reach and readability across audiences Brand voice fit Tactic: Transition / signal words; Why it works: Because, therefore, most importantly, besides - guide next thought Audience tone (formal vs informal) Tactic: Metaphors; Why it works: Make ideas vivid and memorable (e.g. "cold as ice") Truthful claims and differentiation Tactic: Story structure (PPT); Why it works: Place, Protagonist, Time + conflict + resolution Structure that earns the click without confusing the reader Tactic: Inverted pyramid; Why it works: Most important first - less important - details Novels, blogs, magazines, newspapers - exposure to sentence craft, joke timing, metaphor, and voice. A practical starter: Everybody Writes (Ann Handley) for clear, persuasive business writing Tactic: Vary sentence length; Why it works: Avoid monotonous rhythm

Must remember:

- Copy = persuasive words for immediate action and conversion
- Content = longer educational/trust-building writing
- Read broadly; lock formal/informal tone to brand + audience
- Clarity tactics: one idea, short sentences, simple words, transitions
- Creative spice: metaphor, PPT storytelling, inverted pyramid, varied rhythm
- Words still matter because narratives change feeling and behaviour

Example or contrast: Dimension: Goal; Copywriting: Immediate action; hook and persuade; Content writing: Inform, educate, build trust and engagement Dimension: Tone; Copywriting: Persuasive, punchy, often urgent; Content writing: Educational, narrative, informative Dimension: Length; Copywriting: Usually short: headlines, ads, CTAs, landing hero; Content writing: Longer: blogs, white papers, case studies

Exam trap: Trap: Equating copywriting with "pretty writing." Success is action, not literary praise Trap: Mixing copy and content goals on the same asset without clear hierarchy (long essay ads rarely convert)

MKT-W04-T05 Visuals, Design Principles, and Visual Cues

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Words persuade; visuals decide where the eye goes first. Design principles and subtle cues shape attention, interpretation, and action without requiring conscious analysis - like traffic signals on a road of competing page elements

Core explanation: Divide the frame into a 3x3 grid (two horizontal + two vertical lines). The four intersections are natural focus points Principle: Placement; Practice: Put key subjects on lines or intersections, not always dead centre Principle: Coverage heuristic; Practice: Subject ~33% of area; remaining ~66% breathing room Principle: Effect; Practice: Better balance; more dynamic, interesting compositions Short answer: You

can break it; Long answer: Learn the rule first; break only with intentional concept Photographers use this constantly; marketers borrow it for ads, heroes, and product shots Cue type: Eye gaze; Mechanism: Viewers follow where a depicted person looks; Example: Model looks at headline, not camera - attention shifts to text Cue type: Directional cues; Mechanism: Gestures/angles act as arrows; Example: Characters pointing arms inward - frame headline - lead to CTA Cue type: Layout / motif alignment; Mechanism: Image content reinforces message; Example: Illustration of completed building mirrors "design better buildings" copy Concept flow: Visual cue - Eye gaze / direction - Negative space focal - Image-message alignment - Directed attention - CTA / comprehension If the idea is stronger than classical composition (award-winning conceptual portraits often ignore intersections), concept can outweigh composition - but random centring without reason usually looks amateur Visual cues: Signals in design that the brain recognises quickly, shaping where attention moves and how the message is interpreted

Must remember:

- Rule of thirds: 3x3 grid; place subjects on intersections; ~1/3 subject, ~2/3 space
- Positive space = subject; negative space = surrounds that create focus
- Learn rules before intentional breaks driven by concept
- Visual cues = subconscious guides (eye gaze, directional gestures, motif alignment)
- Good design routes attention to message and CTA with clarity and calm

Example or contrast: Term: Positive space; Meaning: Primary subject - what you want noticed Term: Negative space; Meaning: Everything around the subject (often "empty" or white space) Why it works: Negative space creates a clear focal point, pulls attention to the subject, and (with rule-of-thirds placement) adds energy and premium calm. Crowded layouts compete; sparse layouts signal importance

Exam trap: Trap: Centring every subject "to be safe" - often flatter and less clear than thirds + space Trap: Filling every gap (fear of empty space) - kills hierarchy and premium feel

MKT-W04-T06

Creative Execution and the ABC Behaviour Model

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Clicks and purchases are surface behaviours. To change what people do, marketers need the story around the act: what triggered it, what the person did, and what consequence reinforced (or killed) the habit. The ABC model supplies that full picture so interventions fix the right stage

Core explanation: Letter: A; Name: Antecedents; Meaning: Events or triggers immediately before the behaviour Letter: B; Name: Behaviour; Meaning: Observable action Letter: C; Name: Consequences; Meaning: Outcomes that follow - and often reinforce - the behaviour Concept flow: Antecedent trigger - Behaviour - Consequence Symptom: People don't know you exist; Likely ABC gap: Weak A; Intervention direction: Stronger awareness cues, reach, reminders Symptom: Visitors arrive but don't buy; Likely ABC gap: Hard B; Intervention direction: Cut friction: UX, pricing clarity, checkout, trust Symptom: People buy once and never return; Likely ABC gap: Weak C; Intervention direction: Rewards, loyalty, post-purchase value, reminders to return Focusing only on B (e.g. "why didn't they buy?") misses whether the problem is missing triggers (A), friction in the act (B), or weak rewards (C) Diagnose where the funnel breaks: The model guides interventions that shape antecedents, simplify behaviour, and design consequences that reinforce desired actions Copy and ads often create or strengthen antecedents (reminders, urgency, desire) UX and design cues make the behaviour easier (clear CTA, less friction) Loyalty, status, delight, savings design consequences that retain Creative without ABC thinking can look beautiful and still fail the wrong stage

Must remember:

- ABC = Antecedents → Behaviour → Consequences
- Diagnose awareness (A), friction (B), and reward/retention (C) separately
- Interventions should target the broken stage
- Starbucks pattern: timed offer → easy reorder → skip line + points
- Creative, UX, and loyalty design map naturally onto A, B, and C

Example or contrast: Stage: A; Fast-food example: Anxiety or hunger Stage: B; Fast-food example: Eating fast food Stage: C; Fast-food example: Temporary relaxation / contentment - reinforces the habit

Exam trap: Trap: Blaming "bad creative" when the real issue is consequence (no reason to return) Trap: Flooding antecedents (more ads) when behaviour is blocked by checkout friction

Creative Execution and the ABC Behaviour Model



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: Creative Execution and the ABC Behaviour Model

MKT-W04-T07

Week Summary: Mix, Copy, Design, and Behaviour

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: This module's ideas form one stack: control the mix, persuade with copy, guide attention with design, and intervene on the right ABC stage so behaviour sticks

Core explanation: Theme: 4Ps / 7Ps; Core takeaway: Controllable levers for product, price, place, promotion + people, process, physical evidence Theme: Copywriting; Core takeaway: Persuasive short-form writing for immediate action; distinct from educational content Theme: Design foundations; Core takeaway: Rule of thirds, positive/negative space, intentional rule-breaking Theme: Visual cues; Core takeaway: Eye gaze and directional signals route attention to message and CTA Theme: ABC model; Core takeaway: Antecedents, behaviour, consequences - diagnose and design interventions Concept flow: 7Ps decisions - Copy + visuals - Attention path - Trigger act reward - Awareness conversion retention

Must remember:

- Marketing mix: right product, place, price, time via controllable Ps
- 7Ps add people, process, physical evidence for experience markets
- Copy drives action; content builds trust/education
- Visual hierarchy: thirds, space, gaze/direction cues
- ABC: fix the right stage - awareness, friction, or reward
- Apply frameworks where decisions meet consumers - campaigns, UX, loyalty

Exam trap: Trap: Revising Ps as a list without applying them to a service case (need 7Ps) Trap: Confusing copy goals with content goals

Week 4 Exam Lens

Likely questions

- Define and explain Module Map: Marketing Mix and Creative Execution; include the mechanism and one limitation.
- Compare Module Map: Marketing Mix and Creative Execution with Marketing Mix Foundation and state when each is preferred.
- Apply The Four Ps and Seven Ps in Detail to a realistic system or business scenario and justify the decision.

10-mark answer frame: Start with a precise definition; draw or state the causal flow; explain each stage and metric; add a comparison or worked example; close with trade-offs, failure modes, and the decision rule.

Mistakes to avoid: Trap: Treating creative craft as separate from strategy. Mix decisions and creative execution must align Trap: Calling the mix a "slogan of four words." It is an operational framework for decisions that interact (e.g. premium price needs aligned product and place) Trap: Reducing Product to "features only" - brand, UX, and warranties are product decisions

Week 5: Consumer Behaviour and Branding

Week roadmap: Consumer Behavior: Social and Cultural Influences → Branding: Meaning, Levels, Roles, Assets, and Vehicles → Color Psychology for Branding and Design → Brand Personality: Human Traits Brands Can Own → Brand Architecture Pyramid → Brand Development Strategy: The 2x2 Growth Grid → 2 more topics.

Coverage: 8 exact source topics; definitions and mechanisms come first, followed by formulas, examples, and traps where applicable.

MKT-W05-T01 Consumer Behavior: Social and Cultural Influences

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: People do not buy in isolation. A purchase is shaped by who they live with, who they imitate, where they sit in society, and which cultural rules feel "normal." Consumer behavior is the study of how individuals, groups, and organizations select, purchase, use, and dispose of goods, services, ideas, or experiences to satisfy needs and desires Aspect: Who; Meaning: Individuals, groups, organizations

Core explanation: Concept flow: Consumer Behavior - Psychological - Social - Cultural - Personal - Economical - Technological Factor: Psychological; Core idea: Motivation, perception, learning, attitudes Factor: Social; Core idea: Family, peers, roles, status, social proof Factor: Cultural; Core idea: Values, subcultures, social class Factor: Personal; Core idea: Age, lifestyle, occupation, self-concept Factor: Economical; Core idea: Income, price sensitivity, purchasing power Factor: Technological; Core idea: Devices, platforms, access to information Element: Family; How it influences buying: Foundation for early preferences and brand habits; Example: Parents choose toothpaste brand; children often stick with it later Element: Reference groups & social networks; How it influences buying: Peers and circles set norms for what to wear, use, or try; Example: Teenagers buy clothing brands to fit in with friends Element: Roles and status; How it influences buying: Products signal social position and life stage; Example: Adults join a gym or take up hobbies that match their circle Element: Social proof; How it influences buying: Reviews and endorsements from similar or admired people reduce risk; Example: Positive reviews or influencer endorsements drive purchase Concept flow: Culture: shared values and beliefs - Subcultures: ethnicity, religion, region, shared interests - Social class: buying power, brand preference, consumption patterns Social and cultural factors are especially powerful because they operate before the shopper reaches a product page - they shape what feels acceptable, desirable, and "for people like me." Level: Culture; Definition: Shared values, beliefs, and habits of a society; Marketing implication: Messaging must fit cultural norms (e.g., family first vs self-expression) Social factors shape early preferences and ongoing buying habits through relationships and social position Level: Subculture; Definition: Groups defined by ethnicity, religion, geography, or shared interest; Marketing implication: Same product, different rituals or language of benefit Level: Social class; Definition: Position related to income, education, occupation; Marketing implication: Affects brand preference, channel, and consumption pattern Key insight: People trust those they perceive as similar to themselves. Endorsements work less because of celebrity fame alone and more because of perceived similarity or aspirational identity Influence: Social; Primary mechanism: Relationships and status signals; Typical outcome: Brand choice to belong or stand out Culture shapes values, beliefs, and habitual buying patterns. It operates at several nested levels Influence: Cultural; Primary mechanism: Shared meaning and class norms; Typical outcome: What is considered appropriate or aspirational

Must remember:

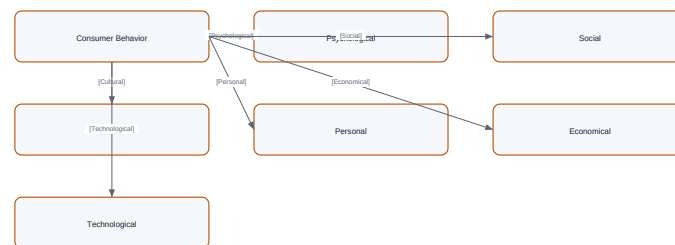
- Consumer behavior = how people/groups/orgs select, purchase, use, dispose to satisfy needs
- Six factors: psychological, social, cultural, personal, economical, technological
- Social: family, reference groups, roles/status, social proof
- Culture → subcultures → social class shape values and buying power signals
- Collectivist cultures prioritize group benefit; individualist cultures prioritize self-expression
- People trust reviewers/endorsers who feel similar to them
- Social + cultural forces often override purely rational product comparisons

Example or contrast: Cultural orientation: Collectivist; Decision style: Choices that benefit family or group; Buying lean: Joint decisions; products framed as family good Cultural orientation: Individualist;

Decision style: Personal preference and self-expression; Buying lean: Unique identity; products as personal statement

Exam trap: Trap: Treating consumer behavior as only "why someone clicked buy." It covers select, purchase, use, and dispose Trap: Listing only personal or psychological factors and ignoring social/cultural drivers (family, class, collectivism)

Consumer Behavior: Social and Cultural Influences



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermald visual

Concept map: Consumer Behavior: Social and Cultural Influences

MKT-W05-T02

Branding: Meaning, Levels, Roles, Assets, and Vehicles

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: A logo is not a brand. Color, symbol, and packaging are brand communication assets. A brand is the perception people hold in their minds - how they think and feel about a product or company. You can influence that perception; you cannot fully control it. Like raising a child, experiences accumulate into an image you guide but do not own completely Level: 1. Attributes; Meaning: Tangible or technical traits; Example angle: Technology superiority, ease of use

Core explanation: Concept: Brand (formal); Definition: Name, term, sign, symbol, design - or a combination - that identifies one seller's goods/services and differentiates them from competitors Concept: Brand as promise; Definition: Seller's commitment to deliver a consistent set of features, benefits, and service Concept: Brand image; Definition: Perception built from many small experiences over time Concept: Not just; Definition: Color, logo, or slogan alone (those are communication assets) Concept flow: Logo / color / slogan - Repeated experiences - Brand perception in mind - Trust, loyalty, premium Role: Identify source; Why it matters: Assign responsibility for performance to a maker/distributor Role: Ethical evaluation; Why it matters: Same product type may be judged differently once branded Role: Learn from experience; Why it matters: Past use + marketing teach which brands satisfy needs Role: Simplify decisions; Why it matters: Time-starved buyers use brands as shortcuts Role: Reduce risk; Why it matters: Familiar brand lowers fear of a bad purchase Role: Handling & tracing; Firm benefit: Organize inventory and accounting Role: Legal protection; Firm benefit: Trademark (name), patents (process), copyright/design (packaging) Role: Quality signal; Firm benefit: Credible brand - easier repurchase Role: Demand security; Firm benefit: Loyalty creates predictable demand Role: Barriers to entry; Firm benefit: Harder for new rivals to steal share Role: Price premium; Firm benefit: Loyal buyers often pay ~20-25% more than competing brands As lives get busier, the brand's ability to simplify choice and reduce risk becomes more valuable than another feature bullet Layer: Meaning levels; Question: What do we stand for - attributes through to users? Layer: Consumer roles; Question: Do we reduce risk and simplify choice? Layer: Firm roles; Question: Are we protected, loyal, and premium-capable? Layer: Assets + vehicles; Question: Are visual/verbal assets expressed in strong market experiences? Intellectual property makes brand investment safer: firms can build equity knowing competitors cannot legally copy protected elements

Must remember:

- Brand = identification + differentiation + consistent promise; image = lived perception
- Six meaning levels: attributes → benefits → values → culture → personality → user
- For consumers: identify source, learn from experience, simplify, reduce risk
- For firms: tracing, IP protection, quality signal, loyalty, entry barriers, price premium
- Loyal customers often accept ~20-25% higher prices

- Assets = color/symbol/slogan; vehicles = trucks, billboards, cards, sponsorships
- Influence perception through experiences - you cannot fully dictate it

Formula / decision rule: 20; 25%

Example or contrast: Concept: Brand asset; Definition: Element that carries brand identity (color, symbol, shape, slogan); Examples: Coca-Cola bottle silhouette; UPS Pullman brown; Mastercard interlocking circles; Red Bull "gives you wings" Concept: Brand vehicle; Definition: Physical or experiential expression in the market; Examples: 3D Times Square billboard; UPS delivery trucks; plastic Mastercard; Red Bull space jump sponsorship Concept flow: Brand asset: bottle / color / slogan - Brand vehicle: retail / truck / event - Stronger brand perception

Exam trap: Trap: Defining a brand as only logo/color. Those are assets; the brand is perception + promise Trap: Skipping levels - talking only about attributes without benefits, culture, personality, or user

MKT-W05-T03

Color Psychology for Branding and Design

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Color is not decoration - it is a shortcut to emotion. Color psychology is a framework for choosing which color (and which shade) to use so that the vibe matches the message: trust, passion, creativity, calm, or mystery

Core explanation: Question: Which color when?; Color psychology answers: Match emotion/vibe to context Question: What does it evoke?; Color psychology answers: Different hues trigger different feelings Question: Do shades matter?; Color psychology answers: Yes - moving along a hue changes the emotion Color family: Red (and its shades); Typical vibe: Excitement, passion, desire - intensity shifts with shade Color family: Blue; Typical vibe: Trustworthy technology; reliability Color family: Violet; Typical vibe: Creativity Color family: Green; Typical vibe: Reassurance, nature Concept flow: Choose hue - Tint or shade - Target emotion / vibe - Brand or product feel Examples of hue associations (guidance, not absolute law): Point: Nature; Detail: No chromatic hue; strong visual impact via contrast Point: Audience pattern; Detail: Men generally tolerate achromatic palettes more than women Point: Use cases; Detail: Luxury minimalism, tech, premium packaging, high-contrast type Achromatic colors = colors without hue: black, white, and grays Influencer of interpretation: Personal experience; Effect: Same red can mean love or danger for different people Influencer of interpretation: Upbringing; Effect: Learned associations override textbook wheels Simple does not mean weak - black/white/gray can dominate perception when used deliberately Influencer of interpretation: Cultural background; Effect: Colors carry different meanings across cultures Influencer of interpretation: Mood in the moment; Effect: Same palette can feel different today vs tomorrow Step: 1; Action: Define the emotion you want (trust, energy, calm, luxury) Step: 2; Action: Pick a hue family that usually supports that vibe Step: 3; Action: Decide intensity: bright vs soft for audience Human perception is complex. Color-emotion links are not universal Step: 4; Action: Decide tint (soft/youthful) vs shade (deep/mysterious) Step: 5; Action: Validate against culture and category norms - then test Color psychology is useful guidance, not a guarantee. Individual perception and momentary mood always mediate the result

Must remember:

- Color psychology = framework for matching color/shade to emotion and context
- Red → passion/desire; blue → trustworthy tech; violet → creativity; green → nature/reassurance
- Men often prefer brighter intensity; women more often prefer softer colors
- Achromatic = black, white, gray (no hue); men often tolerate them more
- Tint = + white (soft, youthful); shade = + black (deep, mysterious)
- Women generally prefer tints over shades more than men
- Associations are guidance - experience, culture, and mood always mediate

Example or contrast: Research points to a pattern shared across genders for light vs dark, with divergence on intensity: Dimension: Light vs dark; Finding: Men and women generally share similar preferences Dimension: Implication; Finding: Gender-skewed packaging or UI may lean bright vs soft accordingly - but test, don't stereotype blindly

Exam trap: Trap: Treating color associations as universal laws. Culture, mood, and experience break the wheel Trap: Confusing tint (add white) with shade (add black)

MKT-W05-T04

Brand Personality: Human Traits Brands Can Own

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Brand personality is the moment a brand becomes humanized. It is the set of human traits that define how a brand behaves and communicates. When a brand feels human, people connect more naturally and emotionally - the same way they relate to a friend's character, not a feature list
Term: Brand personality; **Meaning:** Human traits and characteristics that describe how a brand behaves and communicates

Core explanation: Social psychologist Jennifer Aaker identified five key dimensions used to measure brand personality: Concept flow: Brand Personality - Sincerity - Excitement - Competence - Sophistication - Ruggedness
Dimension: Sincerity; **Feels like:** Genuine, pure-hearted; **Traits in practice:** Honest, warm, joyful; **Brand examples:** Disney, Amazon, Cadbury
Dimension: Excitement; **Feels like:** Adventurous, energetic; **Traits in practice:** Creative, bold, modern, vibrant; **Brand examples:** Coca-Cola, Nike, Red Bull, Tesla
Dimension: Competence; **Feels like:** Trustworthy, capable; **Traits in practice:** Intelligent, reliable, expert, efficient; **Brand examples:** Microsoft, Google
Dimension: Sophistication; **Feels like:** Elegant, high-class; **Traits in practice:** Luxurious, prestigious, refined taste; **Brand examples:** Gucci, Apple, Tiffany, Rolex
Dimension: Ruggedness; **Feels like:** Outdoorsy, tough; **Traits in practice:** Strong, resilient, durable; **Brand examples:** Timberland, Jeep, Marlboro, Harley-Davidson
 A sincere brand communicates honestly, with warmth and joy. It feels "good-hearted" rather than edgy or cold
Fit: Family brands, everyday treats, customer-obsessed service brands
Decision question: Who are we for?; **Practical test:** Which traits would our ideal user claim as their own? An exciting brand feels energetic and alive - often creative, bold, and modern
Decision question: Can we own it?; **Practical test:** Do product, packaging, ads, and service all agree? **Fit:** Sports, soft drinks, energy, innovation-forward tech
Decision question: Distinct vs rivals?; **Practical test:** Does a competitor already own this dimension in the category? A competent brand signals expertise and reliability: "this will work." **Decision question:** Measurement; **Practical test:** Rate the brand (and rivals) on each of the five dimensions
Fit: Productivity software, search, enterprise tools, professional services
 A sophisticated brand projects elegance, luxury, and refined taste
Related concept: Six levels of brand meaning; **How personality connects:** Personality is one of the six meaning levels
Fit: Fashion, jewelry, premium devices, status categories
Related concept: Brand architecture pyramid; **How personality connects:** Personality sits near the emotional / essence layers
 A rugged brand feels outdoorsy and resilient - toughness and durability
Related concept: Color and design; **How personality connects:** Visual system should reinforce chosen traits
Fit: Outdoor footwear, off-road vehicles, bold lifestyle brands
 Brands can emphasize more than one trait, but a muddled mix (e.g., cheap and ultra-luxury cues together) weakens recognition

Must remember:

- Brand personality = human traits that make the brand feel human and emotionally connectable
- Measured via Aaker's five: sincerity, excitement, competence, sophistication, ruggedness
- Sincerity: Disney, Amazon, Cadbury
- Excitement: Coca-Cola, Nike, Red Bull, Tesla
- Competence: Microsoft, Google
- Sophistication: Gucci, Apple, Tiffany, Rolex
- Ruggedness: Timberland, Jeep, Marlboro, Harley-Davidson
- Consistency across touchpoints is what makes personality believable

Exam trap: Trap: Listing random adjectives instead of Aaker's five: sincerity, excitement, competence, sophistication, ruggedness
 Trap: Treating personality as logo redesign alone - behavior and communication must match

MKT-W05-T05

Brand Architecture Pyramid

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: The brand architecture pyramid (also called brand pyramid or brand hierarchy) organizes brand identity from the concrete to the ethereal. At the base sit tangible features and

benefits; at the peak sits intangible brand essence. Strong brands climb the pyramid coherently so customers remember not just what the product does but what the brand means

Core explanation: Concept flow: Brand core / essence - Brand personality - Emotional benefits - Functional / product benefits - Features and attributes Level (bottom - top): Features & attributes; Nature: Tangible; Role: What the product has Level (bottom - top): Functional / product benefits; Nature: Practical; Role: What it does or delivers Level (bottom - top): Emotional benefits; Nature: Feeling; Role: How it makes the customer feel Level (bottom - top): Brand personality; Nature: Character; Role: Human traits of the brand Level (bottom - top): Brand core / essence; Nature: Meaning; Role: Enduring idea / positioning rally cry Build clear features and benefits at the base; elevate them into a powerful essence at the top Brand: Indi Go; Base focus: On-time, clean, courteous, low-cost performance; Peak essence: Dream of flying for every Indian; sincere + fun Brand: Apple; Base focus: Design, OS, security, ease; Peak essence: Think different Brand: Disney; Base focus: Family entertainment quality; Peak essence: Magical / happiest place Benefit: Organization; Explanation: Forces clarity from features - meaning Benefit: Elevation; Explanation: Prevents stuck-at-features branding Benefit: Consumer connection; Explanation: Emotional and essence layers build lasting preference Benefit: Consistency; Explanation: Personality and essence guide campaigns and product choices Same pyramid logic - different category truths and emotional peaks A brand that only advertises features is stuck at the base. A brand that claims "magical" without delivery at the base feels hollow

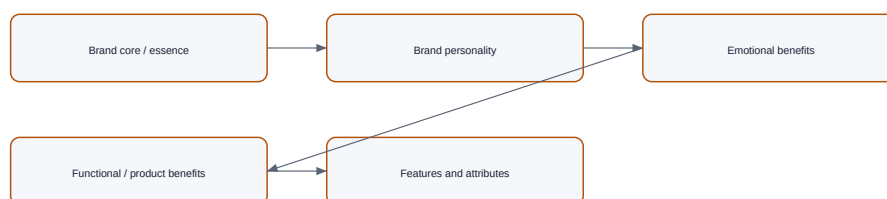
Must remember:

- Brand architecture pyramid = hierarchy from tangible features up to intangible essence
- Levels: features → functional benefits → emotional benefits → personality → core/essence
- IndiGo: on-time/low-cost performance → sincere, fun, fly-for-everyone dream
- Apple: design/security/ease → think different; sophisticated, creative personality
- Disney: family content quality → magic/happiness; playful, nostalgic personality
- Strong brands build clear bases and rise to a memorable essence
- Use the pyramid to organize identity and tighten consumer connection

Example or contrast: Level: Features & benefits; Content: On-time performance, courteous staff, spotless interiors Level: Functional benefits; Content: Low-cost airline with high performance Level: Emotional benefits; Content: Affordable and dependable

Exam trap: Trap: Reversing the pyramid - treating essence as a product feature Trap: Confusing functional benefits with emotional benefits (e.g., "low cost" vs "dependable/affordable feeling")

Brand Architecture Pyramid



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: Brand Architecture Pyramid

MKT-W05-T06

Brand Development Strategy: The 2x2 Growth Grid

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: When a company launches something new, the first strategic fork is: stretch the existing brand, or birth a new one - and stay in the same category, or enter a new one. The brand development 2x2 grid maps those choices so marketers pick a path that matches brand strength, market position, and risk appetite

Core explanation: Axes: brand (existing vs new) x category (existing vs new) Concept flow: Line extension: existing brand + existing category - Brand extension: existing brand + new category - Multibrand: new

brand + existing category - New brand: new brand + new category Strategy: Line extension; Brand name: Same; Category: Same (new formats/variants); Classic example: Coca-Cola - Diet Coke, Cherry Coke, Coke Zero Strategy: Brand extension; Brand name: Same; Category: New; Classic example: Dove - Dove Men+Care (e.g., men's shampoos/care) Strategy: Multibrand; Brand name: New; Category: Same; Classic example: Unilever launching multiple shampoo brands for shelf space Strategy: New brand; Brand name: New; Category: New; Classic example: Typical startup launch; radical innovations as a clean slate : Why choose it; : Low cost; reuses packaging systems, recognition, and trust; keeps brand feeling fresh : Risk; : Cannibalization - new SKU steals sales from existing SKUs : Why choose it; : Instant credibility from known brand; cheaper than building a brand from zero : Risk; : Failure can damage or dilute the parent brand's reputation : Why choose it; : Capture more shelf space and multiple price segments; stronger category presence : Risk; : Internal competition - own brands fight each other for the same shopper Same brand, same category, new formats or variants : Why choose it; : Clean slate free of old associations; fits radical innovation or high-risk markets : Risk; : Heavy spend to build awareness, trust, and presence Same brand name enters a new category Factor: Strong equity + close fit to current category; Favors: Line extension Factor: Strong equity + meaningful fit to a new category; Favors: Brand extension Factor: Need for distinct price tiers / shelf control; Favors: Multibrand New brand names inside an existing category the company already plays in Factor: Radical break / toxic or mismatched associations; Favors: New brand Factor: Low budget / need speed; Favors: Line or brand extension Factor: High risk tolerance + large investment; Favors: New brand (or carefully chosen multibrand) Entirely new brand in a completely new category Concept flow: New product / service idea - Stay in same category? - Use existing brand name? - Use existing brand name? - Line extension - Multibrand - Brand extension - New brand

Must remember:

- Brand development grid = existing/new brand x existing/new category
- Line extension: Diet/Cherry/Zero Coke - same brand, same category, new formats
- Brand extension: Dove into men's care - same brand, new category
- Multibrand: Unilever's many shampoo brands - new brands, same category
- New brand: new name + new category - clean slate, high cost
- Watch cannibalization (line), dilution (brand extension), internal rivalry (multibrand)
- Choose based on brand strength, market position, and risk appetite

Example or contrast: Strategy: Line extension; Category: Existing; Brand: Existing; Key upside: Cheap, fresh, trusted; Key downside: Cannibalization Strategy: Brand extension; Category: New; Brand: Existing; Key upside: Credibility transfer; Key downside: Dilution / reputation risk Strategy: Multibrand; Category: Existing; Brand: New; Key upside: Shelf + price coverage; Key downside: Internal rivalry

Exam trap: Trap: Swapping line vs brand extension. Line = same category, new format; brand extension = new category, same name Trap: Calling Unilever's many shampoos a "line extension." Same category + new brand names = multibrand

MKT-W05-T07 Purchase Decision Involvement and Problem-Solving

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Not every purchase deserves the same mental effort. Buying a lunchtime soft drink is almost automatic; buying a car or a house is not. Involvement and perceived risk decide whether the shopper glides on habit or works through extended problem-solving Term: Routine / habitual behavior; Definition: Automatic purchases based on limited or past information

Core explanation: Mode: Extended problem-solving; When it appears: High risk or high uncertainty; How the consumer decides: Gather information; carefully evaluate options; Example angle: Car, home, insurance Mode: Limited problem-solving; When it appears: Impulse or moderate situations; How the consumer decides: Decide quickly with less information; Example angle: Many impulse buys Mode: Routine problem-solving; When it appears: Brand loyalty / familiar purchase; How the consumer decides: Rely on past experience and trust; almost automatic; Example angle: Loyalty to Diet Coke at lunch If the shopper feels: Low stakes, familiar brand; They tend to use: Routine response behavior If the shopper feels: Some novelty, but not life-changing; They tend to use: Limited problem-solving (including impulse) If the shopper feels: High stakes,

high uncertainty; They tend to use: Extended problem-solving Decision type: Routine / low involvement; Marketer focus: Habit cues, packaging recognition, shelf presence, reminders, keep friction near zero Decision type: Limited / impulse; Marketer focus: Point-of-purchase, scarcity or offer triggers, simplify choice Decision type: Extended / high involvement; Marketer focus: Comparison content, proofs, guarantees, demos, reviews, sales assistance Rule of thumb: Level of involvement + perceived risk → amount of effort in the purchase decision Routine response is not lazy buying in a negative sense - for low-involvement categories, it is efficient. Brands that win loyalty become the routine Pushing "long form education" at a habitual soft-drink buy wastes attention. Underinvesting in proof for insurance or autos loses the sale

Must remember:

- Involvement + perceived risk set how hard consumers think
- Low involvement → routine/habitual (e.g., Diet Coke at lunch)
- High involvement → extended problem-solving (car, house, insurance)
- Three modes: extended, limited (incl. impulse), routine (loyalty-driven)
- Extended: high risk/uncertainty → research and compare
- Limited: quick decisions with less information
- Routine: past experience + trust → nearly automatic purchase

Example or contrast: Dimension: Behavior; Low involvement: Routine / habitual; High involvement: Extended problem-solving Dimension: Risk if wrong; Low involvement: Low; High involvement: High Dimension: Complexity; Low involvement: Simple; High involvement: Complex

Exam trap: Trap: Equating "cheap" alone with low involvement. Familiarity and risk also matter Trap: Calling every fast purchase "routine." Impulse often sits under limited problem-solving

MKT-W05-T08

Psychological Principles: Thinking Fast and Slow

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Most buying happens on mental autopilot. Daniel Kahneman's Thinking, Fast and Slow frames two systems: a fast, intuitive System 1 (~95% of thinking) and a slow, analytical System 2 (~5%). Marketers who understand that split can design choices that feel easy - or that nudge risk, value, and urgency Response: System 1 jump; Calculation: Ball = 0.10, bat = 1.10; Result: Total = 1.20\$ (wrong)

Core explanation: Tactic: Time pressure; Mechanism: Less room for System 2; Example angle: Limited-time offers Tactic: Deplete System 2; Mechanism: Fatigue reduces scrutiny; Example angle: Cookie offer at 8 p.m. vs 8 a.m Tactic: Raise cognitive load; Mechanism: Multitasking - instinct; Example angle: Decisions while distracted Tactic: Simplify choice sets; Mechanism: Lower paradox of choice; Example angle: Curated few options vs huge assortment Assortment: 24 jams; Shoppers who stopped: 60%; Shoppers who bought: 3% Offer: Price A; Sticker story: 500\$; Felt deal: Fair / ordinary Offer: Price B; Sticker story: Was 1{,}000, now 500; Felt deal: Bargain (same final price) Goal for many retail and CPG contexts: make the preferred option easy for System 1 without requiring a spreadsheet Fewer options → fewer browsers but much higher conversion. More choice can reduce purchase likelihood Marketing takeaway: Curation often beats endless shelves People judge value relative to a reference (anchor), not in isolation Identical final price; the struck-through anchor makes B feel better Product comparison pattern: Show the most expensive smartphone first. Mid and base models then feel more affordable by contrast Principle: System 1 dominance; Design lever: Defaults, familiar brands, simple cues People generally try to limit losses; losses loom larger than equivalent gains (loss aversion) Principle: Fatigue / load; Design lever: Timing and environment of the ask Principle: Paradox of choice; Design lever: Fewer SKUs on display; guided selling Principle: Anchoring; Design lever: Compare-at prices; premium-first assortments Principle: Loss aversion; Design lever: Frame inaction as ongoing loss

Must remember:

- System 1: fast, automatic, ~95%; System 2: slow, effortful, ~5%
- Bat-and-ball: correct ball = 0.05, not 0.10
- Time pressure, fatigue, and cognitive load push System 1 decisions
- Jam study: 24 options → 3% buy; 6 options → 30% buy

- Anchoring: INR / \$ compare-at prices make identical deals feel better
- Show premium options first so others feel affordable
- Loss aversion: "stop losing" often beats "save"; gain frames favor safer choices
- Risk attitude varies by situation for the same person

Formula / decision rule: 95%; 5%

Example or contrast: Dimension: Speed; System 1: Fast; System 2: Slow Dimension: Style; System 1: Intuitive, instinctive, automatic; System 2: Analytical, deliberate Dimension: Conscious effort; System 1: Low / unconscious; System 2: High effort

Exam trap: Idea: Risk spectrum; Meaning: Some people avoid risk; others accept it Idea: Same person, different contexts; Meaning: Can be cautious and risky depending on domain

Week 5 Exam Lens

Likely questions

- Define and explain Consumer Behavior: Social and Cultural Influences; include the mechanism and one limitation.
- Compare Consumer Behavior: Social and Cultural Influences with Branding: Meaning, Levels, Roles, Assets, and Vehicles and state when each is preferred.
- Apply Color Psychology for Branding and Design to a realistic system or business scenario and justify the decision.

10-mark answer frame: Start with a precise definition; draw or state the causal flow; explain each stage and metric; add a comparison or worked example; close with trade-offs, failure modes, and the decision rule.

Formula and decision sheet: 20; 25%; 95%; 5%

Mistakes to avoid: Trap: Treating consumer behavior as only "why someone clicked buy." It covers select, purchase, use, and dispose Trap: Defining a brand as only logo/color. Those are assets; the brand is perception + promise Trap: Treating color associations as universal laws. Culture, mood, and experience break the wheel

Week 6: Pricing Strategy, Sales, and Channel Decisions

Week roadmap: Pricing Strategy: Module Overview → Pricing Concepts: What Price Really Means → Price vs Promotion → Pricing Strategies from a Marketer's Perspective → Pricing Strategies from an Economist's Perspective → Price Elasticity of Demand → 4 more topics.

Coverage: 10 exact source topics; definitions and mechanisms come first, followed by formulas, examples, and traps where applicable.

MKT-W06-T01 Pricing Strategy: Module Overview

Tier C

Definition and why it matters: Price is not a label on a shelf - it is a strategic lever that shapes revenue, perception, and competitive position. This module builds a complete pricing toolkit: what price is, how it differs from promotion, how marketers and economists approach it differently, how demand responds to price changes (elasticity), and how customer lifetime value guides long-term pricing across business models

Core explanation: By the end of this module, you should be able to: Objective: Master key pricing concepts; Why It Matters: Separate costing (reality) from pricing (strategy)

Must remember:

- Module focus: price vs promotion, dual pricing perspectives, elasticity, and CLV
- Price captures value; promotion creates communication and demand
- Marketers balance cost floor, value ceiling, and competition
- Economists focus on surplus capture and segment-based extraction
- Elasticity links price changes to demand and revenue outcomes
- CLV shifts pricing from transaction thinking to relationship economics

Example or contrast: Lens: Marketer; Focus: Perceived value, positioning, competition, mix; Decision Style: Floor/ceiling thinking; brand and mix levers

Exam trap: Trap: Treating this module as "just discounting." Pricing includes floors, ceilings, discrimination, and lifetime value - not only promotions Trap: Confusing price with promotion. They are related mix elements with different primary roles and P&L impact

MKT-W06-T02 Pricing Concepts: What Price Really Means

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Price is often reduced to "what we charge," but strategically it is the total value consumers exchange for the benefits they receive. Cost tells you what you must cover to stay alive; price tells you how you choose to compete and position. Confusing the two produces weak strategy Framing: Monetary; Meaning: Rupees/dollars on the tag; Example: Coffee priced at INR 200

Core explanation: Approach: Cost-led only; Logic: $\text{Cost} + \text{markup} = \text{price}$; Risk: Ignores willingness to pay; may underprice luxury or overprice commodities Approach: Strategy-led; Logic: Start from value, competition, goals; check costs remain viable; Risk: Requires research and discipline Example: A handmade bag may cost INR 800 to make. Costing says you need at least that plus margin. Pricing asks whether the brand story, craftsmanship, and scarce design support INR 4,000 - or whether a commodity bag in a crowded aisle can only clear INR 900 Cost sets a constraint, not a positioning statement Price communicates quality, status, and segment fit Strategy connects price to brand, demand, and profit goals - not only accounting recovery

Must remember:

- Price = money charged, or total value exchanged for benefits
- Costing = what you must cover (reality)
- Pricing = how you position to meet goals and expectations (strategy)
- Cost constrains; it does not automatically determine market price
- Strong pricing starts from customer value and market position, then checks cost viability

Example or contrast: These are distinct concepts. Mixing them is a classic failure mode Concept: Costing; Nature: Reality; Question It Answers: What must we cover to produce or deliver? Concept: Pricing; Nature: Strategy; Question It Answers: How do we position the offer to hit business goals and customer expectations?

Exam trap: Trap: Defining price only as "money charged." The stronger definition includes total exchange value for benefits Trap: Treating costing and pricing as synonyms. Costing is reality; pricing is strategy

MKT-W06-T03 Price vs Promotion

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Price and promotion both sit in the marketing mix, but they do different jobs. Price captures value in the exchange. Promotion creates communication and demand. Treating a discount campaign as "pricing strategy" - or expecting ads alone to fix a broken price - confuses the levers and muddies P&L diagnosis

Core explanation: If margins collapse, audit price and mix before blaming "weak creatives." If awareness is low but price is fair, invest in promotion If customers desire the brand but balk at checkout, reassess price-value fit (or justify price with stronger value cues) Chronic deep discounting can train customers to wait - blurring price and promotion roles and eroding the price ceiling

Must remember:

- Price captures value; promotion creates communication and demand
- Price: monetary value of exchange; direct revenue/margin impact; signals worth/status
- Promotion: communicate and persuade; usually expense for growth; builds awareness/desirability
- Diagnose problems by which lever is broken - not by adding more of the wrong one
- Discounts often blur the line; exam answers should still separate roles clearly

Example or contrast: Dimension: Primary role; Price: Sets the monetary value of the exchange; Promotion: Communicates and persuades consumers Dimension: Impact on bottom line; Price: Directly influences revenue and profit margins; Promotion: Usually an expense aimed at longer-term growth, not instant profit Dimension: Consumer perception; Price: Shifts perceived worth or status of the product; Promotion: Influences awareness and desirability

Exam trap: Trap: Saying promotion "makes profit directly." Promotion is typically an expense for growth; price hits revenue and margins more directly Trap: Equating a discount with pricing strategy. A discount is often a promotional tactic that temporarily changes effective price

MKT-W06-T04 Pricing Strategies from a Marketer's Perspective

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Every workable price sits between a floor and a ceiling. Costs set the floor (below which profit vanishes). Customer perceived value sets the ceiling (above which buyers walk away). Competition and strategy fill the zone in between. Marketer pricing frameworks are ways of navigating that zone deliberately - not guessing a number

Core explanation: Concept flow: Product costs = Price floor - Perceived value = Price ceiling - Competition + demand + marketing strategy - Feasible price zone - Chosen price Force: Product costs; Bound: Floor; Meaning: Minimum to stay profitable Force: Consumer perception of value; Bound: Ceiling; Meaning: Maximum consumers will pay Force: Competition & external factors; Bound: Mid-zone; Meaning: Competitor prices, demand, own marketing strategy Effective pricing finds a level customers see as valuable while keeping the business profitable Stance: Above competitors; Signal / Goal: Premium quality Stance: Below competitors; Signal / Goal: Attract cost-conscious buyers Stance: At parity; Signal / Goal: Align with market expectations Works best when: Products are nearly identical (commodities, fuel, generic groceries); Risk: Continuous undercutting - price wars where no one makes a profit Example: Cinema; Added value that justifies price: Luxury reclining seats + gourmet snacks Example: Software; Added value that justifies price: 24/7 dedicated human support in the package Prices are set mainly from the prevailing market rate. A firm may price: Condition for success: Strong high-quality image; Why: High price must feel deserved Condition for success: Enough early adopters wanting the product immediately; Why: First-wave revenue exists Price often becomes the main differentiator in homogeneous markets - which is why wars escalate quickly Enhance the offer with features, benefits, or experiences that justify a higher price versus cheaper alternatives. Goal: increase pricing power so buyers stop comparing you as a pure commodity Dimension: Initial price; Skimming: High; Penetration: Low Dimension: Primary aim; Skimming: Maximise early surplus / segment skim; Penetration: Share, scale, deter rivals Dimension: Later move; Skimming: Price steps down; Penetration:

Often price steps up after lock-in Launch at a high price, then gradually reduce to "skim" successive segments - from those willing to pay most down to more price-sensitive buyers Dimension: Typical fit; Skimming: Innovation with strong image; Penetration: Markets where scale and network matter Situation: Strong brand, rare experience, inelastic segment; Lean toward: Value-based / skimming Situation: Commodity, transparent rivals; Lean toward: Competition-based (with war caution) Example: Smartphones launch at premium; older models discount as new generations arrive - capturing value across the life cycle Situation: Need rapid share and unit cost decline; Lean toward: Penetration Set a low initial price to attract many buyers quickly and win market share. High volume enables economies of scale; thin margins discourage entry

Must remember:

- Floor = costs; ceiling = perceived value; middle = competition and strategy
- Cost-based: product → cost → price → convince value
- Value-based: value → target price → allowable cost → design product
- Competition-based follows market rates; best for near-identical goods; watch for wars
- Value-added builds pricing power through extras that block cheap comparisons
- Skimming: high then down by segment; penetration: low then scale (and often later increases)

Example or contrast: Aspect: Starting point; Cost-based: Product and internal cost; Value-based: Customer needs and perceived value Aspect: Sequence; Cost-based: Design product - calculate cost - set price - convince buyers of value; Value-based: Understand value - set target price - determine allowable cost - design product to deliver at that price Aspect: Driver; Cost-based: Internal cost structure; Value-based: Customer expectations and perceived value

Exam trap: Trap: Reversing cost-based and value-based sequences. Cost-based starts with product/cost; value-based starts with perceived value and target price Trap: Saying competition-based pricing always means pricing below rivals. It can be above, below, or at parity

MKT-W06-T05

Pricing Strategies from an Economist's Perspective

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Where marketers talk floors, ceilings, and brand, economists ask: how much consumer surplus can the seller capture? The toolkit centres on charging different prices to different buyers (or self-selected behaviours), splitting fees, bundling products, and using discounts as screening devices. Same SKU, different extraction logic Concept flow: Price Discrimination - 1st degree: individual WTP - 2nd degree: self-select by quantity / version - 3rd degree: observable segments

Core explanation: Charge each consumer their maximum willingness to pay (WTP) Result: Consumer surplus - 0; Implication: Producer captures all surplus Classic form: Personalised haggling (flea market); fees tailored to client capacity (e.g. high-end legal services); Modern form: Dynamic pricing algorithms using browsing, history, and behaviour to personalise price Logic: More volume - lower unit price; Example: Buy one at 10, second at 5; wholesale bulk packs Segment elasticity: More inelastic; Price: Higher price Segment elasticity: More elastic (price-sensitive); Price: Lower price Example: Student discounts; senior movie tickets; Rationale: Higher elasticity / lower WTP Example: Business-class fares; Rationale: More inelastic demand (urgency, employer pay) Often called the economist's "holy grail" - powerful in theory, hard to achieve perfectly in practice Seller does not know each buyer's exact WTP. Instead, a schedule lets customers self-select by how much they consume. Unit price falls as quantity rises Component: Fixed fee; Role: Captures "entry" / access value Component: Usage fee; Role: Covers incremental consumption Captures extra value from high-volume users without needing person-by-person WTP knowledge Divide the market by observable traits (age, location, status). Segments differ in price elasticity; sellers charge: Consumer effect: Higher perceived value / "deal" feeling; Firm effect: Higher items per transaction; sells add-ons buyers might skip a la carte Mechanism: Coupons / rebates (effort required); Who self-selects in: Price-sensitive buyers who will invest effort Total price = fixed access fee + variable usage fee Mechanism: No coupon / full price; Who self-selects in: Time-poor buyers who value convenience over search Tool: 1st degree / dynamic personalisation; When it fits: Granular WTP signals available Example: Gym monthly membership (access) + charges for personal training or specialty classes (usage) Tool: 2nd degree; When it fits: Heterogeneous usage; versioning or quantity breaks work Two or more distinct products sold as one combined offer Tool: 3rd degree; When it

fits: Clear segments with different elasticities Tool: Two-part tariff; When it fits: Access + variable use (gyms, utilities, platforms) Example: McDonald's Value Meal - burger + fries + drink cheaper together than as three separate full-price items Tool: Bundling; When it fits: Complements; raise perceived value and attach rate Discounts separate buyers by how they trade time vs money Tool: Effort / seasonal discounts; When it fits: Screen by time sensitivity or demand seasonality Seasonal / temporal pricing: hotels charge more in peak season and lower rates off-season to fill rooms when demand drops

Must remember:

- Price discrimination = different prices for the same product by WTP or behaviour
- 1st degree: individual max WTP; consumer surplus ≈ 0
- 2nd degree: self-select via quantity/version; unit price falls with volume
- 3rd degree: segment by traits; price high for inelastic, low for elastic groups
- Two-part tariff = fixed access + variable use
- Bundling packages products to lift perceived value and volume
- Coupons/rebates and seasonal rates screen buyers tactically

Formula / decision rule: 10; ≈ 0

Exam trap: Trap: Mixing degrees - 1st is individual WTP; 2nd is self-selection by quantity/version; 3rd is group/segment traits Trap: Claiming 1st degree always raises consumer surplus. It drives consumer surplus toward zero

MKT-W06-T06 Price Elasticity of Demand

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Pricing without elasticity is guessing. Price elasticity of demand measures how strongly quantity demanded reacts when price changes. If buyers bolt at a small hike, demand is elastic. If they barely flinch, demand is inelastic. Revenue strategy flips depending on which world you are in

Core explanation: Concept: Price; Meaning: Amount charged for a product or service Concept: Demand; Meaning: Need + ability + willingness to pay - all three required Concept: Elasticity; Meaning: Degree to which quantity demanded responds when price changes Concept flow: Need - Ability to pay - Willingness to pay - Price change - Elasticity - Demand - Revenue impact : $Ed > 1$; Ed : Elastic: $Ed < 1$; Ed : Inelastic $Ed = 1$; Ed : Unitary Price elasticity of demand (Ed or PED): Price move: Increase P; Typical revenue effect: Total revenue falls $Ed = \frac{\% \text{ change in quantity demanded}}{\% \text{ change in price}}$ Price move: Decrease P; Typical revenue effect: Total revenue rises Using relative changes: $Ed = \frac{\Delta Q / Q}{\Delta P / P}$ (Demand curves usually slope down, so Ed is often discussed with absolute value.) Consumers are highly sensitive to price. A small price increase can cause a large drop in quantity demanded Price move: Any change in P; Revenue effect: Total revenue unchanged Common when: many substitutes exist (e.g. a specific brand of bottled water) Consumers are less sensitive. Quantity demanded falls only slightly even if price rises a lot Common when: necessities (insulin, gasoline), addictive goods (tobacco), or few/no substitutes Percentage change in price is matched by an equal percentage change in quantity demanded Often framed as a balance / "sweet spot" for thinking about revenue maximisation. Example framing: petrol for commuters with a roughly fixed monthly fuel budget - spend stays relatively constant as price wiggles Suppose $P = 100$, $Q = 50$, so revenue $R = P \times Q = 5000$ Elastic case: price +10% ($P=110$), quantity -20% ($Q=40$) $\rightarrow R = 4400$ (down) Inelastic case: price +10% ($P=110$), quantity -5% ($Q=47.5$) $\rightarrow R = 5225$ (up) Unitary: price +10%, quantity -10% $\rightarrow R$ unchanged Elastic markets punish arrogant markups; compete on value and substitutes Inelastic markets reward careful premiumisation (ethically and legally constrained for true necessities) Unitary thinking reminds you that not every price move "grows the top line."

Must remember:

- Demand type: Elastic; Raise price: Revenue down; Lower price: Revenue up
- Demand type: Unitary; Raise price: Revenue unchanged; Lower price: Revenue unchanged
- Concept flow: Demand type? - Prefer lower price to grow revenue - Higher price can grow revenue - Revenue flat at the margin
- $Ed = (\% \Delta Q) / (\% \Delta P)$; also $Ed = (\Delta Q / Q) / (\Delta P / P)$

- Elastic ($|E_d| > 1$): price up $\rightarrow$ revenue down; many substitutes
- Inelastic ($|E_d| < 1$): price up $\rightarrow$ revenue up; needs, addiction, few substitutes
- Unitary ($|E_d| = 1$): revenue unchanged with price moves
- Demand = need + ability + willingness; elasticity governs price-quantity response
- Match price moves to elasticity type before expecting revenue gains

Formula / decision rule: E_d ; $E_d = \frac{\% \text{ change in quantity demanded}}{\% \text{ change in price}}$

Exam trap: Trap: Saying "elastic means revenue always rises with price." For elastic demand, raising price typically cuts revenue Trap: Confusing need with inelasticity forever. Brands of a commodity can be elastic even if the category (water) is needed

MKT-W06-T07 Why Price Elasticity Matters for Marketers

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Great marketing often aims to make demand more inelastic - so strong preference that price becomes secondary. Elasticity is not only a homework formula; it tells you whether to promote hard on price, raise margins, skim a launch, or differentiate to escape price wars

Core explanation: Marketing can be framed as making a product so desirable that demand becomes inelastic: consumers want your brand enough that small price gaps hurt less Brand strength: Weak / commodity; Typical price sensitivity: High elasticity; Pricing room: Compete on deals; thin margin risk Brand strength: Strong preference / unique; Typical price sensitivity: Lower elasticity; Pricing room: Premium and margin expansion possible Sign / pattern: Positive $E(AB)$; Relationship: Substitutes (rival's price up - your demand up) Sign / pattern: Negative $E(AB)$; Relationship: Complements (other's price up - your demand down) Concept flow: Rival raises price - Cross-price effect - If substitutes: our demand rises - If complements: our demand may fall - Defend or harvest share Goal / context: Grow market share; Elasticity picture: High elasticity markets; Typical move: Aggressive price promotions Goal / context: Grow profit margins; Elasticity picture: Less elastic demand; Typical move: Raise prices; premium / luxury positioning Goal / context: New product launch; WTP uncertain; Elasticity picture: Elasticity unknown; Typical move: Price skimming to reveal max willingness to pay Cross-price elasticity measures how demand for product A changes when the price of product B changes Goal / context: Defend vs rivals / substitutes; Elasticity picture: Pressure from comparison; Typical move: Differentiation to cut direct price comparisons and lower sensitivity $E(AB) = \frac{\% \text{ change in quantity demanded of A}}{\% \text{ change in price of B}}$ Marketers use this when a competitor raises price: Will share shift to us? How much? Promotion is especially potent when demand is elastic and share is the KPI Premium positioning works when brand work has already reduced elasticity Skimming is a learning and surplus tool under uncertainty Differentiation is the anti-elasticity weapon against substitutes

Must remember:

- Strong marketing often aims to make demand more inelastic
- Cross-price elasticity: $\%QA / \%PB$ - substitutes vs complements
- High elasticity + share goal $\rightarrow$ aggressive price promotions
- Low elasticity + margin goal $\rightarrow$ raise price, premium positioning
- Uncertain launch elasticity $\rightarrow$ skimming to discover WTP
- Rival/substitute pressure $\rightarrow$ differentiate to reduce price comparison

Formula / decision rule: $E_{(AB)} = \frac{\% \text{ change in quantity demanded of A}}{\% \text{ change in price of B}}$; $E_{(AB)}$

Example or contrast: Scenario: Two nearly identical snack brands; Elasticity logic: High own-price and cross-price sensitivity; Action: Promo wars common; differentiation (flavour, occasion, pack) needed to escape Scenario: Iconic sports shoe with few true substitutes; Elasticity logic: Relatively inelastic core fans; Action: Margin via price rises + storytelling; promo more about drop culture than deep cuts Scenario: Entering a new SaaS category; Elasticity logic: Unknown elasticity; Action: Skim tiers or geo prices to learn WTP before broad penetration

Exam trap: Trap: Treating own-price elasticity and cross-price elasticity as the same. Own-price: your P vs your Q. Cross-price: their P vs your Q Trap: Saying marketers always want elastic demand. Often the goal is to reduce sensitivity (make demand more inelastic)

MKT-W06-T08

Customer Lifetime Value and Competitive Pricing Strategy

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: A price that looks winning on a single order can still lose the war. Customer lifetime value (CLV / LTV) asks how much a customer is worth across the entire relationship - after acquisition and service costs. Competitive pricing strategy that ignores CLV optimises for the wrong customer: the deal-chaser who churns before you recover CAC

Core explanation: Customer lifetime value (CLV) is the total revenue (and, in net form, profit) a business can expect from a customer over the full relationship. It is forward-looking: not only past spend, but expected future value. Focus shifts from one-off transactions to long-term engagement and repeat purchase Lens: Transaction; Question: Did this sale clear margin today? Lens: Lifetime; Question: Will this relationship repay acquisition and serving costs and still earn? A practical form: Metric: Average purchase value; Definition / idea: Total revenue number of purchases; Why it matters: Size of each buy $CLV(net) = (Average\ revenue\ per\ customer \times Customer\ lifespan) - Total\ cost\ to\ serve$ Metric: Purchase frequency; Definition / idea: How often a customer buys in a period; Why it matters: Repeat engine Gross before costs: Metric: Customer lifespan; Definition / idea: Average length of relationship; Why it matters: Duration of revenue $CLV(gross) = Average\ revenue\ per\ customer \times Customer\ lifespan$ Metric: Churn rate; Definition / idea: % who stop buying / cancel over time; Why it matters: Inverse of retention Works best with reliable history and a fairly consistent pricing model Metric: Customer profitability score; Definition / idea: Revenue vs cost to serve; Why it matters: High-touch vs low-touch accounts Metric: User adoption (digital subs); Definition / idea: Active engagement over time; Why it matters: Usage predicts renewal Metric: Engagement score; Definition / idea: Logins, events, interactions; Why it matters: Leading indicator of retention Metric: Product expansion; Definition / idea: Growth across offerings, not only spend; Why it matters: Cross-sell / upsell upside Pricing move: Deep intro discount; CLV caution: May attract Claire-type churners; watch payback Pricing move: Premium / value-based price; CLV caution: Can raise ARPU if retention holds Pricing move: Penetration / free trial; CLV caution: Only works if conversion to loyal cohorts is high Pricing move: High CAC channels; CLV caution: Need higher CLV or shorter payback to justify Together these metrics help predict and improve CLV - which in turn disciplines acquisition bids, discount depth, and service investment

Must remember:

- CLV = value expected across the full customer relationship (forward-looking)
- Same price != same CLV - retention and costs decide profit
- Simple net form: $(ARPU-like\ revenue \times lifespan) - cost\ to\ serve$
- Track AOV/purchase value, frequency, lifespan, churn, profitability, adoption, engagement, expansion
- Price and promo decisions should be judged by cohort CLV, not first-order alone
- Competitive pricing wins when it builds lukes, not only converts claires

Formula / decision rule: 50; 70

Example or contrast: Assume a subscription at 50\$ per month. Three archetypes: Customer: Cautious Claire; Behaviour: Cancels after first delivery; Lifetime revenue: 50; Economics after costs: CAC 70+ serve25 - firm loses 45 Customer: Experimental Eric; Behaviour: Cancels after second payment; Lifetime revenue: 100; Economics after costs: Still loses 20 after acquisition and two months of product/shipping

Exam trap: Trap: Equating CLV with last month's revenue. CLV spans the relationship, often including expected future value Trap: Using only gross CLV. Net CLV subtracts cost to serve (and strategy must also face CAC)

MKT-W06-T09

Netflix vs Nykaa: Lifetime Value Across Business Models

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: CLV formulas look similar until you ask how revenue is earned. Netflix is a subscription machine: fixed monthly fee, value grows mainly with months retained. Nykaa is a transactional

retail machine: no fixed spend ceiling - value grows with basket size, order frequency, and relationship length. Same metric, different engines, different pricing and marketing priorities

Core explanation: Dimension: Model; Netflix (subscription): Recurring membership fee; Nykaa (transactional / retail): Discretionary orders over time Dimension: Spend ceiling; Netflix (subscription): Relatively fixed by plan price; Nykaa (transactional / retail): No clear ceiling; baskets vary Dimension: CLV core logic; Netflix (subscription): Monthly fee x months subscribed; Nykaa (transactional / retail): AOV x orders per period x relationship length Dimension: Predictability; Netflix (subscription): Relatively high; Nykaa (transactional / retail): Wider variance across customers Concept flow: Monthly fee - Months retained - LTV - AOV - Order frequency - Relationship length - LTV $LTV \approx \text{Monthly subscription fee} \times \text{Number of months retained}$ Question: Raise price?; Netflix implication: Watch churn; need content and habit strength; Nykaa implication: Can raise effective revenue via mix, bundles, premium brands without changing "plan" Transactional retail (Nykaa-style): Question: Discount?; Netflix implication: Intro offers must convert to retained months; Nykaa implication: Promos may lift frequency/AOV but train deal-seeking $LTV \approx \text{Average order value (AOV)} \times \text{Orders per period} \times \text{Length of relationship}$ Question: Product work that lifts LTV; Netflix implication: More must-watch content; reduce fatigue; Nykaa implication: Merchandising, personalisation, loyalty that raise AOV and return rate (Periods can be month, quarter, or year - stay consistent.) Netflix-style: fee = INR 650/month, retained 14 months $\rightarrow LTV \approx 650 \times 14 = \text{INR } 9(,)100$ (gross, before costs) Nykaa-style: AOV = INR 1(,)800, 6 orders/year, 3 years $\rightarrow LTV \approx 1(,)800 \times 6 \times 3 = \text{INR } 32(,)400$ (gross) Different knobs: months vs AOV x frequency x years When evaluating LTV for any firm, always ask: How does the company generate revenue (subscription vs transactional)? What keeps customers engaged over time (habit/content vs discovery/desire)? Which KPI is the truth metric (churn vs AOV/frequency)? What risk kills the relationship (fatigue vs price switching)?

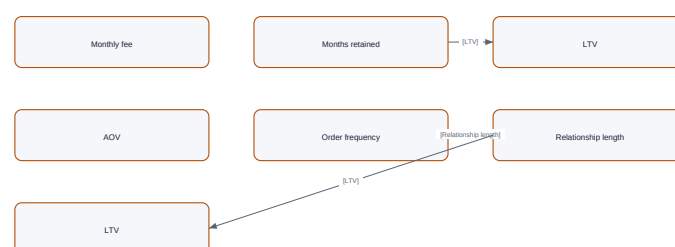
Must remember:

- Netflix: subscription $LTV \approx \text{monthly fee} \times \text{months retained}$; growth via retention; watch churn; risk = content fatigue
- Nykaa: retail $LTV \approx \text{AOV} \times \text{order frequency} \times \text{relationship length}$; growth via basket + frequency; watch AOV; risk = price switching
- Marketing: Netflix $\rightarrow$ habit/essential; Nykaa $\rightarrow$ discovery and desire
- Always tie LTV math to the revenue model before recommending price moves
- Same CLV concept; different engines and KPIs

Formula / decision rule: $LTV \approx \text{Monthly subscription fee} \times \text{Number of months retained}$; $LTV \approx \text{Average order value (AOV)} \times \text{Orders per period} \times \text{Length of relationship}$

Exam trap: Lens: Revenue growth driver; Netflix: Retention - longer subscriptions - more revenue; Nykaa: Basket size + purchase frequency - how much and how often Lens: Primary metric; Netflix: Churn rate (cancels); Nykaa: Average order value (AOV)

Netflix vs Nykaa: Lifetime Value Across Business Models



Vector reconstruction of the source Mernail visual

Concept map: Netflix vs Nykaa: Lifetime Value Across Business Models

MKT-W06-T10

Week 6 Summary: Pricing Strategy Toolkit

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: This week's ideas form one chain: define price correctly, separate it from promotion, choose marketer and economist tools deliberately, read elasticity before moving price, then judge success by lifetime value - not only the first sale. Flexible problem-solving means picking the right link in that chain for each case

Core explanation: Concept flow: What is price? - Price vs promotion - Marketer strategies - Economist strategies - Price elasticity - Strategy by elasticity - Customer lifetime value - Subscription vs retail LTV Idea: Price; Takeaway: Money charged or total value exchanged for benefits Idea: Costing vs pricing; Takeaway: Costing = reality (must cover); pricing = strategy (positioning + goals) Strategy: Three forces; Core idea: Cost floor, value ceiling, competition in between Strategy: Cost-based; Core idea: Product - cost - price - convince value Strategy: Value-based; Core idea: Value - target price - allowable cost - design Strategy: Competition-based; Core idea: Set vs market rate; war risk in commodities Strategy: Value-added; Core idea: Extras create pricing power Strategy: Skimming; Core idea: High then step down by segment Strategy: Penetration; Core idea: Low then scale (margins thin; deter entry) Tool: 1st degree; Core idea: Individual max WTP; surplus - seller Tool: 2nd degree; Core idea: Self-select by quantity/version Tool: 3rd degree; Core idea: Segments by elasticity Tool: Two-part tariff; Core idea: Fixed access + usage fee Tool: Bundling; Core idea: Package to lift perceived value and volume Tool: Tactical discounts; Core idea: Screen by time vs money; seasonal demand Type: Elastic; Price up - revenue: Down Type: Inelastic; Price up - revenue: Up Type: Unitary; Price up - revenue: Unchanged Situation: High elasticity, share goal; Move: Aggressive price promos Situation: Low elasticity, margin goal; Move: Raise price / premium Situation: Uncertain launch WTP; Move: Skimming to learn Situation: Substitute pressure; Move: Differentiate $E_d = \frac{\Delta Q}{\Delta P}$ Model: Subscription (Netflix-like); LTV shape: Fee x months; Primary focus: Retention / churn Model: Retail (Nykaa-like); LTV shape: AOV x frequency x lifespan; Primary focus: Basket + repeat Problem framing: "Is this cost or market/value logic?"; Reach for: Costing vs pricing; cost- vs value-based Problem framing: "Ads vs list price?"; Reach for: Price vs promotion table Problem framing: "Same product, different prices?"; Reach for: Degrees of discrimination / discounts Problem framing: "Should we raise price?"; Reach for: Elasticity - revenue table Problem framing: "Rival just raised price?"; Reach for: Cross-price + differentiation Cross-price: $E_{AB} = \frac{\Delta Q_A}{\Delta P_B}$ Problem framing: "Aggressive acquisition OK?"; Reach for: CLV vs CAC / cost to serve $CLV(\text{net}) \approx (\text{Revenue per customer} \times \text{Lifespan}) - \text{Cost to serve}$

Must remember:

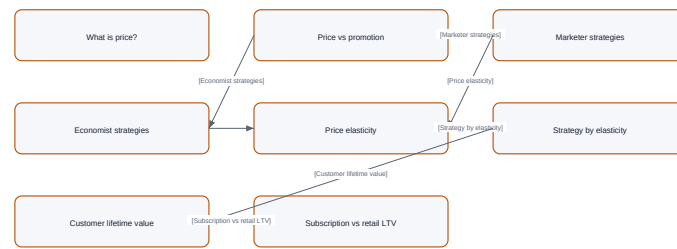
- Price = exchange value; costing constrains, pricing strategises
- Price captures value; promotion builds demand and awareness
- Marketers: floor/ceiling + cost, value, competition, skim, penetrate, value-add
- Economists: discrimination degrees, two-part tariffs, bundling, tactical discounts
- Elasticity links ΔP to ΔQ and revenue; marketing often seeks more inelastic demand
- CLV forces long-horizon thinking; Netflix-like vs Nykaa-like engines use different LTV knobs
- Use the right tool from this toolkit for the problem - that is flexible marketing judgment

Formula / decision rule: $E_d = \frac{\Delta Q}{\Delta P}$; $E_{AB} = \frac{\Delta Q_A}{\Delta P_B}$

Example or contrast: : Role; Price: Monetary value of exchange; Promotion: Communicate and persuade : P&L; Price: Direct on revenue/margins; Promotion: Usually expense for growth : Perception; Price: Worth / status; Promotion: Awareness / desirability

Exam trap: Trap: Equating costing with pricing, or promotion with permanent pricing strategy Trap: Reversing cost-based and value-based sequences

Week 6 Summary: Pricing Strategy Toolkit



Vector reconstruction of the source Memmalt visual

Concept map: Week 6 Summary: Pricing Strategy Toolkit

Week 6 Exam Lens

Likely questions

- Define and explain Pricing Concepts: What Price Really Means; include the mechanism and one limitation.
- Compare Pricing Concepts: What Price Really Means with Pricing Strategies from a Marketer's Perspective and state when each is preferred.
- Apply Pricing Strategies from an Economist's Perspective to a realistic system or business scenario and justify the decision.

10-mark answer frame: Start with a precise definition; draw or state the causal flow; explain each stage and metric; add a comparison or worked example; close with trade-offs, failure modes, and the decision rule.

Formula and decision sheet: $E_d \sim 0$; $E_d = \frac{\% \text{ change in quantity demanded}}{\% \text{ change in price}}$; $E_{AB} = \frac{\% \text{ change in quantity demanded of A}}{\% \text{ change in price of B}}$; 50; 70

Mistakes to avoid: Trap: Treating this module as "just discounting." Pricing includes floors, ceilings, discrimination, and lifetime value - not only promotions Trap: Defining price only as "money charged." The stronger definition includes total exchange value for benefits Trap: Saying promotion "makes profit directly." Promotion is typically an expense for growth; price hits revenue and margins more directly

Week 7: Product, Market, and Growth Strategy

Week roadmap: Developing a Marketing Strategy - Module Overview → Blue Ocean vs Red Ocean Strategy → Product Life Cycle → Modelling Perceived Risk for Consumers → Internal vs External Consumer Problems → Sales vs Marketing → 2 more topics.

Coverage: 8 exact source topics; definitions and mechanisms come first, followed by formulas, examples, and traps where applicable.

MKT-W07-T01 Developing a Marketing Strategy - Module Overview

Tier C

Definition and why it matters: Strategy is not a list of tactics. It is a thinking framework for reading the market environment, matching product stage to the right moves, reducing consumer uncertainty, and aligning sales with marketing so execution converts demand into revenue Question: Where is the competition?; Why it matters: Crowded fight vs open space changes the whole plan

Core explanation: Capability: Market environment; Focus: Compete in crowded markets vs create uncontested ones Capability: Product-market life cycle; Focus: How products evolve and how strategy shifts by stage

Must remember:

- Module lens: market environment + lifecycle + perceived risk + sales/marketing + sales tactics
- Red vs blue ocean: compete for existing demand vs create new demand
- PLC stages change marketing mix priorities
- Reduce consumer uncertainty to raise purchase intention
- Marketing builds demand; sales converts it
- Sales techniques must fit market conditions and priorities
- Outcome: frameworks to analyse markets and link strategy to execution

Exam trap: View purchases from the consumer's uncertainty Model risk types and use strategy and communication to lower hesitation

MKT-W07-T02 Blue Ocean vs Red Ocean Strategy

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Competition is not always about beating rivals at the same game. Red oceans are crowded pools where firms fight over existing demand; blue oceans are open waters where firms create new demand so that competition becomes less relevant - at least for a while

Core explanation: Kim and Mauborgne (Chan Kim and Renee Mauborgne) use red and blue oceans to describe the market universe Ocean: Red ocean; Meaning: All industries that exist today - known market space; Nature of competition: Industry boundaries clear; rivals fight for share Ocean: Blue ocean; Meaning: Industries that do not yet exist - unknown market space; Nature of competition: Little or no direct rivalry; new demand created Concept flow: Existing industries - Fight for share - Profits shrink - Unexplored space - Create new demand - Value innovation - Blue - Red Known market space with defined industry boundaries Dimension: Market stance; Red ocean strategy: Compete in existing markets; Blue ocean strategy: Create new market space Firms compete to outperform rivals and capture existing demand Dimension: Demand; Red ocean strategy: Exploit existing demand; Blue ocean strategy: Generate and capture new demand As rivalry intensifies, the "water turns red": crowded markets, cutthroat tactics, shrinking profits Dimension: Competitive goal; Red ocean strategy: Outperform rivals; Blue ocean strategy: Make competition irrelevant Growth is limited because everyone fights over the same consumers Dimension: Value-cost logic; Red ocean strategy: Choose differentiation or low cost; Blue ocean strategy: Break the trade-off - pursue both Example: Budget airlines and mid-range airlines competing on routes, fares, and ancillaries in a saturated corridor Dimension: Focus model; Red ocean strategy: Cost differential / beat rivals; Blue ocean strategy: Value max - raise buyer value Unexplored, largely untouched market spaces Dimension: Risk over time; Red ocean strategy: Crowding and shrinking opportunity; Blue ocean strategy: Attracts imitators; space fills up Instead of stealing demand from rivals, firms unlock new demand Offer room for profitable growth that saturated markets cannot Example: Cirque du Soleil reframing circus entertainment by combining theatre and spectacle

without animal shows - creating a new kind of experience rather than out-clowning traditional circuses

Concept flow: Raise buyer value - Value innovation - Lower cost structure - New demand + new market space

Blue ocean logic rests on value innovation: Raise buyer value (differentiation) Reduce cost simultaneously Align activities so the firm is not stuck choosing only one side of the classic trade-off

Red ocean mindset: Keep costs low and win within a cost-differential competition model

Blue ocean mindset: Create more value for the buyer, open new demand, and leave the head-to-head fight No. A forever-uncontested space is a myth

A firm creates a blue ocean and value becomes visible Competitors notice and enter

Must remember:

- Red ocean: known markets, fight for existing demand, profits pressured
- Blue ocean: unexplored space, create new demand, competition less relevant
- Red strategy: outperform rivals; choose differentiation or low cost
- Blue strategy: value innovation - differentiation and low cost
- Blue oceans are temporary; successful ones attract competitors and redden
- Key skill: keep creating and refreshing value, not clinging to one blue space

Example or contrast: Situation: Mature category, clear rivals, share battles; Lean toward: Red ocean tools (cost, differentiation, efficiency) Situation: Underserved jobs-to-be-done, new combinations of value; Lean toward: Blue ocean (redefine boundaries, create demand) Situation: Your "new" category is already copying others; Lean toward: Likely already reddening - innovate again

Exam trap: Trap: Equating blue ocean with "any innovation." Blue ocean means new market space and new demand, not a minor feature update in a crowded category Trap: Saying blue oceans last forever. They turn red as imitators arrive

MKT-W07-T03

Product Life Cycle

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Products do not stay "new" forever. Sales and profits follow a path - introduction, growth, maturity, decline - and the right pricing and promotion at launch can decide whether the product ever reaches a strong growth phase

Core explanation: Stage: Introduction; Sales: Low; Profits: Often negative (heavy spend); Marketing focus: Awareness, trial, investment recovery Stage: Growth; Sales: Rapid rise; Profits: Rising as payoffs begin; Marketing focus: Scale, preference, prepare for rivals Stage: Maturity; Sales: Peak, then slow growth; Profits: Peak, then pressure; Marketing focus: Efficiency, differentiation, defend share Stage: Decline; Sales: Falling; Profits: Falling; Marketing focus: Harvest, cut cost, or exit

Concept flow: Introduction - Growth - Maturity - Decline

Strategy: Rapid skimming; Price: High; Promotion: High; Core aim: Recover investment fast + build strong awareness

Strategy: Slow skimming; Price: High; Promotion: Low; Core aim: Profit from early adopters with light marketing spend

Strategy: Rapid penetration; Price: Low; Promotion: High; Core aim: Win share quickly via fast adoption

Strategy: Slow penetration; Price: Low; Promotion: Low; Core aim: Gradual entry with low risk and low cost

Concept flow: Promotion - High - Price Condition: Market awareness; Application: Large portion still unaware Condition: Buyer type; Application: Aware buyers are early adopters willing to pay more

Typical drivers of decline: saturation, shifting needs, better substitutes

Condition: Competition; Application: Expected soon - build brand preference quickly

At introduction, firms combine price (high/low) and promotion (high/low) into four strategies:

Condition: Objective; Application: Recover launch investment; establish brand before rivals

Condition: Market size; Application: Relatively small

Condition: Awareness; Application: Most potential buyers already know the product

Condition: Price willingness; Application: Buyers accept a high price

Condition: Competition; Application: Not imminent - no rush to overspend on promotion

Condition: Objective; Application: Gradual profit with low marketing cost

Condition: Market size; Application: Large

Condition: Awareness; Application: Most consumers still unaware

Example: A premium new smartphone launched with heavy ads and a high launch price to early enthusiasts

Condition: Price sensitivity; Application: High - low price drives trial

Condition: Competition; Application: Expected to intensify - early share matters

Condition: Cost dynamics; Application: Unit costs fall as scale/experience grows

Condition: Objective; Application: Strong early presence; prepare for rivalry

Example: A niche B2B instrument sold to specialists who already know the category, with limited advertising

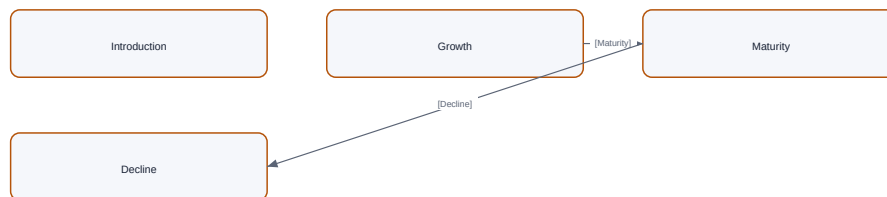
Condition: Awareness; Application: High category awareness already Condition: Price sensitivity; Application: High - low price needed Condition: Promotion; Application: Limited spend Condition: Competition; Application: Present but not requiring aggressive marketing Condition: Advantage; Application: Pioneer advantage - early enough to lock a base Condition: Objective; Application: Steady growth without heavy investment or price wars Example: A new streaming app in a price-sensitive market launching cheaply with aggressive user acquisition spend Stage: Growth; Typical strategic shift: Capitalise on adoption; differentiate as rivals arrive Stage: Maturity; Typical strategic shift: Defend share; improve efficiency; refresh differentiation

Must remember:

- PLC: introduction → growth → maturity → decline
- Intro: low sales, often negative profits; decline: sales and profits fall
- Rapid skimming: high price + high promo - reclaim cost, build awareness before rivals
- Slow skimming: high price + low promo - small informed market, delayed rivalry
- Rapid penetration: low price + high promo - large unaware, price-sensitive market
- Slow penetration: low price + low promo - large aware, price-sensitive market; pioneer advantage
- Match aggressiveness to awareness, size, price sensitivity, and competitive threat

Exam trap: Trap: Mixing up skimming and penetration. Skimming = high price; penetration = low price
 Trap: Equating "rapid" only with low price. Rapid skimming is high price + high promotion

Product Life Cycle



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: Product Life Cycle

MKT-W07-T04

Modelling Perceived Risk for Consumers

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Buyers do not only ask "Is this good?" - they ask "What could go wrong for me?" Perceived risk is the personal sense of uncertainty or possible harm after buying. Higher risk means more research, more delay, and stronger preference for trusted brands Concept flow: High perceived risk - More search and advice - Prefer reputable brands - Purchase intention rises if risk falls

Core explanation: Insight: Risk is perceived, not only objective; Action: Communication can change behaviour even when specs are fixed Insight: Luxury / high involvement - high risk; Action: Expect longer journeys; design trust assets early Insight: New brands start at a trust deficit; Action: Over-invest in proof, guarantees, and social evidence Insight: One lever rarely enough; Action: Match the dominant risk type for the category

Must remember:

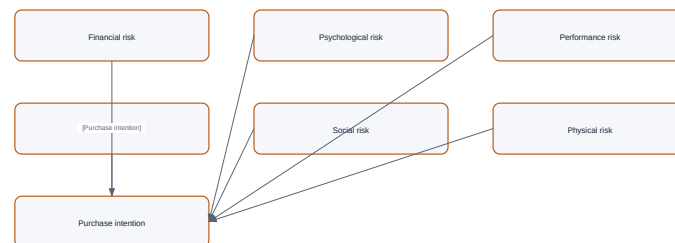
- Perceived risk = subjective uncertainty about negative purchase outcomes
- Higher for costly/luxury goods → more research and brand reliance
- Types: functional, financial, social, physical, time, psychological
- Dimensions jointly shape purchase intention
- Reduce via trials, refunds, testimonials, certifications, convenience, identity/CSR alignment
- Goal: build trust so willingness to buy rises

Example or contrast: Product: Electric scooter; Dominant risks: Physical, financial, performance; Typical risk-reduction moves: Safety certs, warranty, test rides Product: Online MBA course; Dominant risks:

Financial, time, psychological; Typical risk-reduction moves: Free modules, alumni stories, clear career outcomes
 Product: Fashion luxury bag; Dominant risks: Social, financial; Typical risk-reduction moves: Brand heritage, authenticity guarantees, peer reviews

Exam trap: Dimension: Financial; Consumer fear: Money lost if product fails expectations; Effect on decision: Hesitation on expensive buys
 Dimension: Psychological; Consumer fear: Regret, emotional dissatisfaction; Effect on decision: Guilt or identity conflict after purchase

Modelling Perceived Risk for Consumers



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: Modelling Perceived Risk for Consumers

MKT-W07-T05

Internal vs External Consumer Problems

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: We often design funnels as if people buy through cold logic - compare features, then decide. Most purchases run on emotion, intuition, and quick feelings. Surface complaints are external problems; the deeper drivers - fear, desire, identity - are internal problems. Marketing that only mirrors the surface message misses why people actually say yes

Core explanation: Assumption (how we think they buy): Long rational evaluation; Reality (how they often buy): Fast emotional triggers
 Assumption (how we think they buy): Feature comparison first; Reality (how they often buy): Feeling and intuition first
 Assumption (how we think they buy): Linear logic to "yes"; Reality (how they often buy): Emotion guides, then reasons justify
 Understanding the gap lets marketers craft messages that connect emotionally and guide consumers toward a decision
 Step: Capture both layers; Practice: Map external claim internal motivation for the segment
 Listen for the external problem (easy language)
 Step: Lead with emotion; Practice: Hook identity/fear/desire first
 Dig for the internal struggle (identity, belonging, status, fear of missing out, clutter, loneliness)
 Step: Support with product truth; Practice: Features prove you can solve the external job
 Speak to the deeper driver while remaining credible on the surface
 need Step: Stay specific; Practice: Vague "inspiration" without a product fit feels manipulative
 Customers narrate the external problem; the internal problem is the real force behind the decision
 Example: Travel brand for festival loneliness - creative about reunion and shared tables; landing page with group packages and flexible dates that make reunion logistics easy
 Feature-only messaging assumes a rational buyer who rarely exists
 Competitors can copy features faster than emotional positioning if you own the internal job
 Insight quality determines whether campaigns feel "about me" or about SKUs

Must remember:

- People often buy emotionally; rational steps are frequently post-hoc
- External = visible, easy-to-state symptom
- Internal = deeper fear, desire, or identity behind the symptom
- Customers talk external; decisions run on internal
- Map both layers to design communication and strategy
- Examples: backpack → authentic self; art skill → artist identity; trip → belonging

Example or contrast: : Nature; External problem: Visible symptoms on the surface; Internal problem: Deeper causes behind the symptoms : How expressed; External problem: Easy to say out loud; Internal problem: Often hidden (shame, embarrassment, unawareness, complexity) : Role in talk; External problem: What customers claim they need; Internal problem: What actually forces the decision

Exam trap: Trap: Treating internal and external as rival frameworks. External is the symptom; internal is the cause - use both Trap: Equating "emotional buying" with irrational waste. Emotion is the primary path; reason often justifies after

MKT-W07-T06 Sales vs Marketing

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Sales and marketing are not rival tribes. Marketing finds needs, builds awareness, and creates demand; sales converts that demand into purchases. In that sense, sales is part of marketing - a promotional, action-oriented tool that turns strategy into closed deals

Core explanation: Concept flow: Marketing: create and nurture demand - Sales: convert demand to purchase - Revenue and relationships Misconception: separate and competing functions. Reality: sales operates within the broader marketing system Dimension: Primary goal; Marketing: Brand awareness / demand generation; Sales: Lead conversion Dimension: Target focus; Marketing: Audience segmentation; Sales: Personalised outreach to specific prospects Dimension: Time horizon; Marketing: Longer-term (visibility, pipeline); Sales: Shorter-term (close now) Dimension: KPIs; Marketing: Traffic, visibility, MQLs; Sales: SQLs, deals closed, revenue Dimension: Channels; Marketing: Websites, ads, SEO, webinars, events; Sales: Emails, calls, demos, meetings Capability area: Insight; Marketing strength: Analytical thinking (data - strategy); Sales strength: Active listening (uncover client needs) Capability area: Communication; Marketing strength: Broad audience messaging; Sales strength: One-to-one prospect dialogue Capability area: Knowledge systems; Marketing strength: Consumer / segment knowledge; Sales strength: CRM - track interactions and relationships Capability area: Creative / close; Marketing strength: Creativity for campaigns and positioning; Sales strength: Negotiation to finalise agreements Capability area: Opportunity response; Marketing strength: Problem solving when markets shift; Sales strength: Networking to expand pipeline Capability area: Technical craft; Marketing strength: CMS, SEO, social, analytics; Sales strength: Product knowledge and pitching Stage: Attract and educate; Owner: Marketing; Typical outcome: Awareness, interest, MQLs Both are designed to work together to drive business results Stage: Qualify and deepen; Owner: Shared / sales; Typical outcome: SQL readiness

Must remember:

- Sales is part of marketing: converts demand created by marketing
- Marketing: awareness, segmentation, long horizon, MQLs, broad channels
- Sales: conversion, personalised outreach, short horizon, SQLs/revenue, direct interaction
- Skills differ in application but both need strong communication
- Together: marketing generates leads; sales closes deals

Example or contrast: Context: B2B SaaS; Marketing does: SEO, webinars, case studies - MQLs; Sales does: Discovery calls, demos, contract negotiation Context: Auto dealership; Marketing does: Brand campaigns, inventory ads; Sales does: Test drive, financing conversation, close

Exam trap: Trap: Saying sales and marketing are fully separate. Sales is a promotional conversion arm within marketing's wider system Trap: Swapping KPIs - MQLs are marketing; SQLs and closed deals are sales

MKT-W07-T07 Sales Tactics: Waterfall vs Sprinkler

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Not every go-to-market should blast every segment on day one. Waterfall rolls out sequentially - highest-value customers first, then down. Sprinkler sprays many segments at once for speed and mass share. Choose based on how different customers are, how competitive the race is, and how much capital and patience you have

Core explanation: : Pattern; Waterfall: Step-by-step; priority segments first; Sprinkler: Many segments simultaneously : Metaphor; Waterfall: Cascade down the value ladder; Sprinkler: Spray across the lawn : Scope; Waterfall: Focused and sequential; Sprinkler: Broad and rapid Concept flow: High-value segment - Next tier - Lower tiers - Segment A - Segment B - Segment C - Launch Dimension: Risk; Waterfall: Low, controlled (gradual rollout); Sprinkler: Higher risk and cost (scale from day one) Dimension: Speed; Waterfall: Slow and steady; learn each stage; Sprinkler: Fast and aggressive; immediate impact Dimension:

Customisation; Waterfall: High (one segment at a time); Sprinkler: Low (mass message) Consumer base is heterogeneous (customers differ a lot in value) Dimension: Key resource; Waterfall: Time and patience; Sprinkler: Capital and infrastructure Product perception is uncertain or not extreme Key action: separate high-value from low-value customers and prioritise systematically Need to hit multiple segments at once to gain share quickly Market is highly competitive and speed is critical Concept flow: Customers very heterogeneous in value? - Lean Waterfall - Speed and competition extreme? - Lean Sprinkler - Perception uncertain? - Match to capital vs patience

Must remember:

- Waterfall: sequential, highest-value first - for heterogeneous buyers and uncertain perception
- Sprinkler: simultaneous multi-segment push - for speed, competition, mass appeal
- Waterfall: low risk, slow, high customisation, needs patience
- Sprinkler: higher risk/cost, fast, low customisation, needs capital
- Examples: enterprise software waterfall; fashion/games sprinkler
- Match tactic to market conditions and business priorities

Example or contrast: Firm / category: Microsoft (enterprise software); Tactic: Waterfall; Why it fits: Sell to Fortune 500 in the US first, learn, then expand to mid-sized firms in Europe months later Firm / category: H&M / Zara (fashion); Tactic: Sprinkler; Why it fits: Short trend shelf life; same product for many markets - global/same-day style launches Firm / category: Candy Crush-style mobile games; Tactic: Sprinkler; Why it fits: Mass appeal; compete for attention and downloads at once

Exam trap: Trap: Calling waterfall "mass market." Waterfall is sequential focus; sprinkler is broad simultaneous reach Trap: Saying sprinkler is low risk. It is higher risk and higher upfront cost

MKT-W07-T08

Module Summary - Marketing Strategy Essentials

Tier C

Definition and why it matters: Competitive strategy, product stage, consumer risk, sales-marketing roles, and rollout tactics are one toolkit. Use red vs blue ocean to read the battlefield, the product life cycle to time the mix, perceived risk to unlock buyers, sales and marketing to convert demand, and waterfall vs sprinkler to scale

Core explanation: Stage: Introduction; Strategic emphasis: Skimming or penetration (price x promotion) to build awareness and/or share Stage: Growth; Strategic emphasis: Rapid adoption brings rivals; differentiation becomes key

Must remember:

- Red ocean: compete in known markets; blue ocean: create uncontested demand
- PLC: intro → growth → maturity → decline; each needs different playbooks
- Intro: skimming/penetration pricing-promotion mixes
- Perceived risk: multiple types; cut with trials, guarantees, social proof
- Marketing generates interest and leads; sales converts
- Waterfall: slow/controlled for heterogeneous markets; sprinkler: fast/wide for mass appeal
- Module goal: read markets, reduce buyer uncertainty, and apply the right sales-marketing execution

Example or contrast: : Space; Red ocean: Saturated, existing markets; Blue ocean: Untapped, little competition

Exam trap: Uncertainty consumers feel before buying Types include functional, social, financial, physical, psychological (and related forms such as time risk)

Week 7 Exam Lens

Likely questions

- Define and explain Blue Ocean vs Red Ocean Strategy; include the mechanism and one limitation.
- Compare Blue Ocean vs Red Ocean Strategy with Product Life Cycle and state when each is preferred.
- Apply Modelling Perceived Risk for Consumers to a realistic system or business scenario and justify the decision.

10-mark answer frame: Start with a precise definition; draw or state the causal flow; explain each stage and metric; add a comparison or worked example; close with trade-offs, failure modes, and the decision rule.

Mistakes to avoid: View purchases from the consumer's uncertainty Trap: Equating blue ocean with "any innovation." Blue ocean means new market space and new demand, not a minor feature update in a crowded category Trap: Mixing up skimming and penetration. Skimming = high price; penetration = low price

Week 8: Meta Advertising and Campaign Design

Week roadmap: Meta Ads Foundations: Module Overview → Meta Advertising Standards and Restricted Content → Meta Ads Structure, Objectives, Targeting, and Formats → Meta Ads Manager Lab: Building and Reading a Campaign → Meta Ads Week Wrap-Up: Structure, Formats, and Targeting.

Coverage: 5 exact source topics; definitions and mechanisms come first, followed by formulas, examples, and traps where applicable.

MKT-W08-T01 Meta Ads Foundations: Module Overview

Tier C

Definition and why it matters: Meta Ads is not "one Facebook button." It is a multi-platform advertising system spanning Facebook, Instagram, and WhatsApp. This module builds the skill stack to choose formats, structure campaigns, and match creative to goals - from awareness to conversion

Core explanation: By the end of this module, you should be able to: Objective: Describe Meta Ads basics and structure; Why It Matters: Know where campaigns sit in the broader marketing mix

Must remember:

- Meta Ads = paid reach across Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp
- Module focus: foundations, formats, structure, and platform setup
- Formats: image, video, carousel, lead (and related immersive types)
- Goals span awareness → traffic → engagement → leads → app promotion
- Match format and creative to audience and objective
- Campaign hierarchy organises optimisation, targeting, and creative

Exam trap: Trap: Treating Meta Ads as Facebook-only. The ecosystem includes Instagram and WhatsApp placements and messaging Trap: Memorising formats without linking them to objectives. Exams expect "format → purpose" (e.g., lead forms for signup capture on-platform)

MKT-W08-T02 Meta Advertising Standards and Restricted Content

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Meta Ads reach people inside trusted social feeds. To keep that trust, Meta enforces advertising standards: ads must be clear, safe, compliant, and honest. Cheap tricks that inflate clicks or reactions usually get disapproved - and can damage brand credibility even if they slip through once

Core explanation: Concept: Meta ecosystem; Meaning: Platforms under Meta used for advertising (notably Facebook, Instagram, and related placements) Concept: Advertising standards; Meaning: Principles and policies that shape how ads are created, reviewed, and approved Concept: Goal of standards; Meaning: Clear, safe, compliant ads aligned with Meta policies and user trust Concept flow: Meta Advertising Standards - Quality and Honesty - Safety and Respect - Clickbait rules - Engagement bait rules - Low-quality / misleading / deceptive - Content ownership - Nudity and sexual content - Violence and criminality Pillar: Quality and honesty; Covers: Clickbait, engagement bait, low-quality links, misleading content, deceptive actions, content ownership; Marketer Takeaway: Promise must match landing experience Pillar: Safety and respect; Covers: Nudity, sexual activity, violence/criminality, bullying/harassment, hate speech, graphic content, self-injury, journalist safety guidance; Marketer Takeaway: Ads must stay responsible for all audiences Type: React bait; What It Does: Asks for specific reactions to boost visibility; Example Pattern: "Like if yes, angry-face if no" Type: Comment bait; What It Does: Pushes users to comment set words/phrases; Example Pattern: "Comment YES for a surprise" Type: Share bait; What It Does: Requires shares for contests or reach; Example Pattern: "Share to enter / help this post go viral" Type: Tag bait; What It Does: Pushes tagging friends for reach, often irrelevantly; Example Pattern: "Tag a friend who needs this" Marketing stance: Compliance is not bureaucracy - it is a performance constraint. Disapproved ads burn time, delay launches, and waste setup cost Type: Vote bait; What It Does: Fake votes via clicks/reactions/image selection; Example Pattern: "Vote A or B to decide the winner" Engagement bait manipulates people into reacting, commenting, sharing, tagging, or voting to inflate metrics. Meta AI and policy review can disapprove or remove such ads Don't: Withhold key information; Why It Fails: "You'll never believe who tripped on the red carpet" frustrates readers; Do Instead: State who/what clearly while staying interesting Don't: Exaggerate or sensationalise; Why It

Fails: "Apples are actually bad for you" when reality is about excess; **Do Instead:** Accurate, informative, still engaging headlines **Rule of thumb:** If the ask exists mainly to game the algorithm, it is engagement bait **Not every call for interaction is banned.** Authentic, valuable posts can ask for participation when the value is real - for example: Circulating a missing-child report **Category:** Alcohol; **Key Conditions:** Local laws, industry guidelines, age restrictions; banned entirely in some countries **Raising funds for a genuine cause** **Category:** Online dating; **Key Conditions:** Prior written permission; Meta dating guidelines + local law **Asking the community for useful travel tips** **Category:** Real-money gambling; **Key Conditions:** Advance approval; only in permitted regions (lotteries, sports betting, skill/chance with real money) **Meta tries to protect meaningful engagement from the same automated takedowns applied to manipulative bait** **Category:** OTC / over-the-counter drugs; **Key Conditions:** Local laws, industry codes, licences/approvals; correct age and country targeting

Must remember:

- Meta standards keep ads clear, safe, compliant, and trustworthy
- Two pillars: quality/honesty and safety/respect
- Engagement bait types: react, comment, share, tag, vote - discouraged because they manipulate metrics
- Authentic engagement for real value (causes, missing persons, helpful tips) can be exceptions
- Clickbait = withhold or exaggerate; prefer clear, accurate, engaging headlines
- Restricted categories: alcohol, dating, real-money gambling, OTC drugs, weight loss, cosmetic procedures - permissions, laws, and age/geo rules apply
- Policy deep-dive: Meta Ad Standards transparency page

Formula / decision rule: 18+

Exam trap: Trap: Treating all "engagement CTAs" as illegal. Meta discourages bait; authentic cause/community asks can be acceptable **Trap:** Confusing prohibited content (often blocked) with restricted content (allowed under conditions). Alcohol and gambling are classic restricted cases

MKT-W08-T03

Meta Ads Structure, Objectives, Targeting, and Formats

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Meta organises advertising like a company org chart: the campaign sets the goal, the ad set chooses who sees it and where, and the ad is the creative people actually see. Get any layer wrong and the algorithm optimises for the wrong outcome - or shows great creative to the wrong audience

Core explanation: Concept flow: Campaign: Objective and overall direction - Ad Set: Audience, placements, schedule, often budget controls - Ad: Creative, copy, CTA, destination **Layer:** Campaign; **Job:** Sets direction and optimisation goal; **Key Decisions:** Objective (awareness, traffic, engagement, leads, app promotion, etc.) **Layer:** Ad set; **Job:** Defines who and where; **Key Decisions:** Audience, placements, demographics, interests, behaviours **Layer:** Ad; **Job:** Defines what people see; **Key Decisions:** Images/videos, headline, primary text, links **Objective:** Awareness; **Primary Aim:** Reach people who may care, even if not ready to buy; **Typical Use:** New store launch, brand introduction **Objective:** Traffic; **Primary Aim:** Send people to a destination; **Typical Use:** Website, app, Instagram profile, landing page, blog, event page **Objective:** Engagement; **Primary Aim:** Drive interactions; **Typical Use:** Likes, comments, shares, video views, Messenger/Instagram/WhatsApp conversations **Objective:** Leads; **Primary Aim:** Capture prospect information; **Typical Use:** Instant forms, event RSVP, survey, insurance callback **Objective:** App promotion; **Primary Aim:** Drive installs and continued use; **Typical Use:** App installs, in-app events **Concept flow:** Business goal? - Awareness - Traffic - Engagement - Leads - App Promotion **Exam phrasing:** Campaign tells Meta what to optimise for; ad set focuses on exactly whom to reach; ad is the creative unit Meta asks for an objective at campaign creation. That choice shapes targeting logic, budget distribution, and how performance is judged **Mode:** Manual placements; **Meaning:** You pick surfaces (e.g., Instagram Stories, Facebook Feed, Marketplace, right column) **Mode:** Automatic placements; **Meaning:** Meta spreads delivery and shifts toward surfaces that engage best at efficient cost **Targeting Type:** Demographic; **Basis:** Age, gender, location, language, basic details; **Example:** Women 25-35 in Mumbai **Marketing example:** An insurance brand needing callback requests chooses Leads with instant forms - not Traffic to a long PDF - so Meta optimises for form completion, not

empty clicks Targeting Type: Interest; Basis: Hobbies, followed pages, activities; Example: Fashion, fitness, cooking At ad set level you define audience and placements. While the campaign chooses the objective, the ad set chooses the match between message and people Targeting Type: Behaviour; Basis: Online actions, device use, purchase signals; Example: Online shoppers, specific device users Create or select audience (age, location, interests, behaviours) Targeting Type: Custom audiences; Basis: Your first-party data / existing customers; Example: Email list, past buyers, website visitors Choose placements (manual or automatic) Targeting Type: Lookalike audiences; Basis: People similar to your best customers; Example: Expand from high-LTV buyer seed list Align targeting detail with the campaign objective Concept flow: Custom audience / best customers - Lookalike audience - New people with similar traits Recommendation pattern: Automatic placements are Meta's default guidance for reach/cost efficiency unless creative or brand rules require exclusion (e.g., avoid right-column display for a tall video creative) Format: Image ads; Strength: Clean, direct, visually striking; Best For: Single product, event highlight Format: Video ads; Strength: Storytelling; product in action; Best For: Short attention grabs or longer demos Format: Carousel ads; Strength: Multiple cards, each with own destination; Best For: Product range, step-by-step story

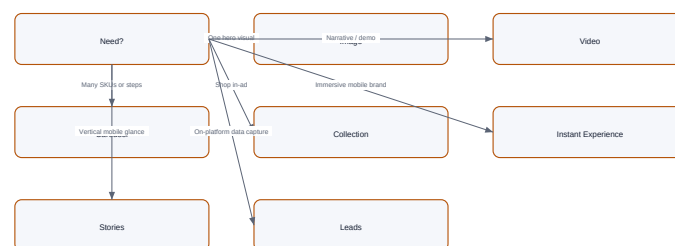
Must remember:

- Structure: Campaign (objective) → Ad set (audience/placements) → Ad (creative)
- Objectives: awareness, traffic, engagement, leads, app promotion
- Ad set = targeting magic: demographics, interests, behaviours, custom, lookalike
- Placements: manual or automatic (Meta often recommends automatic)
- Formats: image, video, carousel, collection, Instant Experience, Stories, lead forms
- Instant Experience: mobile immersive; faster load vs typical mobile web; lowers drop-off
- Match format to goal: assortment → carousel; signup on Meta → lead form; story → video/Stories

Formula / decision rule: 10 x

Exam trap: Trap: Confusing campaign with ad set. Objective lives at campaign; audience/placement detail lives at ad set Trap: Using Traffic when you need Leads. Clicks != contact data; Meta optimises to the objective you picked

Meta Ads Structure, Objectives, Targeting, and Formats



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: Meta Ads Structure, Objectives, Targeting, and Formats

MKT-W08-T04

Meta Ads Manager Lab: Building and Reading a Campaign

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Ads Manager is where structure becomes operational: you pick auction vs reservation, set an objective, define budget, target an audience, attach creative, then read metrics that separate vanity volume from real reach. The interface walks the same three layers every time - campaign, ad set, ad - so fluency is pattern recognition, not button memorisation

Core explanation: Step: 1; Action: Open Meta Ads / Business tools and sign in with Facebook or Instagram account Step: 2; Action: Go to Ads Manager Step: 3; Action: Work from Campaigns view to create, pause, or inspect delivery Concept flow: Campaign: objective + buying type + often budget - Ad set: destination, performance goal, audience, placements, schedule - Ad: page connection, creative, URL, CTA Layer: Campaign; In-Product Focus: Objective (traffic, engagement, leads, app, awareness...); buying type

Layer: Ad set; In-Product Focus: Audience and placement "magic"; dates; performance goal Layer: Ad; In-Product Focus: What users see - single image/video, carousel, etc Type: Auction; How It Works: Real-time auction for inventory; Cost Character: Usually more cost-effective / flexible Type: Reservation; How It Works: Pre-set / reserved delivery for a period; Cost Character: Typically more expensive Prerequisite for fuller features: Instagram business presence and/or Meta business page connection unlocks more options Setting: Budget location; Meaning: Campaign budget vs ad-set budget; Example: Campaign budget for simplicity Setting: Daily budget; Meaning: Cap spend per day; Example: INR 100 / day Setting: Lifetime budget; Meaning: Total for the flight; Example: INR 10,000 over 7 days Lab default: Auction for learning and flexible spend Control: Destination; Lab Guidance: Website, Instagram, Facebook page, etc Example path: choose Traffic (website or Instagram profile visits) → continue → choose manual targeting for learning (vs letting AI fully decide) → name the campaign (e.g., test campaign) Control: Performance goal; Lab Guidance: e.g., maximise landing-page views for Traffic Control: Attribution; Lab Guidance: Start with Meta's standard model; deeper attribution studied later Control: Schedule; Lab Guidance: Start/end based on budget type Control: Placements; Lab Guidance: Uncheck surfaces you do not want (e.g., Facebook right column) or leave automated With daily budget, a start date is enough; you can stop or edit later Control: Audience; Lab Guidance: Advantage+/audience controls: age, gender, detailed interests Declare if the ad falls under sensitive regulated themes such as: Financial products or services Control: Gender; Example Setting: Women Also mark securities/investment-related ads when applicable. Incorrect omission can cause rejection or restricted delivery Control: Age; Example Setting: 25-35 Control: Detailed targeting; Example Setting: Women's clothing, online shopping Concept flow: Traffic objective - Website destination - Max landing page views - Women 25-35 + apparel interests - Placements - Single image/video ad Audience example (women's apparel): Connect Facebook Page and Instagram account (create page if needed) Choose format (lab often uses single image or video) Enter destination URL (e.g., www.abc.com) - WhatsApp links can also be used as destinations where supported Upload creative or pull suggestions from existing posts Preview → publish (set region/timezone as prompted) Operational note: You can leave campaigns off with the toggle after drafting; turn on when ready to spend Customise columns to show metrics that match the objective (e.g., clicks, CTR)

Must remember:

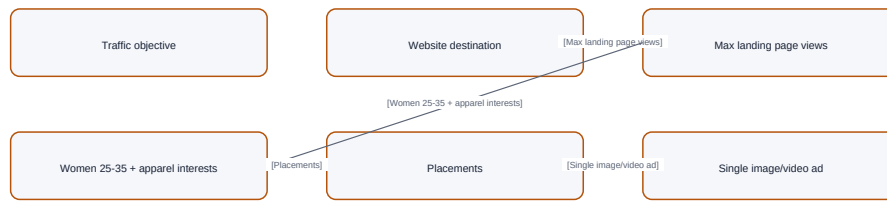
- Ads Manager: Campaign → Ad set → Ad
- Auction = real-time, typically cost-flexible; Reservation = booked, usually costlier
- Budget: daily vs lifetime; campaign- or ad-set-level
- Special categories need disclosure (finance, employment, housing, social issues, etc.)
- Ad set: destination, performance goal, audience, placements - "where magic happens"
- Metrics: reach (unique), impressions (total), frequency (repeats); customise columns for clicks/CTR
- Audiences: custom (your data), lookalike (similar prospects), saved (reusable)
- Billing and access control complete basic account operations

Formula / decision rule: Impressions $\approx$ Reach x Frequency

Example or contrast: Metric: Reach; Definition: Number of unique people who saw the ad; Uniqueness: Unique Metric: Impressions; Definition: Total times the ad was shown; Uniqueness: Non-unique (repeats count) Metric: Frequency; Definition: Average times each reached person saw the ad; Uniqueness: Derived

Exam trap: Trap: Confusing reach and impressions. Reach is unique people; impressions count repeats
Trap: Forgetting Impressions $\approx$ Reach x Frequency

Meta Ads Manager Lab: Building and Reading a Campaign



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: Meta Ads Manager Lab: Building and Reading a Campaign

MKT-W08-T05

Meta Ads Week Wrap-Up: Structure, Formats, and Targeting

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Week 8 turns Meta from "social posts" into a measurable ad system: platforms for reach, standards for trust, a three-layer structure for control, formats for creative jobs, and targeting (including custom and lookalike) for precision. If you can map goal → objective → format → audience → metric, you can design campaigns that are organised and result-driven

Core explanation: Idea: Multi-platform ecosystem; Implication for Marketers: Reach users on Facebook, Instagram, and related Meta surfaces Idea: Global + targeted delivery; Implication for Marketers: Scale awareness while narrowing to people who match your ICP Idea: Objective-led optimisation; Implication for Marketers: Meta allocates delivery toward the outcome you selected Concept flow: Image: single product / event - Video: story and motion - Carousel: multi-SKU or sequence - Lead forms: on-platform capture - Clarity and polish - Engagement and demo - Assortment or narrative steps - Signup / inquiry data Format: Image; Job: Simple, effective product or event showcase Format: Video; Job: Dynamic engagement; show product in use Format: Carousel; Job: Multiple products or a step-by-step story Format: Lead forms; Job: Collect customer info without forcing users off Meta Concept flow: Campaign: define objective - Ad set: audience, budget, scheduling - Ad: content, media, CTA Layer: Campaign; You Define: Objective aligned to marketing goal Why it matters: Modern digital marketing needs both creative storytelling and precise delivery. Meta combines them under one Ads Manager workflow Layer: Ad set; You Define: Audience, budget, schedule Layer: Ad; You Define: Creative assets, copy, call to action Lever: Demographics; Precision Benefit: Age, location, gender, language bases Lever: Interests; Precision Benefit: Affinity and lifestyle match Lever: Behaviours; Precision Benefit: Action and purchase signals (Other formats covered in depth elsewhere in the week - collection, Instant Experience, Stories - follow the same rule: pick by goal, not vanity.) Lever: Custom audiences; Precision Benefit: Reach people you already know (CRM, site, app) Lever: Lookalike audiences; Precision Benefit: Expand to people similar to strong existing customers Marketing Goal: Engagement; Format Tendency: Video, Stories, engagement-oriented creative Marketing Goal: Lead generation; Format Tendency: Lead forms / instant forms This hierarchy keeps campaigns organised and goal-aligned - each layer answers a different management question Marketing Goal: Product promotion; Format Tendency: Image, carousel, collection Marketing Goal: Multi-product storytelling; Format Tendency: Carousel (or Instant Experience for immersive mobile) Impact logic: Better targeting raises relevance → improves engagement and conversion odds → stretches budget toward measurable outcomes Selection skill: Know each format's strength, then tailor the campaign - format is strategy, not decoration You should now be able to: Navigate the Meta Ads ecosystem and its role in digital marketing Map formats to purposes (image, video, carousel, leads, and related types) Build campaigns with correct campaign → ad set → ad logic Apply demographic, interest, behaviour, custom, and lookalike targeting Select formats against engagement, lead gen, or product-promotion goals

Must remember:

- Meta Ads: Facebook, Instagram, and related Meta surfaces for targeted digital advertising
- Formats: image (clarity), video (motion/story), carousel (multi/sequence), lead forms (on-platform capture)
- Structure: campaign (objective) → ad set (audience/budget/schedule) → ad (creative + CTA)

- Targeting: demographics, interests, behaviours; custom + lookalike maximise relevance
- Choose format from goal: engagement, lead gen, or product promotion
- Skill outcome: create, manage, and optimise Meta campaigns for measurable business impact

Exam trap: Trap: Recalling platform names without the three-layer structure. Exams often test where objective vs audience live Trap: Matching formats to vague "visibility" instead of specific goals (awareness vs leads vs installs)

Week 8 Exam Lens

Likely questions

- Define and explain Meta Advertising Standards and Restricted Content; include the mechanism and one limitation.
- Compare Meta Advertising Standards and Restricted Content with Meta Ads Structure, Objectives, Targeting, and Formats and state when each is preferred.
- Apply Meta Ads Manager Lab: Building and Reading a Campaign to a realistic system or business scenario and justify the decision.

10-mark answer frame: Start with a precise definition; draw or state the causal flow; explain each stage and metric; add a comparison or worked example; close with trade-offs, failure modes, and the decision rule.

Formula and decision sheet: $18+; 10 \times$; Impressions $\sim$ Reach $\times$ Frequency

Mistakes to avoid: Trap: Treating Meta Ads as Facebook-only. The ecosystem includes Instagram and WhatsApp placements and messaging Trap: Treating all "engagement CTAs" as illegal. Meta discourages bait; authentic cause/community asks can be acceptable Trap: Confusing campaign with ad set. Objective lives at campaign; audience/placement detail lives at ad set

Week 9: Google Ads, Auctions, and Campaign Types

Week roadmap: Introduction to Google Ads for Lead Generation → Real-Time Bidding (RTB) and Programmatic Advertising → Google Ads Foundational Knowledge: Policies, Auction, Structure, Targeting, Bidding → Google Ads Campaign Types: Search, Demand Gen, Discovery/YouTube, Performance Max → Google Ads Lab: Dashboard, Search Campaigns, Performance Max, and CPC Bidding → Week Summary: Google Ads for Lead Generation.

Coverage: 6 exact source topics; definitions and mechanisms come first, followed by formulas, examples, and traps where applicable.

MKT-W09-T01 Introduction to Google Ads for Lead Generation

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Google Ads is performance marketing - spend money only when the platform can drive measurable business outcomes (leads, calls, form fills, sales). For lead-gen businesses (insurance, education, B2B services), the goal is not vanity reach; it is capturing high-quality contact information that sales can convert into revenue

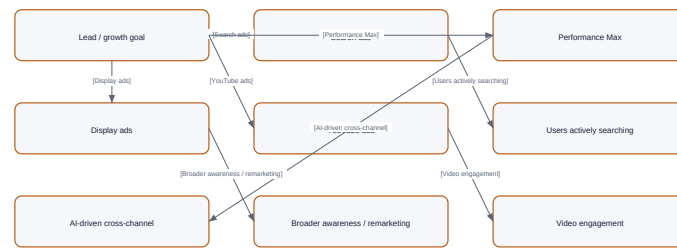
Core explanation: Focus: Performance marketing; Meaning: Drive real-world results (leads, conversions), not just awareness Focus: Lead generation; Meaning: Capture actionable customer information (phone, email, form fills) Focus: Primary use cases; Meaning: Insurance, education, professional services - any business needing leads Concept flow: Lead / growth goal - Search ads - Performance Max - Display ads - YouTube ads - Users actively searching - AI-driven cross-channel - Broader awareness / remarketing - Video engagement Campaign type: Search; Purpose for lead gen: Capture users already looking for the service Campaign type: Performance Max (PMax); Purpose for lead gen: Automated ads across Google inventory from one campaign Campaign type: Display; Purpose for lead gen: Reach a broader audience while they browse websites/apps Marketing example: An insurance company runs Google Ads so someone searching "car insurance quote online" lands on a form, submits details, and becomes a sales-ready lead Campaign type: YouTube; Purpose for lead gen: Video storytelling and engagement to warm or convert By mastering Google Ads for lead gen, you should be able to: Apply foundational basics - account structure, targeting, bidding - with a lead-gen lens Concept flow: Potential customer - Actionable lead - Sales / follow-up - Business result Choose the right campaign type for the goal Drive meaningful conversions, not just clicks Lead generation sits between awareness and sale: Search → highest intent when keywords match the offer PMax → maximises conversions with less manual channel picking Display / YouTube → expand reach, retarget, or educate before the form fill

Must remember:

- Google Ads here = performance marketing for lead-gen businesses
- Goal: attract high-quality leads and convert them into business results
- Core types: Search, PMax, Display, YouTube
- Search targets active seekers; PMax automates cross-channel; Display/YouTube broaden and engage
- Success = meaningful conversions, not just traffic

Exam trap: Trap: Treating Google Ads only as brand awareness. For this module, the frame is performance and leads Trap: Confusing a click with a lead. A lead is captured customer information that can drive further action

Introduction to Google Ads for Lead Generation



Vector reconstruction of the source Memmial visual

Concept map: Introduction to Google Ads for Lead Generation

MKT-W09-T02

Real-Time Bidding (RTB) and Programmatic Advertising

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Every time a page or app loads with an empty ad slot, an auction happens in milliseconds before the user sees anything. Advertisers do not negotiate each placement by email; software bids automatically. That instant auction is real-time bidding (RTB) - the engine behind most programmatic digital ads Step: 1; What happens: User visits a website or opens a mobile app

Core explanation: Traditional advertising: RFPs, negotiation, insertion orders; Real-time bidding: Automated bidding Traditional advertising: Slow to launch and adjust; Real-time bidding: Instant placement and flexible control Traditional advertising: Manual deal-making; Real-time bidding: Speed, efficiency, campaign agility Concept flow: Advertisers / agencies - Demand-Side Platform DSP - Ad exchange - Supply-Side Platform SSP - Publishers / media owners - Winning ad shown to user Platform: DSP (Demand-Side Platform); Who uses it: Advertisers, media agencies; Role: Store target audience, campaign rules, max bid Platform: SSP (Supply-Side Platform); Who uses it: Publishers, media owners; Role: Manage inventory, audience on site/app, floor/minimum price Platform: Ad exchange; Who uses it: Marketplace between DSP and SSP; Role: Auctions inventory when advertiser criteria match supply Concept flow: User - Page - SSP - Exchange - DSP RTB compresses what used to take days of media buying into a fraction of a second per impression opportunity Scenario: Page loads without an ad; Result: Content shows; ad slot stays empty Programmatic buying rests on three software platforms (not physical machines): Scenario: Page loads with an ad; Result: RTB ran in the background; winner appears almost instantly Win logic: Highest bid plus relevancy and ad quality typically wins; the ad is then displayed to the user Providers are often labelled by role: DSP providers, SSP providers, or ad exchange providers The entire auction can complete in a few milliseconds as the page loads

Must remember:

- RTB = automated, real-time auction for digital ad space
- Runs when a user opens a page/app with available inventory
- Stack: DSP (buy) <→ ad exchange <→ SSP (sell)
- Wins on bid, relevancy, and quality - then ad renders instantly
- Replaces slow RFP/IO media buying with speed and flexibility

Exam trap: Trap: Thinking RTB is a human auction that takes minutes. It is automated and finishes in milliseconds Trap: Confusing DSP and SSP. DSP = buyer side; SSP = seller/publisher side

MKT-W09-T03

Google Ads Foundational Knowledge: Policies, Auction, Structure, Targeting, Bidding

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Google Ads is not "upload creative and hope." It is a policy-bounded auction plus a structured account (campaign → ad group → keywords/ads) that decides who sees which ad and how much you pay toward a goal. Policies protect the ecosystem; Quality Score and Ad Rank decide visibility; targeting and bidding decide whether spend buys the right people

Core explanation: Google aims for a trustworthy ecosystem for users, advertisers, and publishers. Policies keep experiences safe and lawful and keep harmful content out Policy area: Prohibited content; Meaning:

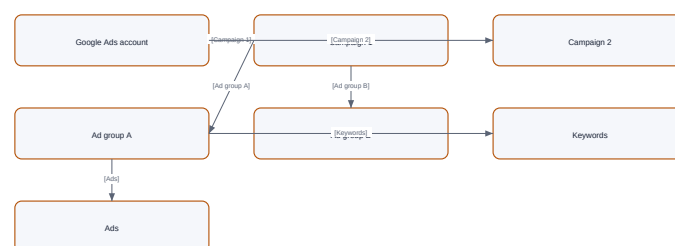
Content that cannot be advertised on Google Network Policy area: Prohibited practices; Meaning: Actions you cannot take if you want to advertise Policy area: Restricted content and features; Meaning: Allowed only with limitations Policy area: Editorial and technical standards; Meaning: Quality bars for ads, websites, and apps Concept flow: User searches / visits GDN - Quick auction for ad space - Advertisers bid - Relevance / Quality Score - Ad Rank = bid + quality + other factors - Highest-ranking ads shown Level: Account; Role: Overall Google Ads account Level: Campaign; Role: Budget, goal, network, location - e.g. Campaign 1, Campaign 2 Level: Ad group; Role: Theme cluster of keywords + ads (analogous to Meta's ad set) User searches on Google or visits the Google Display Network (GDN) Level: Keywords + ads; Role: What triggers the auction and what creative users see Google runs a quick auction for available space Concept flow: Google Ads account - Campaign 1 - Campaign 2 - Ad group A - Ad group B - Keywords - Ads Ads are scored for relevance to the query or content Quality Score reflects overall ad quality Lever: Keywords; What it does: Phrases that trigger Search ads; Example: "term life insurance quote" Google combines bid and Quality Score into Ad Rank Lever: Audiences; What it does: Interest / behaviour groups; Example: Online bookstore - literature lovers Highest Ad Rank ads are shown; position follows Ad Rank and other factors Lever: Demographics; What it does: Age, gender, income, etc; Example: Luxury watches - high-income brackets Lever: Location; What it does: Country, city, town; Example: Local clinic - one city or radius Strategy family: Conversion-focused; Examples: Maximise conversions (target CPA); Typical use: Lead gen Strategy family: Value-focused; Examples: Maximise conversion value (target ROAS); Typical use: E-commerce Meta vs Google naming: Meta uses campaign → ad set → ad; Google uses campaign → ad group → ad Strategy family: Traffic / visibility; Examples: Maximise clicks; Target impression share; Typical use: Traffic growth, awareness Strategy family: Manual control; Examples: Manual CPC; Typical use: Tight budget control Goal: Brand awareness; Prefer: Target impression share (or maximise clicks for traffic) Goal: Lead generation; Prefer: Target CPA or maximise conversions Goal: E-commerce sales; Prefer: Target ROAS or maximise conversion value / conversions Tool: Google Keyword Planner helps discover relevant industry keywords Goal: Strict spend control; Prefer: Manual CPC Google offers smart/automated and manual options. Choose by campaign goal

Must remember:

- Four policy buckets: prohibited content, prohibited practices, restricted content, editorial/technical standards
- Auction: relevance + Quality Score + bid → Ad Rank → placement
- Structure: Account → Campaign → Ad group → Keywords/Ads
- Targeting: keywords, audiences, demographics, location
- Match bidding strategy to goal: awareness, leads, sales, or manual control

Exam trap: Trap: Mixing Meta's "ad set" with Google's "ad group." Same idea, different name Trap: Thinking highest bid alone wins. Ad Rank = bid + Quality Score (+ other factors)

Google Ads Foundational Knowledge: Policies, Auction, Structure, Targeting, Bidding



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: Google Ads Foundational Knowledge: Policies, Auction, Structure, Targeting, Bidding

MKT-W09-T04 Google Ads Campaign Types: Search, Demand Gen, Discovery/YouTube, Performance Max Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Campaign type is a channel and automation choice. Search captures existing demand; Demand Gen and YouTube create or re-engage demand across feeds and video; Performance Max lets Google's AI hunt conversions across almost every Google surface from one campaign. Wrong type = paying for the wrong moment in the customer journey Type: Search; Where it shows: Google Search results; Best for: High-intent queries

Core explanation: Appear when users actively search for information, products, or services. Can include extensions (ratings, callouts, structured snippets, sitelinks) for more information and CTR lift Rule: ALL CAPS; Detail: Not allowed except promotional codes Rule: "Trick to click"; Detail: Phrases like "click here" often flagged Rule: Exclamation points; Detail: Max one; none in headlines Rule: Display URL; Detail: Root domain must match destination URL Smart bidding (needs sufficient conversion history): Target ROAS, maximise conversion value; Manual: Manual CPC Smart bidding (needs sufficient conversion history): Maximise conversions, Target CPA Match type: Broad match; Triggers on: Synonyms and related searches; Reach: Highest; Relevance: More diluted Match type: Phrase match; Triggers on: Phrase + close variants; Reach: Medium; Relevance: Medium Match type: Exact match; Triggers on: Exact term + close variants; Reach: Lowest; Relevance: Highest Match type: Negative match; Triggers on: Blocks unwanted queries; Reach: Protects budget; Relevance: Improves relevance Aligned to goals such as conversions, leads, sales, clicks, views, engagement, impressions Component: Landing page experience; Approx. weight: ~39%; Focus: Relevance, usability, load/UX of destination Component: Expected CTR; Approx. weight: ~39%; Focus: Likelihood users click the ad Component: Ad relevance; Approx. weight: ~22%; Focus: Ad text fit to keyword/query Extension: Sitelinks; Purpose: Deep links to key pages Extension: Ratings / reviews; Purpose: Social proof Extension: App links; Purpose: Drive installs Marketing example: Exact match "car insurance quote" for an insurer; negative "free job" or "career" if irrelevant traffic appears Extension: Price / promotion; Purpose: Surface offers Quality Score combines three factors: Extension: Call / location; Purpose: Phone and map actions Extension: Disclosures; Purpose: Required legal/offer clarity Higher Quality Score improves Ad Rank and can lower cost for the same position Use: Re-engage; Approach: Remarketing / existing audiences Use: Expand; Approach: Custom intent, in-market, affinity Use: Structure; Approach: Ad groups by in-market, custom intent, remarketing, customer match Extensions add information and actions without replacing the core ad Format: TrueView / skippable in-stream; Behaviour: Skippable after 5 seconds; Notes: Pay when viewers watch past 5s (classic popular format) Reach across YouTube Shorts, in-stream, in-feed, Discover, and Gmail. Assets: images, headlines, descriptions, logos, CTAs, URLs, business name Format: Non-skippable; Behaviour: Full message required; Notes: Guarantees complete view of short spot Format: Bumper; Behaviour: ~6 seconds, non-skippable; Notes: Often at start; quick brand hit Format: In-feed video; Behaviour: Appears as users discover content; Notes: Discovery-driven Format: YouTube Shorts ads; Behaviour: Mobile-first Shorts inventory; Notes: Vertical, fast consumption Format: Masthead; Behaviour: Prominent homepage / home feed placement; Notes: High visibility "banner"-scale presence Concept flow: Awareness - Bumper / non-skippable - Engagement - Skippable TrueView - Discovery - In-feed / Shorts - Premium visibility - Masthead

Must remember:

- Types: Search, Demand Gen, YouTube/Discovery formats, Performance Max
- Match types: broad / phrase / exact / negative - trade reach vs relevance
- Quality Score $\approx$ landing page (~39%) + expected CTR (~39%) + ad relevance (~22%)
- Extensions boost info and actions; Demand Gen uses in-market vs custom intent
- YouTube: skippable, non-skippable, bumper, in-feed, Shorts, masthead
- PMax = one AI-driven campaign across Google's major surfaces

Example or contrast: Concept: In-market; Meaning: Users actively shopping a category (known buying pattern); Example: Annual car insurance renewer Concept: Custom intent; Meaning: New/emerging interest signalled by recent behaviour/searches; Example: First-time "best guitar course for beginners" searcher Other audience themes: weddings, financial services, apparel, electronics, education, real estate, etc

Exam trap: Trap: Using broad match without negatives - reach without relevance Trap: Mixing all goals into one campaign type; Search != Demand Gen != PMax

MKT-W09-T05 Google Ads Lab: Dashboard, Search Campaigns, Performance Max, and CPC Bidding Tier A

Definition and why it matters: The Google Ads UI maps the theory: structure (campaign → ad group → ads), goal-led campaign types, and tools for planning. A lead-gen business (e.g. insurance) usually starts by choosing traffic or leads as the objective, then Search or PMax, then keywords/assets, location, and budget. Keyword Planner turns guesswork about CPC into a range you can bid into

Core explanation: After signing up at ads.google.com, the left navigation centers on: Area: Campaigns; What you do: View and manage all campaigns Area: Goals; What you do: Align setup to outcomes Area: Tools; What you do: Asset Studio, planning, data, partnerships Area: Billing; What you do: Payment method (card) Area: Settings; What you do: Time zone, account name, etc Tool: Asset Studio; Purpose: Prompt-based creation of images/videos for ads Tool: Keyword Planner; Purpose: Search volume and bid forecasts (by URL or keywords) Tool: Performance Planner; Purpose: Estimate media budget needs Tool: Reach Planner; Purpose: Especially useful for YouTube / reach planning Tool: Creator partnerships; Purpose: Link co-sponsored YouTube creator videos; track views, clicks, sales Tool: Data manager; Purpose: Connect Google properties (YouTube, Google Analytics, etc.) Concept flow: Create campaign - Choose objective e.g. website traffic - Select Search - Enter business URL + campaign name - Bid focus: conversions / value / clicks / impression share - Location + language - Keywords and ad assets - Daily budget - Review - live Step: Objective; Notes: Leads or website traffic for lead-gen businesses Step: Campaign type; Notes: Search (this walkthrough); also PMax, Demand Gen, Video, Display, Shopping Step: Final URL; Notes: Business site (e.g. abc.com) Step: Bid focus; Notes: Conversions (e.g. form fill), conversion value, clicks, impression share Step: Optional max CPC; Notes: Cap (e.g. INR 50/click) or let Google AI set bids Step: Location / language; Notes: e.g. India or city (Delhi); English Step: Ad groups; Notes: AI can generate from site cues, or create manually (e.g. "Lifestyle" section URL) Example framing: insurance or similar lead-oriented business wanting website traffic or leads Step: Budget; Notes: Custom daily amount (e.g. INR 200-INR 2,000) then submit for review Step: Objective; Notes: e.g. website traffic Step: Type; Notes: Performance Max - one campaign across Search, Display, YouTube, Gmail, Maps, etc Step: Final URL + name; Notes: Landing destination Step: Bidding; Notes: e.g. towards conversions Step: Location; Notes: e.g. India Step: Asset group; Notes: Logos, search/display creatives, YouTube - AI-generated from URL or manual upload + previews by placement Step: Signals; Notes: Cues to AI on who to reach (search themes, audience lists, interests) Conversion example: For insurance, a conversion might be "form completed for callback." Step: Demographics; Notes: Age, gender, parental status, household income, etc Once live, dashboard metrics resemble other paid platforms (impressions, share-related stats, etc.) Signal type: Search themes; Use: Topics you associate with ideal customers Signal type: Audience signals; Use: Customer lists (retarget), YouTube engagers, interest segments Signal type: Extra demographics; Use: Age bands, income tiers, gender Type: Performance Max; Scope: All major Google properties from one campaign Type: Search; Scope: Google Search only Type: Demand Gen; Scope: YouTube, Discover, Gmail, related feed surfaces

Must remember:

- UI: Campaigns, Tools (Keyword / Performance / Reach Planner, Asset Studio, Data manager), Billing, Settings
- Hierarchy: Campaign → Ad group → Ads
- Search setup: objective → Search → URL → bid → geo/language → keywords/assets → budget → review
- PMax: asset groups + signals + previews across Google inventory
- Keyword Planner forecasts give a manual CPC range (low to top-of-page high)
- Lead-gen example: insurance form fills as conversions; Search for intent + PMax for AI reach

Example or contrast: Platform: Google Ads; Hierarchy: Campaign - Ad group - Ads Platform: Meta Ads; Hierarchy: Campaign - Ad set - Ads Same logic; only the middle name differs

Exam trap: Trap: Confusing Google ad group with Meta ad set Trap: Selecting Shopping or Display when the goal needs Search intent or PMax coverage

MKT-W09-T06

Week Summary: Google Ads for Lead Generation

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: This week's thread: use Google Ads as performance marketing for lead-gen - pick the campaign type that matches intent, layer extensions and formats for engagement, and lean on AI (especially Performance Max) where cross-channel conversion is the goal. Search captures demand; Display and YouTube expand it; PMax stitches Google's inventory together

Core explanation: Theme: Audience; Takeaway: Lead-generation businesses needing high-quality leads Theme: Ecosystem; Takeaway: Multiple campaign types for different marketing goals Theme: Success metric; Takeaway: Quality leads and conversions, not empty reach Concept flow: Search - Active seekers - leads - Performance Max - AI across Google surfaces - Display - Awareness + browse reach - YouTube - Video engage + convert Type: Search; Role: Users actively searching related products/services - highly relevant traffic and easier lead conversion Type: Performance Max (PMax); Role: Google AI / ML across YouTube, Search, Display, Gmail, Maps - maximise conversions with less manual work Type: Display; Role: Brand awareness and wider reach on sites/apps across Google Network while people browse Type: YouTube; Role: Video for engagement and conversion; formats include skippable and non-skippable (and related variants covered earlier) Extension examples: Sitelinks; Why they help: More paths into the site Extension examples: Ratings; Why they help: Trust / social proof Extension examples: Callouts; Why they help: Extra value props without long headlines Channel: Display; Strength: Awareness and reach while browsing; connect with prospects before/without a search Channel: YouTube; Strength: Storytelling, engagement, timed reach with format choice (skippable vs non-skippable, etc.) Concept flow: Google Ads + lead gen framing - RTB / DSP-SSP-exchange - Policies, Ad Rank, structure, targeting, bidding - Search, Demand Gen, YouTube, PMax - UI: Search + PMax + Keyword Planner CPC Search drives intent-matched traffic. Ad extensions improve visibility and engagement: One campaign, full Google inventory, AI-optimised for conversions - ideal when the business wants maximum conversions with minimal channel-by-channel management

Must remember:

- Week focus: Google Ads fundamentals for lead-gen performance
- Search: active intent + extensions (sitelinks, ratings, callouts)
- PMax: AI across major Google properties; max conversions, less manual work
- Display: awareness and browse-time reach on the Google Network
- YouTube: video formats (skippable, non-skippable, etc.) for engage + convert
- Choose type by goal; convert relevant traffic into high-quality leads

Exam trap: Trap: Treating all four (Search / PMax / Display / YouTube) as interchangeable - each matches a different intent and control level Trap: Claiming Search is mainly for awareness; week framing stresses relevant traffic → leads

Week 9 Exam Lens

Likely questions

- Define and explain Introduction to Google Ads for Lead Generation; include the mechanism and one limitation.
- Compare Introduction to Google Ads for Lead Generation with Google Ads Foundational Knowledge: Policies, Auction, Structure, Targeting, Bidding and state when each is preferred.
- Apply Google Ads Campaign Types: Search, Demand Gen, Discovery/YouTube, Performance Max to a realistic system or business scenario and justify the decision.

10-mark answer frame: Start with a precise definition; draw or state the causal flow; explain each stage and metric; add a comparison or worked example; close with trade-offs, failure modes, and the decision rule.

Mistakes to avoid: Trap: Treating Google Ads only as brand awareness. For this module, the frame is performance and leads Trap: Thinking RTB is a human auction that takes minutes. It is automated and finishes in milliseconds Trap: Mixing Meta's "ad set" with Google's "ad group." Same idea, different name

Week 10: Targeting and Performance Marketing

Week roadmap: Google Ads for E-commerce and App Marketing → App Campaigns on Google Ads: Foundational Knowledge → Google Shopping Ads: Types, Setup, and Purpose → Google Ads Lab: Demand Gen, Display, Shopping, and App Promotion → Performance Marketing as Investment Banking → How Digital Ads Work: Behavioural vs Contextual Targeting and ML → 1 more topics.

Coverage: 7 exact source topics; definitions and mechanisms come first, followed by formulas, examples, and traps where applicable.

MKT-W10-T01 Google Ads for E-commerce and App Marketing

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Google Ads is not one product - it is a toolkit. E-commerce brands need visual product discovery; app businesses need installs, re-engagement, or launch buzz. Matching campaign type to business goal, then narrowing with audience targeting, is the foundation of profitable media spend

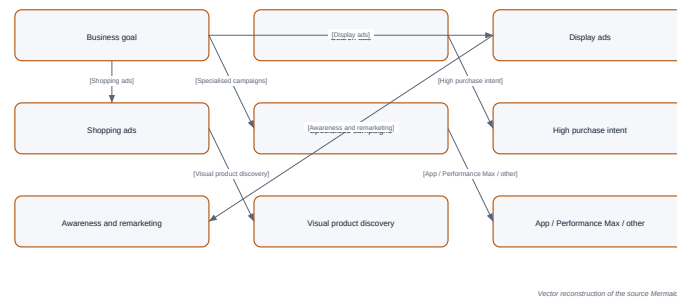
Core explanation: This module centres on using Google Ads specifically for: Focus: E-commerce; Business need: Product visibility, traffic to store, sales Focus: App marketing; Business need: Installs, in-app engagement, pre-launch demand Concept flow: Business goal - Search ads - Display ads - Shopping ads - Specialised campaigns - High purchase intent - Awareness and remarketing - Visual product discovery - App / Performance Max / other Campaign type: Search; Primary role: Capture active query intent; Typical ecom / app use: "Buy running shoes", competitor brand terms Campaign type: Display; Primary role: Visual presence across the web; Typical ecom / app use: Brand awareness, retargeting cart abandoners Campaign type: Shopping; Primary role: Image + price + merchant name; Typical ecom / app use: Product catalog ads for online stores Campaign type: Specialised; Primary role: Goal-specific automation; Typical ecom / app use: App install / engagement / pre-registration Learning outcomes to aim for: Describe foundational Google Ads basics for e-commerce and app contexts Lever: Demographics; What it controls: Who (age, gender, income, parental status) Explain major campaign types and the purpose each serves in a business plan Lever: Interests / affinity; What it controls: What they care about long-term Lever: In-market / intent; What it controls: What they are ready to buy now Lever: Behaviour / remarketing; What it controls: What they already did with your brand or app Each type solves a different stage of the buyer or user journey. Running Search alone when you need app installs (or Shopping alone when people do not know your brand yet) misallocates budget Ads only create value if the right people see them at the right moment Example: An online electronics store uses Shopping ads for product queries, Search for brand defence, and Display remarketing for users who viewed a product but did not buy - three campaigns, one funnel After mastering this module's ideas, you should be able to: Navigate the Google Ads ecosystem with an e-commerce and app lens Map goals → campaign types → targeting Optimise for outcomes (sales, installs, engagement), not vanity metrics alone

Must remember:

- Week focus: Google Ads for e-commerce and app growth
- Core campaign families: Search, Display, Shopping, specialised
- Match campaign type to business goal and funnel stage
- Audience segmentation and targeting decide who sees the ad and when
- Outcomes: foundation + campaign purpose literacy for optimisation

Exam trap: Trap: Treating "Google Ads" as synonymous with Search only. Shopping, Display, and app campaigns are core for ecom/apps Trap: Choosing campaign type by familiarity instead of goal (e.g., Display for "people searching to buy now")

Google Ads for E-commerce and App Marketing



Concept map: Google Ads for E-commerce and App Marketing

MKT-W10-T02

App Campaigns on Google Ads: Foundational Knowledge

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: App marketing on Google Ads is goal-driven automation. Google's machine learning places ads across Search, YouTube, Discover, and the Play network - but you choose the objective: get installs (ACI), win back or monetise existing users (ACE), or build waitlists before launch (pre-registration). Wrong objective = wrong users = wasted CPI budget

Core explanation: Concept flow: ACI: Installs - ACE: Engagement - Pre-registration - Grow user base - Re-engage / monetise installed users - Build demand before Play Store release Type: App campaigns for installs; Abbreviation: ACI; Objective: Drive downloads; When to use: New launch or scale marketplace presence Type: App campaigns for engagement; Abbreviation: ACE; Objective: Re-engage / in-app actions; When to use: Users installed but inactive; carts abandoned; push purchases or events Type: App campaigns for pre-registration; Objective: Sign-ups before release; When to use: Android apps / games not yet live on Google Play Segment: Lapsed purchasers; Message / action: Come back and buy again Goal: Reach people most likely to download and install Segment: Cart abandoners; Message / action: Complete checkout How it works: Segment: Event / sale audiences; Message / action: Reminder for live offer inside the app Google Ads ML optimises delivery toward install-likely users Works for broad reach; still worth narrowing by usage behaviour and interests Best when the priority metric is installs (or quality installs if you set deeper conversion tracking) Marketing example: A food-delivery app (e.g., Swiggy) launching in a new city runs ACI to maximise install volume within a daily CPA/CPI budget Feature: Platform; Detail: Android / Google Play only Goal: Shift from acquisition to engagement and retention once enough users exist Feature: Targeting logic; Detail: Similar apps/games interest; history of pre-registering Typical ACE use cases: Feature: Strategic value; Detail: Waitlist + early audience insights to refine creative and messaging before day-one launch Concept flow: App campaign audiences - Detailed demographics - Life events - Affinity - In-market - In-app action segments Option: Detailed demographics; Basis: Long-term life facts: age, gender, income, parental status; Example: Parenting / education apps - parents in selected age bands Eligibility constraint: ACE requires a substantial install base - typically at least 50,000 installs - so ML has enough users to re-target effectively Option: Life events; Basis: Milestones: wedding, home move, new baby, graduation; Example: Mortgage calculator app - recent home buyers Marketing example: After 80,000 installs, a shopping app runs ACE to users who added items to cart but did not purchase, with creatives focused on free shipping Option: Affinity; Basis: Passions and habits (sports, travel, foodies, etc.); Example: Fitness app - sports enthusiasts Goal: Build excitement and Play Store pre-registrations before the app or game launches Option: In-market; Basis: Recent purchase / action intent; Example: Shopping app - users researching products in your category Option: In-app action segments; Basis: Behaviour inside your own app; Example: Purchase completers, incomplete sign-ups, cart abandoners Situation: Need more downloads; Campaign: ACI Marketing example: A new mobile RPG runs pre-registration toward users of similar RPGs so launch day starts with an eager install queue Situation: Have = ~50k installs; need activity / purchases; Campaign: ACE

Must remember:

- Three types: ACI (installs), ACE (engagement), pre-registration (pre-launch Android)
- ACE needs ~50,000 installs
- Targeting: demographics, life events, affinity, in-market, in-app behaviour segments

- ML automates delivery; marketer sets goal, creative assets, and audience logic
- Match campaign to lifecycle stage: launch → install, mature → engage, pre-release → pre-register

Exam trap: Trap: Running ACE without meeting the ~50,000 install eligibility - campaigns need a large enough base Trap: Saying pre-registration works for iOS the same way; it is framed for Android / Google Play

MKT-W10-T03

Google Shopping Ads: Types, Setup, and Purpose

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: When someone searches "Air Jordans" or "Bluetooth headphones," text ads describe; Shopping ads show. Image, title, price, and merchant name appear before the click - so shoppers compare and decide faster. For e-commerce, Shopping (via Merchant Center) is often the most direct path from search intent to product page

Core explanation: Shopping ads place retailer products on Google Search (and related Shopping surfaces), often at the top of results and in the Shopping tab
 Element shown: Product image; Why it matters: Faster recognition; higher click likelihood than text alone
 Element shown: Title; Why it matters: Clarifies variant / model
 Element shown: Price; Why it matters: Instant value comparison
 Element shown: Business name; Why it matters: Trust and brand recognition
 Concept flow: User searches product - Google pulls matching Merchant Center products - Shopping ad: image + price + merchant - Qualified click - Product page / checkout
 Approach: Performance Max (PMax); Reach: Search, YouTube, Display, Gmail, etc; Control: Highly automated via Google AI; Best when: Broader reach; willing to let ML place & optimise
 Approach: Standard Shopping; Reach: Focused on Shopping inventory; Control: More manual bids, product selection, listing control; Best when: Need hands-on control of which SKUs and how they compete
 Concept flow: Create Merchant Center - Business profile: name, hours, services - Online / physical / both - Upload or sync product data - Connect Merchant Center to Google Ads - Create Shopping or PMax campaign
 Method: Platform sync; How: Link Shopify, BigCommerce, WooCommerce, etc. - auto sync catalog
 Unlike classic text Search ads, creatives are largely driven by product feed data, not free-form ad copy alone
 Method: Store connection; How: Connect site so Google fetches products
 Method: Manual upload; How: Upload / edit products directly in Merchant Center
 Key difference: PMax = wider surfaces + automation; Standard Shopping = Shopping-centric + marketer control
 Marketing example: A fashion retailer uses Standard Shopping for hero SKUs with tight ROAS targets, and Performance Max to scale awareness and find converting placements beyond classic Shopping results

Must remember:

- Shopping ads: image + title + price + merchant on Search / Shopping surfaces
- Campaign options: Performance Max (broad + automated) vs Standard Shopping (control + Shopping focus)
- Setup path: Merchant Center → product feed → link Google Ads → campaign
- Feeds: platform sync, site connect, or manual upload
- Benefits: visibility, conversion-ready clicks, comparison, feed-level control

Example or contrast: Prefer Performance Max if: You want one campaign across many Google properties; Prefer Standard Shopping if: You want bidding / product-level precision

Exam trap: Trap: Trying to run Shopping without Merchant Center - the feed is mandatory Trap: Equating Performance Max with Standard Shopping; reach and control differ sharply

MKT-W10-T04

Google Ads Lab: Demand Gen, Display, Shopping, and App Promotion

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Platform fluency is a skill: the Google Ads UI repeats the same skeleton across campaign types - goal → budget/schedule → audience → assets → review. Lab practice builds muscle memory for Demand Gen, Display, Shopping, and App Promotion so you can set up and diagnose live campaigns without guessing which screen controls what

Core explanation: Most campaign builders follow a similar path: Concept flow: Campaign goal e.g. website traffic - Campaign type - Name + daily budget + schedule - Location / language - Audiences + demographics

- URL + assets + headlines - Review - go live - Dashboard Setting: Daily budget; Examples you can control: e.g. INR 1 for a test; INR 100 for install volume tests Setting: Ad schedule; Examples you can control: Only Mondays and Wednesdays; custom dayparts Setting: Location; Examples you can control: India; city-level (e.g. Delhi) Setting: Language; Examples you can control: Match market language Audience building path: Interests; Options: Education, news & politics, pets, media & entertainment, etc Audience building path: Browse categories; Options: Life events, in-market categories (actively researching) Audience building path: Demographics; Options: Align to business (age, gender, etc.) Purpose: Generate demand with visual creatives across YouTube, Discover, and Gmail (among other surfaces in the Demand Gen family) Choose goal (e.g. website traffic) → Demand Gen Name campaign; optimise for clicks; set daily budget and schedule Ad group → location targeting Targeting layer: Demographics; Examples: Gender, age brackets, parental status, household income (exclude what you do not want) Build an audience (name it, e.g. "test audience") Targeting layer: Audience segments; Examples: Same interest / in-market style segments Targeting layer: Placements; Examples: Specific YouTube channels or video URLs (monetisable), websites, or apps Creative formats: single image, video, or carousel Final URL + upload image/video + headlines → preview on YouTube / Discover / Gmail → Review → live after review Shopping option: Standard Shopping; Lab takeaway: Product-list control; bids e.g. maximise clicks; pick SKUs from feed Marketing example: An edtech brand runs Demand Gen to interest audiences ("education") with a carousel of course benefits driving to a signup landing page Shopping option: Performance Max; Lab takeaway: One campaign across Google inventories (often covered separately; broader automation) Purpose: Place visual ads across the Google Display Network and related placements Creative steps: Final URL → business name → images / logos / videos → multiple headlines and descriptions → use preview toggle → publish Marketing example: A D2C brand places Display ads on specific YouTube reviews in its category and on complementary content sites Prerequisite: Google Merchant Center account (same Google identity helps auto-fetch) Option: App installs; Goal: Drive downloads; Constraint / note: Universal starter; Android or iOS Option: App engagement; Goal: Re-engage installed users; Constraint / note: Needs ~50,000 installs eligibility New campaign → website traffic → Shopping Option: Pre-registration; Goal: Pre-launch sign-ups; Constraint / note: Android only Link Merchant Center Choose Standard Shopping → name → budget + bidding (e.g. max clicks) Ad group → edit product list (pick which catalog items to advertise) Preview summary → go live; confirm status on main dashboard

Must remember:

- Shared UI path: goal → type → budget/schedule → geo → audience → creative → review → dashboard
- Demand Gen: interests / life events / in-market; image, video, carousel; YouTube / Discover / Gmail previews
- Display: demographics + placements (YouTube channels/videos, sites, apps)
- Shopping: Merchant Center → Standard vs PMax → pick products from feed
- App: installs / engagement (>=50k) / Android pre-registration; preview across Google surfaces

Example or contrast: Feature: Core asset driver; Demand Gen: Images / video / carousel; Display: Images / video / logos; Shopping: Product feed; App installs: App listing + headlines Feature: Extra targeting; Demand Gen: Interests, life events, in-market; Display: Placements (YT, sites, apps); Shopping: Product picker from Merchant Center; App installs: Platform + CPI focus Feature: Merchant Center; Demand Gen: No; Display: No; Shopping: Required; App installs: No

Exam trap: Trap: Forgetting Shopping needs a Merchant Center link - the UI blocks or fails without it
Trap: Selecting App engagement without ~50k installs

MKT-W10-T05

Performance Marketing as Investment Banking

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Performance marketing is capital allocation under uncertainty. Like investment banking and portfolio management, you use historical data, risk appetite, and diversification to place media spend where expected return justifies risk - then you monitor, and cut or double down with good timing. Ads are not "set and forget"; they are managed positions

Core explanation: Investment banking / portfolio idea: Historical performance & ratings; Performance

marketing parallel: Past CTR, CVR, CPC, CPA by campaign Investment banking / portfolio idea: Predictions & market conditions; Performance marketing parallel: Predictive analytics, audience behaviour, platform dynamics Investment banking / portfolio idea: Risk appetite; Performance marketing parallel: Aggressive vs conservative vs hybrid media mix Investment banking / portfolio idea: Portfolio diversification; Performance marketing parallel: Multiple channels / formats so one failure does not wipe ROI Investment banking / portfolio idea: Loss management; Performance marketing parallel: Stop or fix tanking campaigns before spend compounds Investment banking / portfolio idea: Timing of trades; Performance marketing parallel: Do not react too early or too late to KPI moves Concept flow: Historical campaign data - Predict likely outcomes - Allocate budget by risk/return - Diversify channels - Monitor 2-3 weeks of KPIs - Adjust creatives / targeting / mix Better data → better predictions → smarter budget allocation Concept flow: lower risk - moderate - higher risk Rule: Wait for signal; Practice: Analyse at least 2-3 weeks of data before major calls Rule: Do not panic-day-trade; Practice: Avoid decisions on a single day or one thin week Rule: Keep continuous monitoring; Practice: Watch for sustained "tanking" (equivalent to accumulating losses) Rule: Act on sustained KPI failure; Practice: Change creative, targeting, or bids when trends stay wrong KPI: CPC; Full name: Cost per click; Warning signal: Rising for weeks without value; Typical response: Tighten targeting; improve relevance

Must remember:

- Performance marketing ~ = investment banking: data, prediction, risk, diversification, loss control, timing
- Aggressive: YouTube (story-dependent); Conservative: Search (intent); Moderate: Meta lookalike video
- Diversify so one channel's failure does not wipe results
- Use 2-3 weeks of data; key KPIs = CPC, CTR, CPA
- Do not decide too early or too late - manage the portfolio continuously

Example or contrast: Mistake: Act too early; Consequence: React to noise / short-term fluctuation; kill a learning campaign Mistake: Act too late; Consequence: Compound losses; miss the window to repair creatives or targeting

Exam trap: Risk style: Aggressive; Investing metaphor: High-risk stocks / bonds; Performance marketing example: YouTube ads; Character: High upside if storytelling and likability work; higher variance Risk style: Conservative; Investing metaphor: Low-risk instruments; Performance marketing example: Google Search ads; Character: Users already state intent; more predictable; lower risk

MKT-W10-T06 How Digital Ads Work: Behavioural vs Contextual Targeting and ML Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Seeing an ad for something you "just thought about" rarely means the platform read your mind. It usually means signals - past behaviour, current context, and machine learning patterns - matched you to an advertiser's bid. Marketers who understand behavioural vs contextual targeting (and the ML methods underneath) design media that feels personal without relying on myth

Core explanation: Concept flow: Past sites / searches / social - Predict interests - Personalised ads - Current place / content / moment - May layer past signals - Context-fit ads Dimension: Primary input; Behavioural targeting: Past actions, interests, interactions; Contextual targeting: Context of where / what the user is engaged with now Dimension: Data examples; Behavioural targeting: Sites visited, search queries, social behaviour; Contextual targeting: Location, page topic, moment (e.g. at a bar vs at home browsing baby products) Dimension: Strength; Behavioural targeting: High personalisation from proven interest; Contextual targeting: Relevance to present situation; avoids awkward mismatches Dimension: Failure mode; Behavioural targeting: Ads ignore current context (baby ads while out drinking with friends); Contextual targeting: Weak if context alone lacks commercial signal Lens: Pure behavioural inertia; Ad served: Childcare products again; Why: Past search history dominates Lens: Contextual; Ad served: Wine / bar discount offer; Why: Current location and situation dominate Technique: Collaborative filtering; What it does: Infers preference from similar users; Marketing use: If User A and User B both like fitness products, suggest to A what B bought (e.g. tracker accessories) Technique: Clustering; What it does: Groups users with shared traits; Marketing use: Segments: high spenders - premium offers; frequent shoppers - discounts / loyalty Technique: Neighbourhood algorithm; What it does: Uses local trends and proximity; Marketing use: If many users in an

area engage with a topic, related ads reach neighbours / local cohorts Concept flow: Large user + context data - Machine learning - Collaborative filtering - Clustering - Neighbourhood / local - Personalised recommendations - Audience segments - Locally relevant ads Same new parent later meets friends for drinks Advantage of context: Ad fit for present behaviour and environment, not only historical trail. Strong contextual systems can combine past behaviour and present context - relevance at this time and place Machine learning (a subset of AI) improves targeting, relevance, and performance by learning from large behavioural datasets without hard-coding every rule "Everyone has a plan until they get punched in the face." - Mike Tyson (as applied to live campaigns) Plans meet reality when campaigns go live. Success depends on: Staying close to data Knowing when to cut losses vs double down That operational mindset separates strong performance marketers from those who only design the initial plan

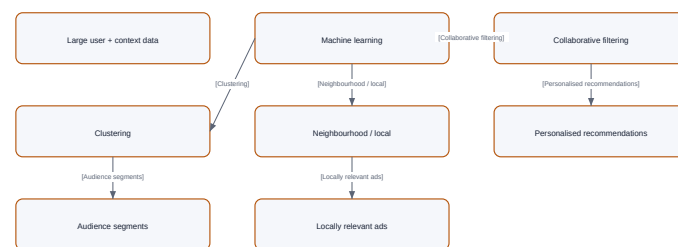
Must remember:

- Behavioural: past actions → personalised ads (e.g. baby products after childcare research)
- Contextual: current situation/location/content → fit-for-now ads (e.g. wine offer at a bar)
- Best practice: relevance from context, often layered with behavioural signals
- ML tools: collaborative filtering, clustering, neighbourhood/local trends
- Live campaigns require data closeness, fast adaptation, and smart loss-cutting

Example or contrast: A new parent researches childcare products online Algorithm observes pattern → serves Pampers and related ads across feeds Ads feel timely because they reflect demonstrated interest

Exam trap: Trap: Claiming ads "read minds" - explain with behavioural/contextual signals + ML instead
Trap: Treating behavioural and contextual as the same; one keys off history, the other off present context

How Digital Ads Work: Behavioural vs Contextual Targeting and ML



Vector reconstruction of the source Mernall visual

Concept map: How Digital Ads Work: Behavioural vs Contextual Targeting and ML

MKT-W10-T07 Week 10 Summary: Targeting, Context, and Machine Learning in Digital Ads

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Digital ad success is not only creative craft - it is placing the right message with the right person at the right moment. This module's spine is how behavioural signals, contextual signals, and machine learning techniques combine so campaigns feel personalised and drive business results

Core explanation: Concept flow: Behavioural targeting - Contextual targeting - Collaborative filtering - Clustering - Right person + right moment - targeting - ml - Engagement and business outcomes Idea: Personalise ads from what users already did - actions, interests, interactions Signal type: Past visits / searches / social; Role: Reveal interest patterns Signal type: Predicted affinity; Role: Match creative and offer Focus: Present place / activity / content; Ensures: Ad relevance now Focus: Optional behavioural layer; Ensures: Continuity with known interests without ignoring situation Concept: Collaborative filtering; Role in campaigns: Recommend what similar users liked / bought - near-personalised suggestions Concept: Clustering; Role in campaigns: Group similar users (e.g. high spenders vs frequent shoppers) - tailored creatives and offers Outcome: Ads feel relevant because they follow demonstrated behaviour (e.g. fitness browsers see gym and supplement offers) Layer: Products & goals; Module theme: Search, Display, Shopping, App (ACI / ACE / pre-reg), Demand Gen Idea: Serve ads based on the user's current context (location, environment, content) - often layered with past behavioural data so the message fits this moment, not only history Layer: Capital allocation; Module theme: Risk profiles, diversification, KPI timing (CPC, CTR, CPA) Layer: Delivery

science; Module theme: Behavioural + contextual + ML Outcome: Fewer mismatched impressions; better timing of offers Together, these approaches help build hyper-personalised, efficient campaigns: similar-user recommendations plus segment-level messaging Across the week, Google Ads for e-commerce and apps, Shopping vs app campaign types, lab setup fluency, and the investment-banking risk lens all sit on this foundation: Without targeting science, media budgets buy impressions; with it, they buy qualified attention

Must remember:

- Behavioural targeting: ads from user actions, interests, interactions
- Contextual targeting: ads from current context (+ optional behavioural layer) for time/place fit
- Collaborative filtering: similar-user preference transfer → recommendations
- Clustering: group similar users → segment-specific creative and offers
- Combined: more targeted, personalised, effective campaigns and meaningful business results

Exam trap: Trap: Defining contextual targeting as "only past behaviour" - contextual is present-situation led (often with behavioural layering) Trap: Omitting collaborative filtering or clustering when asked how ML personalises ads

Week 10 Exam Lens**Likely questions**

- Define and explain Google Ads for E-commerce and App Marketing; include the mechanism and one limitation.
- Compare Google Ads for E-commerce and App Marketing with App Campaigns on Google Ads: Foundational Knowledge and state when each is preferred.
- Apply Google Ads Lab: Demand Gen, Display, Shopping, and App Promotion to a realistic system or business scenario and justify the decision.

10-mark answer frame: Start with a precise definition; draw or state the causal flow; explain each stage and metric; add a comparison or worked example; close with trade-offs, failure modes, and the decision rule.

Mistakes to avoid: Trap: Treating "Google Ads" as synonymous with Search only. Shopping, Display, and app campaigns are core for ecom/apps Trap: Running ACE without meeting the ~50,000 install eligibility - campaigns need a large enough base Trap: Trying to run Shopping without Merchant Center - the feed is mandatory

Week 11: Google Analytics and Attribution

Week roadmap: Introduction to Google Analytics and Attribution Models → Google Analytics: Foundational Knowledge → Google Analytics Account Structure → Key Concepts and Metrics in Google Analytics → Sample Live Google Analytics Report Walkthrough → Attribution Models: Concept and Examples → 1 more topics.

Coverage: 7 exact source topics; definitions and mechanisms come first, followed by formulas, examples, and traps where applicable.

MKT-W11-T01 Introduction to Google Analytics and Attribution Models

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Digital marketing without measurement is guesswork. Google Analytics turns site and app activity into metrics you can act on. Attribution modelling answers a harder question: when a customer saw seven ads before buying, which channel deserves credit - and budget?

Core explanation: Need: Track campaigns; What Analytics Provides: Volume, quality, and path of traffic Need: Monitor performance; What Analytics Provides: Engagement, drop-offs, conversion rates Need: Measure effectiveness; What Analytics Provides: ROI and goal completion, not vanity clicks Need: Improve strategies; What Analytics Provides: Data-backed fixes to creatives, pages, and spend Concept flow: Key metrics in GA - Strategic use of metrics - Attribution modelling - Better budget and campaign decisions With most marketing moving online, reading platform data well can make or break a campaign Metrics are not just numbers - they encode insight about success and gaps Learn what each metric means and how to use it for performance improvement Cover user engagement, traffic sources, and conversion rates Process of assigning conversion credit across marketing touchpoints Customers often interact with multiple channels before converting Needed to evaluate channel effectiveness and allocate resources efficiently Assess campaign success with core GA concepts Optimise marketing strategies using measurement Deliver measurable results instead of gut-feel spend

Must remember:

- Digital analytics tracks, monitors, and measures campaign effectiveness
- GA metrics support engagement, source, and conversion analysis
- Attribution assigns credit across touchpoints before a conversion
- Goal: data-driven decisions, smarter budget allocation, measurable results

Example or contrast: An e-commerce brand runs Google Ads, Meta ads, and email. Sales rise, but without attribution you cannot tell whether to raise Google spend or email frequency. Analytics measures outcomes; attribution decides where credit (and next rupee) goes

Exam trap: Trap: Treating every metric as equally important. Engagement without conversion may not be success Trap: Reading traffic volume without source quality. High visits from the wrong channel waste budget

Introduction to Google Analytics and Attribution Models



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: Introduction to Google Analytics and Attribution Models

MKT-W11-T02

Google Analytics: Foundational Knowledge

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Google Analytics (GA) is a free Google web analytics service that tracks and reports website and app traffic. For marketers, it answers three practical questions: who visits, what they do, and whether marketing goals are being met

Core explanation: Capability: Track visitors; Marketer Benefit: Who is on the site / app Capability: Report engagement; Marketer Benefit: How users interact with content Capability: Measure marketing; Marketer Benefit: Which channels drive valuable actions Capability: Support optimisation; Marketer Benefit: Continuous testing guided by data Concept flow: GA tracking code / page tag - Website or app pages - Records user activity - GA reports and insights GA turns raw behavioural data into insights that improve ROI, user experience, and goal achievement How are users engaging with my site? Aspect: Behaviour tracking; What It Monitors: Popular pages, time on site, navigation paths; Marketing Use: See the site through users' eyes How can outreach campaigns become more effective and accountable? Aspect: Traffic sources; What It Monitors: Organic, social, paid, and other origins; Marketing Use: Know which channels drive engagement Is my content working? Aspect: Audience insights; What It Monitors: Demographics, location, devices; Marketing Use: Tailor content and media to the right people Where do users enter and exit? Aspect: Conversion tracking; What It Monitors: Purchases, sign-ups, form submissions; Marketing Use: Confirm marketing achieves desired results How can I improve on-site experience? Reason: Improve ROI; Practical Meaning: Spotlight channels that deliver best results A small JavaScript snippet (page tag / tracking code) is added to pages or apps Reason: Optimise UX; Practical Meaning: Find high bounce / falloff pages and fix them That code is the foundation of all data GA collects Reason: Data-driven decisions; Practical Meaning: Use real-time and historical data for content and spend Without correct installation, reports are incomplete or empty Reason: Goal monitoring; Practical Meaning: Track e-commerce sales, sign-ups, form completions against objectives Together these give a near-360 view of website and marketing performance Bottom line: GA converts raw data into actionable insight so marketers can improve sites and campaigns

Must remember:

- GA = free Google service for website/app traffic and behaviour
- Works via a page-tag JavaScript tracking code
- Core pillars: behaviour, traffic sources, audience, conversions
- Helps ROI, UX, data-driven decisions, and goal monitoring
- Raw data → insights → smarter marketing

Example or contrast: A fashion retailer sees strong traffic but weak purchases. Behaviour reports show product pages with short visits and exits; traffic sources show most visits from a cheap display campaign. The marketer cuts spend on that channel, improves product page load and imagery, and rechecks conversion events - a classic GA feedback loop

Exam trap: Trap: Equating high traffic with success. Volume without conversion or engagement can be wasted spend Trap: Forgetting that the tracking code must be installed correctly. No tag, no trustworthy data

MKT-W11-T03

Google Analytics Account Structure

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: GA4 data is only as useful as how it is organised. The hierarchy Account → Property → Data stream tells you where company-wide settings live, where brand/product data is stored, and how each website or app feeds events into Analytics

Core explanation: Concept flow: Account - organisation / parent - Property - brand or product line - Property - another entity - Web data stream - iOS app stream - Android app stream Level: Account; Role: Parent container for the organisation; Example (Nike-style): Nike's overarching GA account Level: Property; Role: Specific business entity, brand, or product line; Example (Nike-style): Nike Air as one property Level: Data stream; Role: Channel that sends data from a touchpoint into GA; Example (Nike-style): Web, iOS app, Android app Each property can have up to three stream types: web, iOS, and Android. Users may browse on web and purchase on app - separate streams still roll up under one property for cross-platform analysis when set up correctly

Must remember:

- Structure: Account → Property → Data stream (web / iOS / Android)
- Cross-platform users can be understood via multiple streams under one property
- GA4 uses an event-based data model
- Dimensions = what; metrics = how many
- Correct structure is the foundation for collection, organisation, and analysis

Example or contrast: Level: Account; Pizza Store Mapping: The pizza business as one organisation Level: Property 1; Pizza Store Mapping: Customer-facing website / ordering app Level: Property 2; Pizza Store Mapping: Delivery-driver app / portal

Exam trap: Trap: Confusing account with property. Account = organisation; property = brand/entity being measured Trap: Assuming one stream equals one company. Streams are per platform (web/iOS/Android) under a property

MKT-W11-T04**Key Concepts and Metrics in Google Analytics**

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: GA4 measures nearly everything as events, then layers concepts like sessions, users, engagement, acquisition, and conversions on top. UTM parameters tell Analytics which campaign link brought a visit. Reports package these ideas so each report answers a specific marketing question

Core explanation: Concept: Events; Meaning: Almost all activity is an event; some auto-tracked (page views, scroll), some custom (e.g. add to cart); Marketer Takeaway: Configure business-critical actions Concept: Conversions / key events; Meaning: Valuable actions: purchase, sign-up, lead form; Marketer Takeaway: Not all events are equal Concept: Acquisition; Meaning: Where users come from (social, ads, direct, etc.); Marketer Takeaway: Explains traffic origin Concept: Engagement; Meaning: Depth of interaction beyond simple land-and-leave; Marketer Takeaway: Prefer engaged sessions over vanity bounce alone Concept: Hits; Meaning: Interactions that send data to GA (page, event, commerce hits, etc.); Marketer Takeaway: Building blocks of recorded activity Concept: Session; Meaning: Group of user hits within a time window; default ends after 30 minutes of inactivity; Marketer Takeaway: Visit-level analysis unit Concept: User; Meaning: Repeat sessions tied to the same browser cookie / identifier; Marketer Takeaway: Person-level (approx.) view Concept: Goals; Meaning: How well the site meets objectives (destination, duration, pages/screens per session, events); Marketer Takeaway: Align reporting to business targets Metric: Bounce rate; Definition: Percentage of sessions that were not engaged sessions Metric: Average session duration; Definition: Average time users spend in a session on site or app Term: Source; Answers: Where traffic originates; Examples: Google, Facebook, LinkedIn, a referring domain Term: Medium; Answers: How traffic originated; Examples: Organic, paid/CPC, social, email, referral Term: Channel; Answers: Top-level grouping of source + medium; Examples: Organic Search, Direct, Social, Email, Paid Search An engaged session meets at least one of: Report type: Acquisition; Core question: How did users get here?; Typical contents: Traffic sources, Google Ads, Search Console insights Lasts longer than 10 seconds, or Report type: Behaviour; Core question: What did they do after arriving?; Typical contents: Site speed, events, page timings, site search Has one or more conversion / key events, or Report type: Audience; Core question: Who is visiting?; Typical contents: Demographics, interests, geo, new vs returning, tech/device Has two or more page or screen views Report type: Conversion; Core question: Did they do what we wanted?; Typical contents: Goals, e-commerce, multichannel funnels, attribution, goal funnel visualisation Concept flow: Acquisition: how they arrived - Audience: who they are - Behaviour: what they did - Conversion: did they convert Dimension: Source (utmsource); Role: Where visitors come from; Typical use: Ad platform / publisher (e.g. facebook, google) Dimension: Medium (utmmedium); Role: Marketing medium; Typical use: paid, cpc, email, social, organic Dimension: Campaign (utmcampaign); Role: Campaign name; Typical use: monsoonsale, brandretarget Dimension: Term (utmterm); Role: Keyword or audience identifier; Typical use: Paid search keywords / audiences Dimension: Content (utmcontent); Role: Ad or creative variation; Typical use: Distinguish creatives A vs B UTM codes are query parameters appended to a URL so GA receives campaign detail for that link Symbol: ?; Role: Starts the query string Symbol: =; Role: Separates parameter name and value Symbol: &; Role: Separates

multiple UTM parameters

Must remember:

- GA4 is event-centric; conversions = valuable key events
- Engaged session: 10s OR key event OR ≥ 2 page/screen views
- Default session timeout: 30 minutes of inactivity
- Source / medium / channel explain acquisition
- Main report families: acquisition, behaviour, audience, conversion
- UTMs: source, medium, campaign (+ term, content); join with ? and &
- Source + medium are the most important tagging pair

Example or contrast: Parameter: Source; Value: facebook / meta Parameter: Medium; Value: paid / social Parameter: Campaign; Value: monsoonsale

Exam trap: Trap: Treating every event as a conversion. Conversions are key business actions only Trap: Confusing bounce rate with "left after one second." In modern GA logic it is % of non-engaged sessions

MKT-W11-T05

Sample Live Google Analytics Report Walkthrough

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Reading GA well means knowing which report answers which question. The home and real-time views show activity now and recently; advertising and lifecycle reports connect channels to key events; Explore lets you build custom paths (valuable for e-commerce funnels). Always note that changing the attribution model can change credited conversion numbers

Core explanation: Area: Active / new users; What You Typically See: Scale of current and recent audience Area: Average engagement time; What You Typically See: How long people stay Area: Active users (last 30 minutes); What You Typically See: Near real-time activity, often by country Area: Engaged sessions per active user; What You Typically See: Visit frequency / depth signal Area: Breakdowns; What You Typically See: Country, new vs returning, and related cuts Channel pattern: Direct; Meaning: Typed URL / bookmarks / unclassified direct Channel pattern: Paid Google ads; Meaning: Google Ads traffic Channel pattern: Organic search; Meaning: Unpaid search listings From the home cards you can drill into any metric for deeper breakdowns Channel pattern: Referral / cross-network; Meaning: Other sites or cross-network placements Useful for live monitoring: Where traffic is coming from (geography / channels) What users are doing right now (page views, engagement, clicks on key actions) Ideal when launching a campaign or checking whether a spike is real Example observation: Last-click key events $\approx 1,465,000$; Implication: One credit rule Shows key events broken by acquisition patterns such as: Example observation: Data-driven key events $\approx 1,479,000$; Implication: Slightly different credit - different totals Need: E-commerce funnel; Approach: Path exploration or similar Explore templates Need: Funnel steps; Approach: Define events (session start - product view - ...) Gives a consolidated view when you run Google Ads, Meta ads, and other paid media Need: Flexible analysis; Approach: Pick a template; map event/page names yourself Shows common conversion paths (e.g. 100% direct vs paths involving paid search) and how much each path pattern contributes to key events Concept flow: User acquisition - Traffic acquisition - Users - often first acquisition context - Sessions - how visits arrive Changing the model redistributes credit and can change reported key-event totals Report: User acquisition; Focus: New users / first-acquisition style view; Rough interpretation: Split of users (new/returning context) by channel; engagement time per active user Report: Traffic acquisition; Focus: Session-based; Rough interpretation: How sessions arrive, irrespective of treating each visit as a separate traffic event Exam-critical idea: numbers move when the attribution model changes - not because reality changed, but because credit rules changed Summarises conversions across Direct, Organic Search, Referral, Paid Search Network, and similar groupings - useful for multi-platform campaign review in one place Conceptual difference used in practice: user-oriented views emphasise people (historically linked to identifiers); traffic-oriented views emphasise sessions and how interactions arrive Both typically show channel splits and engagement-related metrics

Must remember:

- Home / real-time: active users, engagement, geography, live behaviour
- Ads views: key events, attribution paths, model comparison, conversion performance

- Explore: custom path / funnel analysis (strong for e-commerce)
- User acquisition $\approx$ people / first acquisition; traffic acquisition $\approx$ sessions
- Changing attribution models changes credited conversion counts

Example or contrast: An e-commerce brand launches a festive campaign. Real-time confirms India-heavy traffic ramping in. Key event performance shows Paid Search driving add-to-cart, but under last-click, Direct steals checkout credit. Switching to data-driven attribution lifts Paid Search's credited share - protecting the paid budget that last-click undercounted

Exam trap: Trap: Reading home snapshot totals as campaign ROI without channel and conversion context
Trap: Assuming attribution model is fixed. Different models $\rightarrow$ different credited key events

MKT-W11-T06

Attribution Models: Concept and Examples

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Customers rarely convert after one ad. Research often cites roughly seven digital touchpoints before purchase. Attribution modelling stitches those touchpoints together and decides how much conversion credit each channel receives - so budgets reflect real contribution, not just the last click

Core explanation: Concept flow: Touch 1 - Touch 2 - ... - Touch N - Conversion - Who gets credit? - Attribution model In an omnichannel, fragmented landscape, single-touch thinking misallocates spend. Attribution is the framework that answers contribution, not just last interaction Category: Rule-based; How credit is set: Fixed human-defined rules; Examples: First click, last click, linear, time decay, position-based Category: Non-rule-based; How credit is set: Algorithm / ML from observed behaviour; Examples: Data-driven attribution Model: First click / first touch; Credit logic: 100% to the first touchpoint; Who wins in the example: Google Ad only Model: Last click; Credit logic: 100% to the final touchpoint before conversion; Who wins in the example: Facebook retargeting only Model: Linear; Credit logic: Equal share across all touchpoints; Who wins in the example: Each of 5 touches gets 20% Model: Time decay; Credit logic: More credit to touches closer to conversion; Who wins in the example: Email / Facebook get more; early Google Ad less Model: Position-based (U-shaped); Credit logic: $\sim 40\%$ first + $\sim 40\%$ last; remaining $\sim 20\%$ split among middle; Who wins in the example: Google Ad and Facebook heavy; form, webinar, email share the middle Concept flow: 100% first - 100% last - Equal % each - higher weight near conversion - 40% first + 40% last + 20% middle Assume a journey: Google Ad $\rightarrow$ Website form $\rightarrow$ Webinar $\rightarrow$ Email click $\rightarrow$ Facebook retargeting $\rightarrow$ Purchase Character role: Friend who first introduces the couple; Journey role: First touch / awareness; Models that favour them: First click Character role: Friend who hosts a later meetup; Journey role: Mid-funnel nurture; Models that favour them: Linear / middle of U-shape Character role: Friend who pushes the final proposal; Journey role: Last push before "convert"; Models that favour them: Last click; heavy under time decay Model: Last click; "Who gets thanked": Only the last encourager Model: First click; "Who gets thanked": Only the first introducer Roughly 40% to first touch and 40% to last touch Model: Linear; "Who gets thanked": First, middle, and last encouragers equally Remaining $\sim 20\%$ split evenly across middle touchpoints Model: Time decay; "Who gets thanked": Most to the last encourager, then middle, then first Values in examples may be stated as $\sim 30\text{--}40\%$ for ends and $\sim 10\%$ each for three middle steps - same U-shaped idea A simple analogy (wedding-toast credit) maps friends to touch roles: Feature: Engine; Description: Machine learning / AI Feature: Logic; Description: Learns from real conversion paths and behavioural signals Feature: Advantage; Description: More adaptive credit than fixed rules; less human bias in weights Takeaway: pick (and state) your attribution model deliberately - do not leave credit ambiguous Data-driven models redistribute credit based on how touchpoints actually change conversion probability in your data - not on a pre-set percentage table

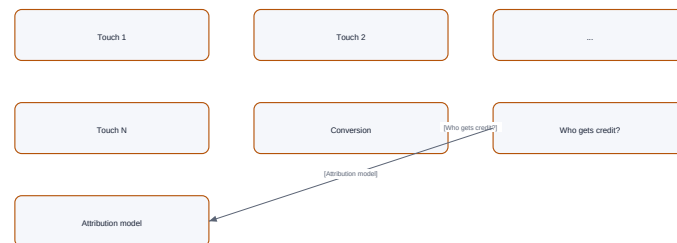
Must remember:

- ~ 7 touchpoints before purchase $\rightarrow$ multi-touch credit problem
- Rule-based: first, last, linear, time decay, position-based (U-shape $\sim 40/20/40$)
- Non-rule-based: data-driven (ML / real behaviour)
- First = awareness credit; last = closer credit; linear = equal; time decay = recent-heavy; U-shape = first+last heavy
- Model choice directly affects how marketers allocate budget

Example or contrast: Path: Paid Search (first) → Blog → Email → Retargeting (last) → Purchase If finance uses: Last click; Paid Search budget signal: Underfunded awareness; Retargeting signal: Overfunded If finance uses: Linear; Paid Search budget signal: Shared fairly by touch count; Retargeting signal: Shared fairly

Exam trap: Trap: Believing last click is "the" true model. It ignores awareness and assist channels Trap: Believing first click is always fair. It ignores closers that seal the sale

Attribution Models: Concept and Examples



Vector reconstruction of the source Memmald visual

Concept map: Attribution Models: Concept and Examples

MKT-W11-T07

Week Summary: Google Analytics and Attribution

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: This module ties measurement to money decisions. Google Analytics supplies the metrics that show what users do; attribution models decide how conversion credit is shared across the many touchpoints that preceded a sale. Together they turn digital marketing from activity into accountable performance

Core explanation: Concept flow: GA metrics and concepts - Improve effectiveness - Attribution models - Credit across touchpoints - Apply insights to performance Theme: Key GA metrics; Core takeaway: Engagement, acquisition, sessions/users, conversions - used to judge and improve campaigns Theme: Strategic use; Core takeaway: Metrics guide experience fixes, channel focus, and goal tracking - not vanity reporting Theme: Attribution modelling; Core takeaway: Rule-based and data-driven methods assign conversion credit across touchpoints Theme: Application readiness; Core takeaway: Use these foundations to improve marketing performance with measurement Question: What happened on site/app?; Tool / idea: GA events, sessions, engagement, reports Question: Where did users come from?; Tool / idea: Source, medium, channel, UTMs Question: Did they complete valued actions?; Tool / idea: Key events / conversions Question: Which touchpoints deserve credit?; Tool / idea: Attribution models Question: Where should next budget go?; Tool / idea: Credit + ROI reading of channels

Must remember:

- Module focus: GA metrics + attribution for digital marketing effectiveness
- Metrics explain engagement, traffic, and conversions
- Attribution assigns credit across multi-touch journeys
- Outcome: apply analytics insights to improve marketing performance

Example or contrast: A performance marketer reviews GA key events by channel, finds high assisted paths through Paid Search → Email → Retargeting, and rejects last-click-only budget cuts to Paid Search. Attribution literacy prevents killing the upper funnel that made retargeting look "efficient."

Exam trap: Trap: Memorising metrics without linking them to decisions. Measurement must change budgets or UX Trap: Separating GA and attribution in your mind. Attribution is how multi-channel GA journeys get scored

Week 11 Exam Lens

Likely questions

- Define and explain Introduction to Google Analytics and Attribution Models; include the mechanism and one limitation.
- Compare Introduction to Google Analytics and Attribution Models with Google Analytics: Foundational Knowledge and state when each is preferred.
- Apply Google Analytics Account Structure to a realistic system or business scenario and justify the decision.

10-mark answer frame: Start with a precise definition; draw or state the causal flow; explain each stage and metric; add a comparison or worked example; close with trade-offs, failure modes, and the decision rule.

Mistakes to avoid: Trap: Treating every metric as equally important. Engagement without conversion may not be success Trap: Equating high traffic with success. Volume without conversion or engagement can be wasted spend Trap: Confusing account with property. Account = organisation; property = brand/entity being measured

Week 12: Storytelling and Thinking Models

Week roadmap: Storytelling and Thinking Models: Module Introduction → Storytelling Formats, Styles, Tactics, and Use Cases → Real-World Business Storytelling → Thinking Models for Clearer Marketing Decisions → The Map Is Not the Territory, Five Whys, and the IUR Model → Storytelling and Thinking Models: Module Summary.

Coverage: 6 exact source topics; definitions and mechanisms come first, followed by formulas, examples, and traps where applicable.

MKT-W12-T01 Storytelling and Thinking Models: Module Introduction

Tier C

Definition and why it matters: Workplaces drown people in data, reports, metrics, and slides - yet most of that information is forgettable. Stories turn scattered facts into something people understand, feel, and recall. Thinking models do the complementary job: they structure how you analyse a problem before you try to persuade anyone. Used together, they give you clarity in understanding and clarity in communicating

Core explanation: Concept flow: Raw information - Thinking models - Clear diagnosis - Storytelling - Audience understands, remembers, acts Skill: Storytelling; Core job: Structure ideas so humans connect and remember; Without it: Facts feel flat; messages do not stick

Must remember:

- Information alone is not memorable; stories create understanding, relation, and recall
- Thinking models = simple tools to analyse, break down problems, and decide better
- Dual skill: clarity of diagnosis + clarity of communication
- Business story ingredients: audience, emotional hook, structure, resonance
- Apply both in presentations, meetings, strategy, and everyday influence
- Goal: right story built on right thinking so people connect with your ideas

Exam trap: Trap: Treating storytelling as decoration ("add a customer quote at the end"). Storytelling is the structure of the message, not garnish Trap: Separating emotion from logic. Thinking without story fails to move people; story without thinking moves them toward the wrong action

MKT-W12-T02 Storytelling Formats, Styles, Tactics, and Use Cases

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Facts inform; stories make people feel and therefore remember. "Customer service needs improvement" is data. Describing a customer who tried repeatedly to get help, grew frustrated, and was finally helped by one employee who listened - that creates empathy. In marketing, the job is often to turn the same insight into a narrative the audience can visualise and carry with them

Core explanation: Stories activate imagination in a way lists of facts do not. They help people: Empathise with others' situations Question: Who is listening?; Why it matters: CEO vs media buyer vs consumer need different stakes Question: What do they fear / want?; Why it matters: Sets the emotional hook Question: What decision should they make?; Why it matters: Shapes the ending of the story Concept flow: Why - purpose / belief - How - approach - What - product / feature / offer Visualise scenes and outcomes Remember messages long after details fade Weak open: "We are launching a new feature."; Stronger open: "Users have wasted hours on the same workflow. This feature cuts that friction and gives them time back." Marketing example: "Cart abandonment is 72%" vs "Maya added running shoes, hesitated at shipping cost, and left - three times this month." The second line makes the metric actionable for creative, UX, and media teams Designing a story without a clear audience is like writing a love letter addressed "to whom it may concern." Precision of audience equals impact Simon Sinek's Golden Circle: Why → How → What Business communicators often jump to what (feature, change, SKU). Without why, the message lacks context and emotional connection The second paints the pain, justifies the solution, and invites care Element: Location; Role: Sets the scene; Tip: Enough place sense; avoid overload Contrast is movement between two states: what is vs what could be; problem vs possibility. It creates narrative tension, discovery, and resolution - the same rhythm real life uses Element: Action; Role: What people do; Tip: Creates forward momentum Classic product narrative (iPhone launch style): Element: Thoughts; Role: Internal perspective; Tip: Raw, unfiltered cognition Competitors

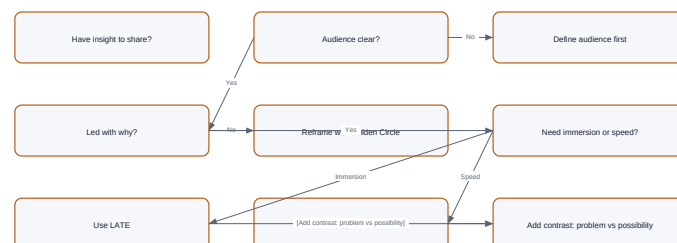
exist - but fall short in specific ways
 Element: Emotions; Role: Human reactions; Tip: Show via behaviour / body language, or name them
 Current phones struggle with software limits
 Element: Dialogue; Role: Voices in the moment; Tip: Makes the scene audible and alive
 Here is the revolutionary interface / OS that resolves the gap
 Back-and-forth (challenge → solution) made the reveal feel inevitable and unforgettable - not a feature dump, but a narrative
 Marketing use: before/after creatives, "old way / new way" landing pages, retention stories (pain of churn → relief of fix)
 LATE = Location, Action, Thoughts, Emotions, Dialogue. Use it to slow a moment down so the audience can almost see it
 Letter: Person; Meaning: Who the story is about; Example: A new app user
 Letter: Protagonist; Meaning: The struggle / focal tension; Example: Struggle with onboarding
 Letter: Time; Meaning: When it happens; Example: First 5 minutes in-app
 Concept flow: Have insight to share? - Audience clear? - Define audience first - Led with why? - Reframe with Golden Circle - Need immersion or speed? - Use LATE - Use PPT - Add contrast: problem vs possibility
 Together, LATE turns an informational update into a human scene
 Tool: Love letter rule; Best when: Scope / stakeholder alignment is unclear

Must remember:

- Stories convert information into something people feel, visualise, and remember
- Love letter rule: no audience → no impact
- Golden Circle: lead with Why, then How, then What
- Contrast: problem <→ possibility creates motion and engagement
- LATE: Location, Action, Thoughts, Emotions, Dialogue (immersive scenes)
- PPT: Person, Protagonist, Time (quick business-story foundation)
- Pick depth (LATE) vs speed (PPT); always keep audience and why clear

Exam trap: Trap: Confusing Golden Circle with "start with features." Correct order is Why → How → What
 Trap: Mixing LATE with PPT. LATE = Location, Action, Thoughts, Emotions, Dialogue. PPT = Person, Protagonist, Time

Storytelling Formats, Styles, Tactics, and Use Cases



Vector reconstruction of the source Miro visual

Concept map: Storytelling Formats, Styles, Tactics, and Use Cases

MKT-W12-T03

Real-World Business Storytelling

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: World-class storytellers (Pixar, Disney, great product marketers) do not keep audiences at one emotional pitch. They move people between warm joy and vulnerability, tension and release. Business storytelling uses the same wiring - subtly - so the audience feels the customer's pain and then the relief of the solution, and therefore trusts and acts

Core explanation: Rapid shifts in emotion deepen impact. The simplified science: Emotional moment: Happy / warm; Chemical signal (simplified): Dopamine; Audience effect: Attention, motivation, engagement
 Emotional moment: Sad / vulnerable; Chemical signal (simplified): Oxytocin; Audience effect: Empathy, trust, connection
 Moment type: Light / hopeful; Chemical signal (simplified): Endorphins; Effect: Relaxation, openness to new ideas
 Moment type: Tension / uncertainty; Chemical signal (simplified): Cortisol; Effect: Sharper attention, sense of urgency
 When these shifts occur close together, the story lands more deeply - which is why certain film scenes stay for years
 Concept flow: Customer pain / confusion - Mild tension - attention up - Solution / transformation - Relief / satisfaction - Trust and readiness to act
 Business application: open with

user frustration → show relief after the solution. Emotion is not decoration; it helps the audience connect and act Practical ways to create this in marketing: Play a real customer-support moment (frustration becomes tangible) Use authentic user quotes or summarised research findings Pair one human quote with a slide of numbers so the data has a face A flat story loses attention. A well-shaped story rises and falls like a roller coaster: tension and release keep the mind awake Source of authenticity: Creators' real fears / life (Finding Nemo ← parental anxiety, overprotectiveness, learning to let go); Why it works: Genuine emotion becomes the heart of the story Source of authenticity: Real customer experiences; Why it works: Relatable proof, not slogans Source of authenticity: Real team efforts and lessons learned; Why it works: Credible culture and brand Film parallel: sequences that move quickly from joy (falling in love) to sadness create lasting bonds with the audience (Up-style opening contrast) Describe confusion, frustration, or inefficiency (tension) Tone: Earth; Character: Deep, grounded, authoritative; Strategic use: Strategy reviews, risk, governance Show clarity, relief, or improvement after your solution (release) Tone: Water; Character: Calm, gentle, flowing energy; Strategic use: Empathy, support narratives, sensitive topics Without intentional highs and lows, attention levels out and fades Tone: Fire; Character: Energetic, passionate, inspiring; Strategic use: Launches, vision pitches, rally moments Rule: don't try to be clever - try to be real. Authenticity builds trust faster than polished perfection Tone: Metal; Character: Bright, confident, enthusiastic; Strategic use: Wins, momentum updates, sales demos Business translation: instead of stating a mission as a poster line, make people feel it through a real story. "Customer-obsessed" is a claim; a specific recovery story is evidence Voice shapes emotional tone. Four useful vocal tones (linked to element metaphors): Beat: Open; Technique: Tension / cortisol lift; Example: "Checkout errors spiked on mobile last week..." Beat: Humanise; Technique: Quote or support clip; Example: "...one user: 'I just wanted to buy birthday gifts'" Beat: Contrast; Technique: Problem - possibility; Example: Old flow vs fixed flow

Must remember:

- Emotional contrast: joy/vulnerability shifts deepen engagement (dopamine / oxytocin framing)
- Roller coaster: alternate tension and release (cortisol / endorphins) to hold attention
- Business pattern: customer pain → solution relief
- Authenticity cleverness; root stories in real experiences
- Voice tones: earth, water, fire, metal - each has a strategic job
- Speak to mind and heart so the message is remembered, felt, and acted upon

Exam trap: Trap: Equating "emotional storytelling" with melodrama. Professional use is subtle contrast - pain then relief - not theatrical overacting Trap: Mixing chemical pairings. Emotional contrast (happy ↔ sad) is often linked to dopamine/oxytocin; roller-coaster (hope ↔ tension) to endorphins/cortisol

Real-World Business Storytelling



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: Real-World Business Storytelling

Definition and why it matters: Storytelling persuades; thinking models decide what is worth persuading for. The best marketers do not only ask "How do we say this?" - they ask "Have we broken the problem down correctly? What happens next? How could this fail?" These models are practical lenses, not academic ornaments

Core explanation: Concept flow: First principles - Rebuild from fundamentals - Second-order thinking - Trace long-term ripples - Inversion - Avoid paths to failure - Range model - Diverge then converge Idea: Break a problem to fundamental truths, then rebuild a solution from the ground up - instead of copying analogies, benchmarks, or "how it's always been done." Aspect: Popularised by; Detail: Elon Musk (widely associated example) Aspect: Goal; Detail: Innovation; remove baggage of analogy Aspect: Method; Detail: Question assumptions - isolate basics - redesign Aspect: Associated with; Detail: Ray Dalio (among others) Aspect: Goal; Detail: Avoid short-term fixes that create long-term disasters Aspect: Championed by; Detail: Charlie Munger SpaceX example: Buying rockets was expensive. Cost of raw materials (aluminium, titanium, copper, etc.) was only a small fraction of market price. By sourcing and redesigning manufacturing, rockets were built at a fraction of the prior cost Aspect: Famous line; Detail: Want to know where you'd "die" so you never go there Marketing example: Instead of "competitors spend 5% of revenue on ads, so we should too," ask: What is the fundamental job of acquisition spend? What is true CAC needed for payback at our margins? Rebuild budget from unit economics, not category folklore Aspect: Goal; Detail: Surface hidden risks and obstacles Idea: First-order thinking stops at the immediate outcome. Second-order thinking asks "And then what?" - the ripple effects and long-term consequences Classic policy trap: A city bounty for killed rats seemed smart - until people bred rats to collect rewards. The first-order win became a second-order failure Phase: Divergence; What you do: Explore different fields, skills, perspectives Marketing example: Heavy discounting lifts this month's sales (first order) → trains customers to wait for deals, erodes brand premium, and hurts full-price conversion (second order). Ask: after the coupon ends, then what? Phase: Convergence; What you do: Bring ideas together to solve a specific problem Idea: Approach the problem backward. Instead of "How do I succeed?" ask "How would I fail?" - then avoid those paths

Must remember:

- First principles: strip assumptions; rebuild from basics (SpaceX materials logic)
- Second-order: ask "and then what?" to catch ripple effects
- Inversion: map failure modes, then avoid them (Munger)
- Range: diverge across domains, then converge on the problem
- Occam: prefer simplest adequate explanation
- Pareto 80/20: focus the vital few inputs
- Chesterton's Fence: understand before removing
- Survivorship bias + base rate neglect: don't let vivid winners erase the unseen and the averages

Exam trap: Trap: Confusing first principles with first-order thinking. First principles = rebuild from fundamentals. First-order = only immediate effects (the shallow half of second-order thinking) Trap: Calling Pareto "80% effort → 80% results." Correct intuition: ~20% of inputs drive ~80% of outcomes

MKT-W12-T05

The Map Is Not the Territory, Five Whys, and the IUR Model

Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Every framework in this module is a map - useful, portable, incomplete. Reality is the territory. Blind faith in dashboards, forecasts, or playbooks is how good-looking plans fail in market. The fix is not abandoning models; it is treating them as tools, digging to root causes (Five Whys), and knowing whether you face ignorance, uncertainty, or risk (IUR) before you bet the budget

Core explanation: From Alfred Korzybski's idea: any model, framework, or representation is a simplified version of reality - the model is not the reality. Matters because models always leave something out Map (model): Revenue projection chart; Territory (reality): Actual demand, competition, execution Map (model): "Next Taco Bell" franchise playbook; Territory (reality): Consumer behaviour that did not follow the script Map (model): Tesla-style investment thesis from neat slides; Territory (reality): Live markets, regulation, sentiment, timing Concept flow: Model / forecast / framework - Messy reality - Blind trust in model - Surprise failure - Models + root cause + IUR - Better bets 1980s reminder: concepts pitched as inevitable category winners (e.g. "the next Taco Bell") can fail despite convincing forecasts. The playbook looked right; reality did not follow Marketing takeaway: treat CAC models, attribution reports, and persona decks as maps. Validate against behaviour in the territory (tests, fieldwork, post-mortems) Origin: Associated with Sakichi Toyoda / Toyota problem-solving. When a problem occurs, ask why repeatedly (often about five times)

until you reach a root cause you can act on - not just a symptom Situation: Buy from a stranger with no inspection; IUR state: Ignorance Situation: See the car online, little history; IUR state: Uncertainty Situation: Full report + inspection done; IUR state: Risk (you can reason with numbers) Marketing situation: Entering a new country with no prior data; Likely IUR state: Ignorance; Move to improve: Small pilots, qualitative research Marketing situation: Launching a variant of a known product; Likely IUR state: Uncertainty; Move to improve: A/B tests, holdouts, stepwise scale

Must remember:

- Models simplify reality; never confuse map with territory
- Forecasts and playbooks can look perfect and still fail in market
- Five Whys: ask why repeatedly to reach root cause (Toyoda / Toyota lineage)
- Surface symptoms != systemic causes - marketing post-mortems need roots
- IUR: Ignorance → Uncertainty → Risk
- Good thinking moves you toward calculated risk, not fantasy certainty
- Pair models with real-world feedback before large bets

Example or contrast: Step: 1; Why?: Why did I run a red light?; Answer: I was late Step: 2; Why?: Why was I late?; Answer: I woke up late Step: 3; Why?: Why wake late?; Answer: Alarm did not work

Exam trap: State: Ignorance; Outcomes: Unknown; Probabilities: Unknown; Decision quality: Guessing in the dark State: Uncertainty; Outcomes: Somewhat known; Probabilities: Unclear; Decision quality: Scenarios without clean odds

MKT-W12-T06

Storytelling and Thinking Models: Module Summary

Tier C

Definition and why it matters: This module's core insight is simple: storytelling connects emotionally; thinking models provide clarity. Combined, they improve both the quality of decisions and the impact of how those decisions are communicated - so others can understand, trust, and act

Core explanation: Stories are not entertainment add-ons. They organise complex ideas, clarify scattered thoughts, and make information easier to understand and remember by engaging imagination and emotion Without story: Data and facts sit flat; With story: Ideas become experiences audiences can follow

Must remember:

- Stories organise complexity and create memory through emotion - not mere ornament
- Great business stories: audience + why + visible problem/transformation + human techniques
- Authenticity from real experiences beats polished generic messaging
- Thinking models discipline analysis: first principles, second-order, inversion, range, plus bias/efficiency tools
- Map != territory; Five Whys for roots; IUR to move toward calculated risk
- Together: emotional connection + analytical clarity → better decisions and stronger influence

Exam trap: Trap: Defining storytelling as decoration or entertainment only. It is structure, meaning, and connection Trap: Treating authenticity as optional fluff. Real experiences outperform generic slogans on trust

Week 12 Exam Lens

Likely questions

- Define and explain Storytelling Formats, Styles, Tactics, and Use Cases; include the mechanism and one limitation.
- Compare Storytelling Formats, Styles, Tactics, and Use Cases with Real-World Business Storytelling and state when each is preferred.

10-mark answer frame: Start with a precise definition; draw or state the causal flow; explain each stage and metric; add a comparison or worked example; close with trade-offs, failure modes, and the decision rule.

Mistakes to avoid: Trap: Treating storytelling as decoration ("add a customer quote at the end"). Storytelling is the structure of the message, not garnish Trap: Confusing Golden Circle with "start with features." Correct order is Why → How → What Trap: Equating "emotional storytelling" with melodrama. Professional use is subtle contrast - pain then relief - not theatrical overacting

Week 13: Budgets, Unit Economics, Ethics, and Career Skills

Week roadmap: Advertising Budgets, Ethics, and Career Readiness: Module Overview → Advertising Budgeting: CAC and LTV → LTV:CAC Ratio, Payback Period, Churn, and ARPU → Marketing ROS (Return on Sales) and MER → Easy Market Share Calculation Models → False Wants, Excessive Materialism, and Marketing's Social Debate → 5 more topics.

Coverage: 11 exact source topics; definitions and mechanisms come first, followed by formulas, examples, and traps where applicable.

MKT-W13-T01 Advertising Budgets, Ethics, and Career Readiness: Module Overview

Tier C

Definition and why it matters: This final module connects three threads of modern marketing: how much to spend (metrics for budgeting), how to spend responsibly (ethics and sustainability), and how to build a career (skills and professional positioning). Growth without measurement is guesswork; measurement without ethics is fragile; technical skill without communication rarely scales

Core explanation: Concept flow: Module Themes - Advertising Budgets - Ethical Marketing - Career Readiness - CAC, LTV, Payback, ROS, Market Share - Materialism, Responsibility, Sustainability - Resume, Interviews, Soft Skills Area: Advertising budgets; Core Question: How much should we invest to acquire, retain, or engage customers?; Tools / Themes: CAC, LTV, payback period, market share models, marketing ROS

Must remember:

- Three pillars: budgets (metrics), ethics (society), careers (skills)
- Key metrics preview: CAC, LTV, payback, market share, marketing ROS
- Data-driven budgeting + ethical responsibility = sustainable growth
- Career readiness: communication, strategic thinking, adaptability
- Goal: marketer who scales profitably and contributes positively

Formula / decision rule: CAC; LTV

Exam trap: Trap: Treating budgeting as "pick a spend number." The module frames budget as a metric-led decision (CAC, LTV, payback, share) Trap: Separating ethics from performance. Responsible marketing is part of strategy, not an optional add-on

MKT-W13-T02 Advertising Budgeting: CAC and LTV

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Before setting an ad budget, ask two linked questions: What does each new customer cost? and What is that customer worth over time? CAC is the price tag of growth; LTV is the return that growth can generate. Looking at either alone misleads - a high CAC can be fine if LTV is much higher

Core explanation: CAC is the total cost required to convince a potential customer to buy - the "price tag" on every new customer Typical costs included: Cost Component: Advertising spend; Examples: Paid search, social ads, display Cost Component: Marketing tools; Examples: CRM, analytics, creative platforms Cost Component: Agency retainers; Examples: Creative, media, consulting fees Cost Component: People costs; Examples: Sales and marketing salaries/effort linked to acquisition Concept flow: CAC = Cost to acquire - Always pair with value - LTV = Value over relationship - Sensible ad budget Metric: CAC; Focus: Cost of acquiring customers Metric: LTV; Focus: Long-term value those customers create CAC = (Total sales and marketing expenses)/(Number of new customers acquired) Same-period rule: Expenses and new customers must come from the same time window (e.g., monthly spend customers acquired that month) Example: INR 10,00,000 sales & marketing spend in a month; 1,000 new customers → CAC = INR 10,000 per customer Component: Average purchase value (APV); Meaning: Spend per transaction Imagine CAC = INR 10,000. That looks expensive - until the same customer spends INR 10,000 over several years. Acquisition is then justified. Marketers need the lifetime value lens, not only the cost lens Component: Purchase frequency (F); Meaning: How often the customer buys (in the lifespan unit) Component: Customer lifespan (L); Meaning:

How long the customer stays active LTV (lifetime value) measures the total revenue a customer is expected to generate over their entire relationship with the business
 Lever: Retention; Action: Keep customers longer (reduces churn; extends lifespan)
 Lever: Repeat purchase; Action: Habits, subscriptions, loyalty
 Higher LTV means the firm can support higher acquisition spend while staying profitable, and rely less on endless new-customer acquisition
 Lever: Upsell / cross-sell; Action: Higher basket or additional products
 Compact form: $LTV = APV \times F \times L$
 Example: $APV = \text{INR } 500$, buys 4 times/year, stays 3 years $\rightarrow LTV = 500 \times 4 \times 3 = \text{INR } 6,000$
 When LTV rises, growth becomes more stable and less dependent on constant cold acquisition

Must remember:

- $CAC = \text{total sales \& marketing cost new customers (same period)}$
- $LTV \approx \text{average purchase value} \times \text{frequency} \times \text{lifespan}$
- CAC alone understates strategy; pair with LTV
- Raise LTV via retention, repeats, and upselling
- Budget logic: can we afford this CAC given expected LTV?

Formula / decision rule: CAC; LTV

Exam trap: Trap: Mismatched periods - monthly spend yearly customers. Always align the time window
 Trap: Treating CAC as only media spend. Include tools, agencies, and relevant sales/marketing labour when the full definition is asked

MKT-W13-T03 LTV:CAC Ratio, Payback Period, Churn, and ARPU

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Knowing LTV and CAC separately is not enough. The ratio answers: for every rupee spent to acquire, how much value returns? Payback answers: how long until that acquisition spend is recovered in cash? Profitability without timing can still kill a company through cash-flow gaps

Core explanation: $LTV:CAC = (LTV)/(CAC)$ It asks: for every unit spent on acquisition, how many units of lifetime value does the business receive? Ratio: $\leq 1:1$; Interpretation: Break-even or loss per customer - danger zone; Typical Action: Stop scaling ads; fix product, pricing, retention, or targeting
 Ratio: $\approx 3:1$; Interpretation: Healthy benchmark in many industries - sweet spot; Typical Action: Cover ops, manage risk, reinvest in growth
 Ratio: $\approx 5:1$ or higher; Interpretation: Very efficient - may mean underinvesting; Typical Action: Consider increasing ad spend to capture share (if ops/retention support it)
 Concept flow: $\leq 1:1$ Danger - Fix fundamentals - $\approx 3:1$ Sweet spot - Sustainable growth - $\geq 5:1$ Underspending? - Scale acquisition carefully
 Input: CAC; Value: INR 1,000
 Input: Average monthly revenue; Value: INR 200
 Input: Gross margin; Value: 50% (0.5)
 Example: $LTV = \text{INR } 9,000$, $CAC = \text{INR } 3,000 \rightarrow \text{ratio} = 3:1$ (healthy)
 Input: Monthly contribution; Value: $200 \times 0.5 = \text{INR } 100$
 Benchmarks vary by industry; the principle does not: acquisition must fund value after costs and risk
 Input: Payback; Value: $1000 / 100 = 10$ months
 Even a great LTV:CAC fails if cash returns too slowly. Payback period is time needed to recover CAC
 Payback: Long (e.g., 12 months); Business Meaning: Cash-flow gap: ads due in 30 days, recovery takes a year - grow carefully, finance conservatively
 Payback period = $(CAC)/(\text{Average monthly revenue per customer} \times \text{Gross margin})$
 Payback: Short (e.g., 2 months); Business Meaning: Cash returns fast - reinvest in ads/research - compounding growth loop
 Compact form: $\text{Payback} = (CAC)/(AMR \times GM)$
 Gross margin matters because only the contribution after production cost actually pays back acquisition
 Context: B2B; Common target direction: Keep monthly churn under $\sim 5\%$
 Context: B2C; Common target direction: Often aim for roughly 7%-10% monthly (context-dependent; lower is better)
 Metric: LTV:CAC; Role in budgeting: Is acquisition financially sustainable? Metric: Payback; Role in budgeting: How fast does cash return?
 Churn = percentage of customers who stop using the product/service in a period - the natural enemy of LTV (shortens lifespan)
 Metric: Churn; Role in budgeting: How fast does LTV erode? Churn rate = $(\text{Customers lost in period})/(\text{Customers at start of period}) \times 100$
 Metric: ARPU; Role in budgeting: How much value per user each period? $ARPU = \text{average revenue generated per customer/user}$ - a direct lever on LTV
 $ARPU = (\text{Total revenue})/(\text{Total number of users})$
 Raise ARPU via upselling (and related moves: higher-tier plans, bundles, add-ons)
 Together they support data-driven advertising budgets - not spend for spend's sake

Must remember:

- LTV:CAC: value per unit of acquisition spend; ~3:1 often healthy; ≤ 1 danger; very high may mean underspend
- Payback = $CAC / (AMR \times GM)$ - timing of cash recovery
- Long payback $\rightarrow$ cash-flow risk; short payback $\rightarrow$ reinvestment loop
- Churn = $\text{lost}/\text{start} \times 100$ - enemy of LTV
- ARPU = $\text{revenue}/\text{users}$ - raise via upsell to lift LTV

Formula / decision rule: LTV; CAC

Exam trap: Trap: Celebrating a very high LTV:CAC as "perfect." It can signal underinvestment and lost market share Trap: Scaling ads at $\leq 1:1$. You amplify losses

MKT-W13-T04 Marketing ROS (Return on Sales) and MER

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: CAC and LTV focus on the customer. Marketing return on sales (ROS) zooms out to the firm: of the sales marketing helped generate, how much becomes marketing-attributable profit? Two campaigns can post similar revenue; ROS reveals which one actually contributed profit after marketing cost

Core explanation: Before ROS, define net marketing contribution - profit attributable to marketing after production costs and marketing expenses Item: Net sales; Value: INR 1,50,000 Item: Net marketing contribution; Value: INR 10,000 Item: Marketing ROS; Value: $10000 / 150000 \approx 0.0667$ - $\approx 6.7\%$ Concept flow: $\text{Net Sales} - \text{Subtract COGS} + \text{Marketing Expenses} - \text{Net Marketing Contribution} - \text{ROS} = \text{NMC} / \text{Net Sales}$ It shows profit from marketing-driven sales after covering goods sold and marketing spend Marketing ROS measures the percentage of net sales that translates into marketing contribution (marketing-driven profit relative to sales) $\text{Marketing ROS} = (\text{Net marketing contribution})/(\text{Net sales})$ Focus: Profit contribution of marketing; Metric: Marketing ROS Often expressed as a percentage: $\text{Marketing ROS} \times 100$ Focus: System-wide revenue per ad rupee; Metric: MER Insight: Similar sales, different spend; Implication: ROS shows which campaign contributes more profit Insight: Higher ROS over time; Implication: Strong contribution; efficient marketing investment About 6.7% of sales revenue is marketing-generated profit in this case Insight: Lower ROS; Implication: Marketing costs may be high vs revenue - or brand-building phase accepting short-term dilution Insight: Hard attribution; Implication: Prefer MER for whole-system efficiency Alongside ROS, managers use MER for a broader efficiency view across channels - useful when precise campaign attribution is hard $\text{MER} = (\text{Total revenue})/(\text{Total advertising spend})$ A healthy MER is often cited around 3 to 4: each unit of ad spend yields roughly 3-4 units of revenue. Context and industry still matter Example: Campaign A and B both sell INR 50 lakh. A spends far more on media. Revenue looks equal; marketing ROS (and contribution) separates the efficient spend from the expensive one - guiding budget reallocation

Must remember:

- $\text{NMC} = \text{Net sales} - \text{COGS} - \text{marketing expenses}$
- $\text{Marketing ROS} = \text{NMC} / \text{Net sales}$ (share of sales that is marketing profit)
- $\text{MER} = \text{Total revenue} / \text{Total ad spend}$ (often ~3-4 as a rough healthy band)
- Use ROS to compare campaigns on profit contribution, not sales alone
- Lower ROS can mean inefficiency - or intentional brand investment

Formula / decision rule: CAC; LTV

Exam trap: Trap: Confusing marketing ROS with ROAS (return on ad spend). ROS here is return on sales via net marketing contribution net sales Trap: Skipping NMC and dividing "profit" incorrectly. Build $\text{NMC} = \text{Net sales} - \text{COGS} - \text{marketing expenses}$ first

MKT-W13-T05 Easy Market Share Calculation Models

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Internal metrics (CAC, LTV, ROS) answer "are we efficient?" Market share answers "how big are we relative to the market and rivals?" Share is competitive position in one number - but revenue share, unit share, and relative share each tell a different story

Core explanation: Market share = percentage of total industry sales captured by a company in a period
 Example: Industry sales INR 100 crore; firm sales INR 10 crore → market share ≈ 10%
 Model: Revenue / value-based (most common); Basis: Money; Best When: Pricing differs a lot across competitors
 Model: Volume / units; Basis: Units sold; Best When: Scale and customer reach matter more than ticket price
 Concept flow: Market Share Views - Revenue / Value Model - Volume / Units Model - Relative Market Share
 Rising share usually signals gaining strength vs competitors. High share often brings brand recognition, scale economies, and pricing flexibility - but share growth should still be balanced with profitability
 Lens: Revenue share; Luxury niche brand: May lead; Mass discounter: May trail
 Market share(revenue) = (Company sales revenue)/(Total industry revenue) x 100
 Result: 1; Meaning: Leadership vs the 1 rival
 Example: Boutique revenue INR 1,00,000; total market INR 10,00,000 → market share = 10%
 Result: < 1; Meaning: Behind the market leader
 Useful when competitors sell at very different prices (premium vs discount players can look unequal on units but clear on value)
 Result: = 1; Meaning: Tied with the leader
 Market share(volume) = (Company units sold)/(Total industry units sold) x 100
 Emphasises operational scale and reach. A low-price mass brand may lead on units while a luxury brand leads on revenue share
 Alone: Chase share only; Risk: Unprofitable growth
 Alone: Ignore share; Risk: Miss competitive erosion
 Compares the firm to the largest competitor, not the whole industry (classic BCG-style idea)
 Alone: Share + LTV:CAC + ROS; Risk: Balanced growth narrative
 Relative market share = (Company sales)/(Largest competitor's sales)
 Example: Your sales INR 80 crore; leader INR 100 crore → relative share = 0.8 (follower)
 When market share is read together with CAC, LTV, and marketing ROS, managers see both competitive position and financial performance

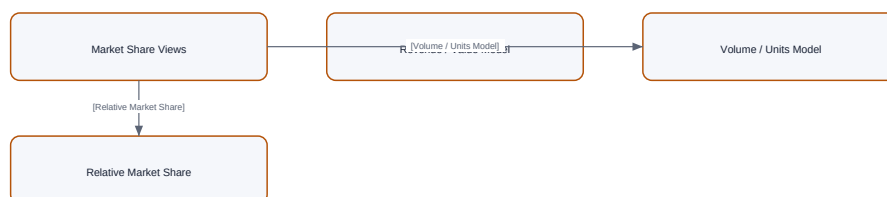
Must remember:

- Market share = firm's slice of industry sales in a period
- Revenue: share = (company revenue)/(industry revenue) x 100
- Volume: share = (company units)/(industry units) x 100
- Relative share = (company sales)/(leader sales) (1 = ahead of leader)
- Prefer revenue model when prices diverge; pair share with CAC, LTV, ROS for full picture

Formula / decision rule: CAC; LTV

Exam trap: Trap: Mixing revenue and unit bases in one comparison ("we're 1") without stating the model
 Trap: Confusing absolute market share (vs industry) with relative market share (vs leader)

Easy Market Share Calculation Models



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: Easy Market Share Calculation Models

MKT-W13-T06 False Wants, Excessive Materialism, and Marketing's Social Debate Tier B

Definition and why it matters: Marketing metrics grow the firm; this topic asks whether marketing also inflates desire. Critics say ads manufacture wants and equate happiness with ownership. Defenders say marketers channel existing motives - comfort, status, belonging - and that high product failure rates prove consumers still choose freely. Ethical marketers must hold both sides

Core explanation: Side: Critics; Claim: Advertising creates a consumption cycle; success/happiness measured by possessions; marketing creates new desires and pressure to buy more; Implication: Marketing manufactures "false wants" and fuels materialism
 Side: Marketers' reply; Claim: Needs are not invented; ads

appeal to existing motivations (comfort, status, convenience, belonging); Implication: Influence $\neq$ total control Side: Evidence often cited by marketers; Claim: Many new products fail; Implication: If firms fully controlled behaviour, failure rates would be much lower Concept flow: Critics: creates false wants - Ethics Debate - Defenders: taps existing motives - Marketing can push consumption OR expand access Criticism: Ads overwhelm attention ("cultural pollution"); Response: Ads subsidise "free" platforms and content Criticism: Pushes overconsumption; Response: Can also improve access and information Critics argue people face constant ad exposure - billboards, digital ads, social promotions, influencers, notifications - that crowds public and mental space Marketer counterpoint: Advertising funds much of the digital ecosystem. Search, social platforms, and many news outlets rely on ad revenue; without it, users might pay more via subscriptions Ethics is not only about excess consumption. Tools - pricing, distribution, communication - can reach disadvantaged groups and improve access to essentials

Must remember:

- Debate: false wants/materialism vs appealing to existing motives
- Product failures argue against total consumer control
- Cultural pollution vs advertising-funded digital ecosystem
- Marketing can expand access (e.g., SNAP Online) as well as push buying
- REI Opt Outside: ethics + brand identity can reinforce each other
- Ethical awareness $\rightarrow$ stronger long-term marketing judgment

Example or contrast: In 2015, outdoor retailer REI closed stores on Black Friday and urged people to spend the day outdoors instead of participating in heavy promotions. Participation grew; the firm later made Black Friday store closure permanent while paying employees for the day Question: Pure ethics or brand play?; Insight: Often both - values stance + identity and loyalty Question: Marketing lesson; Insight: Brands can refuse consumption rituals and still build equity

Exam trap: Trap: Framing the debate as "marketing is always bad" or "always good." Exams expect the both-sides structure plus examples of access/responsibility Trap: Saying marketers "create needs." Course language usually: needs/motivations exist; marketing shapes wants and appeals

MKT-W13-T07

Responsible and Sustainable Marketing Policies

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: If marketing can shape behaviour and consumption, responsibility follows power. Critics raise false wants and materialism; this topic moves to solutions - consumer rights, environmentalism, carbon footprint, and structured sustainability so ethics becomes scalable strategy, not a slogan

Core explanation: Consumerism = organised effort to strengthen buyer power in the marketplace Buyers should have the right to be informed about quality, safety, pricing, and business practices before purchase Era: Traditional focus; Emphasis: Safety and performance Era: Modern expansion; Emphasis: Transparency, ethical sourcing, responsible communication Concept flow: Marketing Influence - Consumer Rights / Consumerism - Environmental Responsibility - Trust and legitimacy - Sustainability in strategy - Balance business goals with social impact Level: 1. Internal operations; Focus: Clean up inside the firm; What It Looks Like: Reduce waste, improve energy efficiency, lower emissions in own operations Level: 2. Product stewardship; Focus: Design for lower life-cycle impact; What It Looks Like: Products/services engineered to reduce harm from cradle to disposal Consumers are no longer passive message recipients; they act as stakeholders who expect responsible operations Level: 3. Strategic integration; Focus: Sustainability in core vision; What It Looks Like: Not a side project - part of business strategy and performance Concept flow: Level 1: Internal improvements - Level 2: Product stewardship - Level 3: Strategic sustainability vision Environmentalism pushes firms beyond short-term consumption maximisation toward long-term planetary impact and quality of life, while protecting environmental resources Carbon footprint = total environmental impact of a product/service across its entire life cycle: Raw material sourcing Goal: Growth and sales; Without balance: Risk of exploitation and backlash Cutting the footprint needs coordinated effort from companies and consumers Goal: Rights, transparency, environment; Without balance: Empty virtue without viable economics A practical framework distinguishing levels of environmental responsibility: Goal: Aligned strategy; Without balance: Trust + durable competitive position When sustainability aligns with business performance, responsible mar-

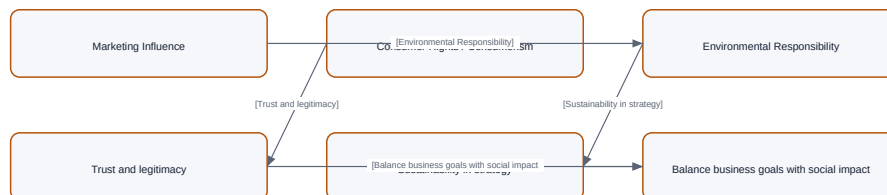
Marketing becomes practical and scalable Responsible marketing balances: Ethical marketing ultimately rests on understanding what people actually need - bridging to human motivation frameworks next

Must remember:

- Consumerism strengthens buyer power: information on quality, safety, price, practices
- Modern rights: transparency, ethical sourcing, responsible communication
- Environmentalism: quality of life + resource protection beyond short-term consumption
- Carbon footprint = full life-cycle impact
- Sustainability grid: internal ops → product stewardship → strategic vision
- Responsibility + performance alignment = scalable responsible marketing

Exam trap: Trap: Equating consumerism with "buying more." Here consumerism means strengthening buyer rights/power Trap: Limiting consumer rights to product safety only - modern view adds transparency and ethical sourcing

Responsible and Sustainable Marketing Policies



Vector reconstruction of the source Mermaid visual

Concept map: Responsible and Sustainable Marketing Policies

MKT-W13-T08

Human Basic Needs and How Marketing Taps Them

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Platforms, media, and tech change fast; basic human motivations change slowly. Campaigns resonate when they map to real needs - food security, safety, belonging, esteem, growth - and fail when they chase superficial trends or exploit insecurity without meaning

Core explanation: Despite shifts in technology and behaviour, the motivations that drive decisions remain largely stable. Understanding them explains why some messages stick and others bounce Human behaviour is framed as a progression of needs: Level: Physiological; Needs: Food, water, shelter; Marketing Resonance: Basics, FMCG staples, meal solutions Level: Safety; Needs: Financial security, physical protection; Marketing Resonance: Insurance, security, reliable banking Level: Belongingness; Needs: Relationships, community, acceptance; Marketing Resonance: Social platforms, membership clubs, communities Level: Esteem; Needs: Recognition, confidence, achievement; Marketing Resonance: Luxury, status signals, awards/credentials Level: Self-actualization; Needs: Growth, fulfilment, purpose; Marketing Resonance: Purpose-led brands, learning, personal development Concept flow: Self-actualization - Esteem - Belongingness - Safety - Physiological (Pyramid reads bottom-up: physiological foundation → self-actualization at the top.) Marketing works best when aligned with genuine needs. The same map can be abused (fear-mongering on safety; manufactured inadequacy on esteem). Ethical practice: Support real motivations Avoid exploiting insecurity Balance effectiveness with responsibility Advertising techniques and media will keep evolving. The underlying drivers - belonging, recognition, security, meaning - remain. Map creatives and offers to the hierarchy; do not confuse channel novelty with new human nature

Must remember:

- Basic motivations stay stable even as platforms change
- Maslow: physiological → safety → belonging → esteem → self-actualization
- Map brands: insurance-safety; social/membership-belonging; luxury-esteem; purpose-self-actualization
- Best marketing aligns with genuine needs, not only trends

- Effectiveness + responsibility = ethical need-based marketing

Example or contrast: Need level: Safety; Brand / category pattern: Insurance, security products; Message flavour: Protection, stability, peace of mind
 Need level: Belonging; Brand / category pattern: Social apps, membership programmes; Message flavour: Community, shared identity
 Need level: Esteem; Brand / category pattern: Luxury and premium badges; Message flavour: Status, recognition, achievement

Exam trap: Trap: Treating Maslow as a rigid ladder every buyer climbs perfectly. Use it as a lens, not a law of physics
 Trap: Ignoring lower needs when designing "aspiration-only" messages for audiences still focused on price and safety

MKT-W13-T09 Soft Skills and the T-Shaped Marketer

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: Marketing concepts get you into the room; soft skills and shape of expertise keep you effective there. Modern campaigns cross content, analytics, paid media, product, and design. Pure specialists struggle to collaborate; pure generalists struggle to deliver depth. The T-shaped marketer balances both

Core explanation: Financial and ethical literacy are necessary - but careers also demand: Clear communication across teams
 Function: Content; Role in the mix: Narrative and assets
 Function: Data analytics; Role in the mix: Insight and measurement
 Function: Paid advertising; Role in the mix: Reach and conversion
 Function: Product; Role in the mix: Offer and experience
 Function: Design; Role in the mix: Clarity and brand craft
 Translation of data into creative strategy
 Alignment of marketing with broader business goals
 Shape: Specialist (I); Meaning: Deep expertise in one area (e.g., SEO, analytics, performance marketing) - strong technical delivery
 Adaptability as platforms and briefs change
 Shape: T-shaped; Meaning: Deep vertical + broad horizontal awareness of related fields
 Campaigns require coordination across: Concept flow: Horizontal: working knowledge across disciplines - Vertical: deep expertise in one domain
 Stage: Early career; Focus: Build depth first - analytics tools, campaign management, or content strategy
 Stage: Next; Focus: Expand horizontally - e.g., performance marketer learns CRO, retention, positioning
 Generalists adapt faster, collaborate across silos, connect perspectives, and link insights to strategy
 Stage: Outcome; Focus: Better collaboration and contribution to strategic discussions
 Vertical bar: depth in one domain
 Horizontal bar: working knowledge across several disciplines
 That balance explains how professionals stay specialised and adaptable
 Example: A performance-marketing specialist who also understands retention and product positioning can debate budget shifts using CAC/LTV language with product and finance - not only report CPC

Must remember:

- Modern marketing is cross-functional; collaboration and communication are core
- Generalists connect teams; specialists deliver depth
- T-shaped = deep expertise + broad related awareness
- Early: deepen one skill; later: expand adjacent domains
- Goal: execute technically and contribute strategically

Formula / decision rule: CAC; LTV

Example or contrast: Depth wins on technical excellence; breadth wins on integration. The T-model is the career design that often fits modern marketing orgs best: deep enough to execute, broad enough to orchestrate

Exam trap: Trap: Treating soft skills as unrelated to marketing exams. Module frames them as career-readiness outcomes
 Trap: Assuming only specialists succeed - or only generalists. The point is the T combination

MKT-W13-T10 Resume and Interview Tips for Marketing Careers

Tier C

Definition and why it matters: Your resume is not an autobiography - it is a positioning document for a specific role. Interviews test competence, thinking, and fit. Technology and job boards change; human psychology - clarity, proof, belonging, recognition - still decides who gets heard
 Interviews are structured conversations evaluating:

Core explanation: Career stage: Students / recent grads; Emphasise: Education, projects, internships, relevant coursework Career stage: Experienced professionals; Emphasise: Work experience, leadership, measurable achievements Do: Specific language, active voice; Why: Impact is clear Do: Articulate work plainly; Why: Fancy wording without proof fails Do: Quantify and qualify achievements; Why: Facts beat adjectives

Must remember:

- Resume = positioning document, stage-appropriate (edu vs experience)
- Active, specific, quantified, scannable; reverse chronological
- Avoid: errors, missing contact, passive duty lists, pronouns, unneeded personal data
- Interviews test competence, thinking, and alignment
- Tools change; motivations (belonging, recognition, security, meaning) stay - use that in careers and marketing

Formula / decision rule: 2.1%; 3.4%

Exam trap: Trap: Treating the resume as a complete life story instead of role-specific positioning Trap: Vague responsibility lists with no metrics or outcomes

MKT-W13-T11

Week Summary: Metrics, Ethics, and Integrated Marketing Judgment

Tier A

Definition and why it matters: This module closed the course by tying money, morals, and craft. Advertising budgets are not arbitrary line items - they reshape growth and long-term profit. Metrics structure those bets; ethics and sustainability keep influence accountable; careers need both analytical and human skills. Marketing at its best joins numbers, strategy, psychology, and responsibility

Core explanation: Concept flow: Budget decisions - CAC, LTV, LTV:CAC, Payback - Marketing ROS, MER, Market share - False wants, responsibility, needs - Soft skills, resume, interviews Metric: CAC; Role: Cost to acquire a new customer Metric: LTV; Role: Revenue (value) over the full customer relationship Metric: LTV:CAC; Role: Sustainability of acquisition / growth strategy Metric: Payback period; Role: Time to recover acquisition spend Theme: False wants / materialism; Takeaway: Ongoing debate - influence vs existing motives Theme: Responsible & sustainable marketing; Takeaway: Rights, transparency, life-cycle impact, sustainability levels Theme: Human needs; Takeaway: Stable motivations (e.g., Maslow) underpin effective, ethical appeals For firms that rely heavily on marketing investment, these concepts are essential - spend that ignores payback and ratio logic can look "busy" while destroying cash or value $CAC = (\text{sales \& marketing spend}) / (\text{new customers})$ Lens: Acquisition economics; Questions answered: Can we afford growth? How fast does cash return? $LTV \sim APV \times \text{frequency} \times \text{lifespan}$ Lens: Firm / market metrics; Questions answered: What profit share does marketing contribute? What is our competitive slice? $LTV:CAC = (LTV) / (CAC)$ Lens: Ethics; Questions answered: Are we creating harm, trust, or access? $\text{Payback} = (CAC) / (AMR \times GM)$ Lens: Career craft; Questions answered: Can we communicate proof and think with stakeholders? After the financial lens, the module turned to society: As consumer expectations evolve, transparency and environmental impact become part of strategy, not optional extras Keep holding the discipline as a whole: numbers + strategy + psychology + human understanding. That combination is what separates mechanical channel operators from marketers who scale responsibly

Must remember:

- Budgets → CAC, LTV, LTV:CAC, payback (and related firm metrics / share)
- Ethics → false wants debate, responsible practice, human needs
- Careers → T-shaped skills, resume positioning, interview clarity
- Marketing = measurable investment decisions + social responsibility + human insight
- End state: grow with evidence, influence with care, communicate with proof

Formula / decision rule: CAC; LTV

Exam trap: Trap: Revising only CAC/LTV and skipping ethics - the module is deliberately dual Trap: Memorising formulas without decision rules (1:1 vs 3:1 vs high ratio; long vs short payback)

Week 13 Exam Lens

Likely questions

- Define and explain Advertising Budgeting: CAC and LTV; include the mechanism and one limitation.
- Compare Advertising Budgeting: CAC and LTV with LTV:CAC Ratio, Payback Period, Churn, and ARPU and state when each is preferred.
- Apply Marketing ROS (Return on Sales) and MER to a realistic system or business scenario and justify the decision.

10-mark answer frame: Start with a precise definition; draw or state the causal flow; explain each stage and metric; add a comparison or worked example; close with trade-offs, failure modes, and the decision rule.

Formula and decision sheet: CAC; LTV; 2.1%; 3.4%

Mistakes to avoid: Trap: Treating budgeting as "pick a spend number." The module frames budget as a metric-led decision (CAC, LTV, payback, share) Trap: Mismatched periods - monthly spend yearly customers. Always align the time window Trap: Celebrating a very high LTV:CAC as "perfect." It can signal underinvestment and lost market share

Rapid Revision Master Sheet

Week 1: Marketing Foundations and Consumer Value. Consumer Value: Benefits, Costs, and the Value Equation; Tangible and Intangible Value; Demand Fundamentals; Need, Want, and Demand; Economics Foundations for Marketers.

Week 2: Marketing Frameworks, Positioning, and Portfolios. From Marketing Funnel to Flywheel: AIDA in Practice; Strategic Analysis Frameworks: PESTEL, Porter's Five Forces, and SWOT; The STP Model: Segmentation, Targeting, and Positioning; Product-Oriented vs Market-Oriented Positioning; BCG Growth-Share Matrix.

Week 3: Marketing Research, Analytics, and Forecasting. Marketing Information Ecosystem and Market Research; Analytics Maturity, Statistics, and Sampling; Demand Research Tools: Google Trends, Search Intent, and Keyword Analysis; Market Demand Forecasting with Simple ML for Sheets.

Week 4: Marketing Mix, Creativity, and Consumer Action. Module Map: Marketing Mix and Creative Execution; Marketing Mix Foundation; The Four Ps and Seven Ps in Detail; Copywriting for Marketing; Visuals, Design Principles, and Visual Cues.

Week 5: Consumer Behaviour and Branding. Consumer Behavior: Social and Cultural Influences; Branding: Meaning, Levels, Roles, Assets, and Vehicles; Color Psychology for Branding and Design; Brand Personality: Human Traits Brands Can Own; Brand Architecture Pyramid.

Week 6: Pricing Strategy, Sales, and Channel Decisions. Pricing Concepts: What Price Really Means; Pricing Strategies from a Marketer's Perspective; Pricing Strategies from an Economist's Perspective; Price Elasticity of Demand; Why Price Elasticity Matters for Marketers.

Week 7: Product, Market, and Growth Strategy. Blue Ocean vs Red Ocean Strategy; Product Life Cycle; Modelling Perceived Risk for Consumers; Internal vs External Consumer Problems.

Week 8: Meta Advertising and Campaign Design. Meta Advertising Standards and Restricted Content; Meta Ads Structure, Objectives, Targeting, and Formats; Meta Ads Manager Lab: Building and Reading a Campaign; Meta Ads Week Wrap-Up: Structure, Formats, and Targeting.

Week 9: Google Ads, Auctions, and Campaign Types. Introduction to Google Ads for Lead Generation; Google Ads Foundational Knowledge: Policies, Auction, Structure, Targeting, Bidding; Google Ads Campaign Types: Search, Demand Gen, Discovery/YouTube, Performance Max; Google Ads Lab: Dashboard, Search Campaigns, Performance Max, and CPC Bidding; Week Summary: Google Ads for Lead Generation.

Week 10: Targeting and Performance Marketing. Google Ads for E-commerce and App Marketing; App Campaigns on Google Ads: Foundational Knowledge; Google Ads Lab: Demand Gen, Display, Shopping, and App Promotion; How Digital Ads Work: Behavioural vs Contextual Targeting and ML; Week 10 Summary: Targeting, Context, and Machine Learning in Digital Ads.

Week 11: Google Analytics and Attribution. Introduction to Google Analytics and Attribution Models; Google Analytics: Foundational Knowledge; Google Analytics Account Structure; Key Concepts and Metrics in Google Analytics; Sample Live Google Analytics Report Walkthrough.

Week 12: Storytelling and Thinking Models. Storytelling Formats, Styles, Tactics, and Use Cases; Real-World Business Storytelling.

Week 13: Budgets, Unit Economics, Ethics, and Career Skills. Advertising Budgeting: CAC and LTV; LTV:CAC Ratio, Payback Period, Churn, and ARPU; Marketing ROS (Return on Sales) and MER; Easy Market Share Calculation Models; Responsible and Sustainable Marketing Policies.

Formula and Framework Recall

- Value = (Benefits)/(Costs)
- Benefits = Costs
- Perceived Value = (Benefits)/(Costs)
- $E_d = \frac{\% \text{ change in quantity demanded}}{\% \text{ change in price}}$
- $E_{(AB)} = \frac{\% \text{ change in quantity demanded of A}}{\% \text{ change in price of B}}$
- LTV $\approx$ Monthly subscription fee x Number of months retained
- LTV $\approx$ Average order value (AOV) x Orders per period x Length of relationship

- $E_d = \frac{\Delta Q}{\Delta P}$
- $E_{AB} = \frac{\Delta Q_A}{\Delta P_B}$
- Impressions $\sim$ Reach x Frequency

Must-Draw and Must-Compare Sheet

Use these seven structures when a question asks you to explain, compare, design, or evaluate. Draw the skeleton first, label every arrow or decision axis, then use the prose answer to explain why each element exists and what can fail.

- Customer-value loop: need/want/demand → offer → exchange → satisfaction → relationship → lifetime value.
- Situation-analysis stack: PESTEL → Five Forces → SWOT → strategic implication.
- STP flow: segment → evaluate → target → position, with POP/POD and perceptual map.
- BCG portfolio: stars, cash cows, question marks, and dogs with investment implications.
- Brand-building ladder: attributes → benefits → values/personality → relationship/equity.
- Digital campaign funnel: objective → audience → creative → auction/delivery → conversion → attribution.
- Unit-economics map: CAC, LTV, LTV:CAC, payback, churn, ARPU, ROS, MER, and market share.

Scoring method: A diagram earns marks only when the labels are explained. After drawing, state the governing assumption, one metric or formula, one realistic example, and one limitation or trade-off. For a comparison, keep the dimensions parallel: purpose, data/input, mechanism, speed/cost, failure mode, and best-fit situation.

Final 30-Minute Answer Checklist

- Define the exact term before describing tools or examples.
- State the causal mechanism in a clear sequence; label each stage.
- Write the relevant formula, define its variables, and interpret the result.
- Compare alternatives on assumptions, cost, latency, risk, or customer value as appropriate.
- Use one realistic example and explicitly connect it to the concept.
- Close with a limitation, failure mode, ethical concern, or decision rule.
- Check that the answer addresses the command word: define, explain, compare, calculate, design, or evaluate.